



ONE MORE TERM

CBI Director Praveen Sood gets extension

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DRAGGING ON

Congress puts off decision on Kerala CM

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SLIGHT FALL

CBSE Class 12 pass percentage dips by 3%

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TESTING TROUBLES

Reputation at risk for NTA

Leaks and breaches have destroyed the agency's credibility

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JUNIOR COACH

HI not to renew Sreejesh's contract

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NEARBY



Top court stays Madras HC order on TVK legislator

NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday stayed a Madras High Court order barring Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam MLA R. Sreenivasa Sethupathi from casting his vote in the floor test in the Assembly. » PAGE 6

Order posting astrologer as aide to CM revoked

CHENNAI

The appointment of astrologer Rickey Radhan Pandit Vettrivel as the Officer on Special Duty (Political) to CM C. Joseph Vijay has been revoked by the State government. » PAGE 6

CMRL to procure additional TBMs for tunnelling

CHENNAI

The Chennai Metro Rail is planning to procure a few more tunnel boring machines (TBMs) amid in the work of the phase II project. » PAGE 3

METROPLUS » 4 PAGES

Vijay wins floor test with 144 votes; AIADMK divided

TVK-led government secures confidence vote in Tamil Nadu Assembly with 25 AIADMK MLAs voting in its favour; rift widens in AIADMK as Palaniswami removes 26 rebel functionaries

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay comfortably won the trust vote in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly on Wednesday with the support of the Congress, CPI, CPI(M), VCK, and IUML, as well as that of 25 rebel AIADMK MLAs and the lone AMMK MLA.

The confidence motion moved by Mr. Vijay was put to vote by Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar after the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam legislators and the lone Desiya Murpokku Dravidar Kazhagam MLA, Premalatha Vijayakant, walked out.

The vote came despite AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami's opposition to allowing S.P. Velumani, rebel AIADMK leader and his confidant until a few days ago, from speaking on the party's behalf.

The rift in the AIADMK widened on Wednesday night with Mr. Palaniswami removing 26 rebel district secretaries, including 12 legislators, from their positions.

Among those who were sacked from their posts



Support check: Chief Minister Vijay delivers a speech in the Tamil Nadu Assembly on Wednesday. ANI

were Mr. Velumani and C.Ve. Shanmugam, both former Ministers.

Earlier in the day, Mr. Velumani's camp pledged support to Mr. Vijay as the government secured 144 votes in the floor test.

While 22 MLAs from Mr. Palaniswami's camp opposed it, four Pattali Makal Katchi MLAs and the lone Bharatiya Janata Party MLA 'abstained' from voting.

Reiterating that this was "the common people's rule," Mr. Vijay said the government was for the good of everyone and the public would realise this as time

goes by. "This is not a government to show power or authority, or hatred. People and public welfare are important. It is the sole objective of this government," he said.

'People's faith'

Thanking everyone in the Assembly, Mr. Vijay said the people had reposed faith in the TVK-led government, just as they did in 1967 and 1977 to usher in "governments of the common people."

The "whistle revolution" had secured over 34.92% of votes to elect the TVK as the single-largest

party in less than three years of its formation.

"The majority was misused by a thin margin. If anyone thinks that this is a minority government, we are happy. This is a minority government, which will truly safeguard the rights of the minorities," he said, adding that his government was for everyone which has been reflected in the confidence motion.

The Chief Minister further promised a democratic, secular regime rooted in social justice.

RELATED REPORTS ON
» PAGE 6

CBI arrests five, conducts raids across India in NEET leak case

Devesh K. Pandey
Snehal Mutha
NEW DELHI/MUMBAI

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested five persons and conducted searches at locations across the country in connection with alleged irregularities related to the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-Undergraduate (NEET-UG) paper leak. Three brothers – Mangilal Biwal, Vikas Biwal and Dinesh Biwal – were



A man arrested in the NEET-UG paper leak case being taken to a court in Jaipur. PTI

taken into custody from Jaipur, Yash Yadav was picked up from Gurugram, and Shubham Khairnar from Nashik in Maharashtra.

tra, it said. The Maharashtra Police detained two more suspects in the case and handed them over to the CBI.

The police nabbed Manisha Waghmare, a beauty salon owner, from Bibbewadi, and Dhananjay Lokhande, an ayurveda practitioner, from Rahuri in the early hours of Wednesday.

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» PAGE 10
RELATED REPORTS ON
» PAGES 5 & 11

Rangasamy sworn in as Puducherry CM

The Hindu Bureau
PUDUCHERRY

N. Rangasamy, founder of the AINRC and head of the NDA in the Union Territory of Puducherry, was on Wednesday sworn in as the Chief Minister for a record fifth time.

Lieutenant-Governor K. Kailashnathan administered the oaths of office and secrecy to Mr. Rangasamy at a ceremony held at the Lok Niwas. Along with Mr. Rangasamy, BJP Legis-

lature Party leader A. Namassivayam and AINRC MLA Malladi Krishna Rao were sworn in as Ministers in the second NDA government in Puducherry.

After the ceremony, the Chief Minister visited the Assembly.

He was given a guard of honour by the territorial police.



FULL REPORT
» PAGE 5

Three tribal church leaders killed in Manipur ambush

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI/NEW DELHI

Suspected armed extremists ambushed a team of tribal church leaders in Kangpokpi district of Manipur on Wednesday, killing three of them and injuring four. The victims, members of the Thadou Baptist Association of India (TBAI) and the United Baptist Council, were travelling in two vehicles from a Baptist convention in Churachandpur to Kangpokpi when they were attacked.

The incident occurred on Tiger Road between Kotlen and Kotzim villages around 10 a.m. One of the survivors told

security personnel that the assailants came on foot and slipped away after firing a volley of bullets from the hillside of the road that connects the Kuki-dominated Churachandpur and Kangpokpi districts, bypassing the non-tribal Meitei-majority Imphal Valley.

Those who lost their lives were TBAI president Reverend Vumthang Sithlhou, finance secretary Rev. Kaigoulun Lhouvum, and Pastor Paogoulun Sithlou.

Peace efforts

The TBAI president had recently led a delegation of Kuki Christian leaders to adjoining Nagaland to



Chief Minister Y. Khemchand Singh and his team hold a discussion with doctors at the hospital where the injured were admitted. PTI

brokered peace between the Kukis and Tangkhul Nagas in the restive Kamjong and Ukhrul districts of Manipur. While three of the four

injured were rushed to a private hospital in Imphal for treatment, a fifth survivor, who managed to escape, was later tracked and rescued from the hills, an

official told *The Hindu*.

"Some eight to 10 armed men are suspected to have opened fire on two vehicles with automatic weapons, most likely AK-47 rifles. They were likely hiding in the hills," the official said.

According to a statement issued by the Indian Army, joint columns of security forces assisted in evacuating the injured to the nearest medical facility. "The joint columns are undertaking extensive search and area domination operations," an official monitoring Manipur said.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10



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HAUNTING MELODIES

Beginning of a maestro's great journey

The song 'Annakili Unnai Theduthey' was based on a tune sung by Ilayaraaja's mother, who would begin with the line 'Pullipotta Ravikkaikari'

After Annakili was released, Ilayaraaja, who composed the music for the film but was then not known to the outside world, along with his brothers Gangai Amaran and Baskar, would visit Rajakumari Theatre to gauge the audience's response. One of the film's directors, Devaraj, stood outside the theatre in Chennai, crestfallen, as only a handful of people had turned up to watch the film.

Impact of AIR

But by then, the songs had begun to echo across the State. All India Radio (AIR) broadcast them repeatedly, and listeners were captivated. Soon, crowds started queuing up outside theatres. Such was the popularity of the songs that Sonthamillai Bandhamillai, which had been removed after the first few days, had to be reinstated.

The song itself had its roots in a tune often rendered by Ilayaraaja's mother, who would sing it with different lines on different occasions. Similarly, Annakili Unnai Theduthey was also based on a tune sung by his mother, who would render it with the line Pullipotta Ravikkaikari.

Fifty years have flown by like a moment. But the songs of Annakili continue to haunt generations of music lovers. With the release of Annakili began the extraordinary journey of Ilayaraaja, whose career would rise to unparalleled heights.

Gangai Amaran, who worked closely with his brother during the composing sessions as the rhythm guitarist, recalls those memorable days.

Ilayaraaja once said he often walked between the Lighthouse and the Anna Mausoleum in Chennai, improvising the humming of the tune in his mind. Machana Paathheengala, another hit song, was originally written by Gangai Amaran and tuned by Ilayaraaja even before they were signed on for the film. Subsequently, Panchu Arunachalam, the producer of Annakili, who introduced Ilayaraaja as a music director, rewrote the lyrics while retaining the first two stanzas. When asked about the need to change the lyrics of the song, he said those making the film had the right to modify them. "Panchu Arunachalam's brothers had no faith in us. But he brushed aside their objections and made it clear that Ilayaraaja would compose the music," said Gangai Amaran, who was 28 when the film was made.

The popularity of the song can be gauged from a scene in the Sivaji Ganesan-starrer Kavarmaan, in which the daughter, when asked by her parents whether she preferred Carnatic or Western music, replies that she was interested only in learning Machana Paathheengala.

Ilayaraaja's native village

The story of Annakili was written by R. Selvaraj, who had visited Pannaipuram, Ilayaraaja's native village, and drew inspiration from its characters, including Annam, the midwife who became the film's heroine. It was Selvaraj who introduced the team to Panchu Arunachalam, whom he had known since their days working with music director G.K. Venkatesh.

"He had no instrument. He just tapped on the table and rendered the song Machana Paathheengala," he recalled while singing the number.

"After he sang all the tunes, Panchu Arunachalam was satisfied and said a story could be built around it. Mr. Selvaraj then narrated a story that suited his idea, and the film was conceived," he said. Panchu Arunachalam also changed the name of the Pavalar Brothers – Ilayaraaja's music troupe, which included Gangai Amaran and Baskar – and introduced Ilayaraaja as a music director.

To convince Arunachalam's brothers, Ilayaraaja arranged a full orchestra at a marriage hall near Natesan Park, where singers, including S. Janaki, rendered the songs. Only after this demonstration did they approve Ilayaraaja as the music director. "If there had been no Panchu Arunachalam, there would have been no Ilayaraaja or Gangai Amaran. He was our first god. He lit the light in our lives

But the troubles were not over. They resurfaced during the recording sessions. Well-known music director Govardhan Master conducted the orchestra. Just as the recording was about to begin, the studio was hit by a power cut, leaving the film industry – known for its deep-rooted superstitions and sentimentality – stunned.

Despite all the odds, the film became a huge hit. "At Thamukkam Maidanam (Madurai), there was a massive event where we performed all the songs from the film and even played tunes we were planning to use in the next film," he said. A woman who had watched the film the highest number of times was also presented with an award by Ilayaraaja. Fifty years have passed, but Ilayaraaja continues to work tirelessly and compose symphonies. "It is his life," he said.



Ilayaraaja with Gangai Amaran during the composition of songs for the film

50 YEARS OF Annakili

Annakili, the Tamil film, was a trendsetter in many ways. Rooted in a rural backdrop, the film revolved around lead character Annam, a remarkable woman who ekes out a living as a midwife and finds solace amid sorrow, played memorably by Sujatha. The film also showcased the phenomenal talent of Ilayaraaja and his brothers, who would later go on to dominate the world of film music. Actor Sivakumar, the hero of the film and Gangai Amaran, younger brother of Ilayaraaja, who was the rhythm guitarist for the film, share their experiences in the making of the film released on May 14, 1976 with B. Kolappan



Selvaraj, Story writer



Devaraj, Director



Mohan, Director



Ilayaraaja with actor Sivakumar



A REMARKABLE WOMAN'S TALE

A trendsetter through the hero's eyes

The film, set in Thengumarahada, a place full of coconut trees, was the discovery of the film's art director Babu

As May 14 marks the film's 50th anniversary, actor Sivakumar, the film's hero Thyagarajan, shared his memories.

The 50-day celebration of Uravu Solla Oruvan was held at Shanmuga Theatre on September 6, 1975. The cast included R. Muthuraman, Sujatha, Padmapriya, and me. Poet Kannadasan, who attended the evening show, praised the film. He was the uncle of the late producer and writer Panchu Arunachalam. It was then that producer Panchu Arunachalam asked us to find a suitable location for Annakili.

'A rare sense of brotherhood'

In those days, heroes, producers, and directors worked together and shared a rare sense of brotherhood. I did not think my job ended with acting alone. As part of our plan to tour Coimbatore district, I took directors Devaraj-Mohan, director Subbu, his brother Lakshmanan, and journalist Chitra Lakshmanan to my village. Chitra Lakshmanan and producer Subbu stayed for a night and then left. The others came to my house, had tiffin, and we headed northwards – to Bhavanisagar Dam, Karachikoral, Thottapalayam, Sathyamangalam, Kemmanayakanpalayam, Vaniputhur, and Vinobha Nagar. We inspected the locations, took photographs, and stayed overnight in Coimbatore.

The next day, we travelled to Perur, Mathampatti, Karadimadai, Mathiyapalayam, Thondamuthur, Narasipuram, Chemmedu, and Siruvani – villages nestled at the foothills of the Western Ghats – and photographed those locations as well. On the third day, we went to Polachi and travelled southwards to Angalakurichi, Aliyar, Anaimalai, Vettaikaranpudur, Sethumadai, and Topslip. After photographing the locations, we returned to Chennai. However, the locations were still not finalised, as we were not fully satisfied.

Serene setting

Suddenly, the film's art director, Babu, said he had discovered a place. "Where is it?" I asked. "Thengumarahada". The name sounded unfamiliar, and I asked where it was located. He explained that from the village of Karachikoral, about seven kilometres from Bhavanisagar Dam, one could travel another 22 kilometres through hilly roads to reach Thengumarahada. Elephants, deer, and peacocks roamed freely there. Thengumarahada literally means a place full of coconut trees. Around 180 acres of land there were cultivated by about 20 families and they practised cooperative farming. Every day, a bus would come to the village from Mettupalayam. The villagers had no link with the outside world. Only a few had watched movies; others did not even know what cinema was. Only I was known to them. They thought we had come there for some work and watched the shooting with great curiosity.

Sujatha, Jayalakshmi, M.N. Rajam, S.V. Subbaiah, Thengai Srinivasan, Senthamarai, Srikanth, and all of us went there for the shoot. There were only about 10 to 20 farmers' houses in the village, and the residents vacated them for us to stay. The actresses stayed in the houses that had toilet facilities. The rest of us would go to the riverbank early in the morning to attend to nature's call.

Devaraj and Mohan completed 70 per cent of the shooting in 20 days at Thengumarahada. All the songs composed by Ilayaraaja – Machana Paarthheengala, Annakili Unnai Theduthe, Sontham Illai Bandham Illai, and Sutha Samba Pachanelu – became huge hits. Fifty per cent of the credit for the film's success should go to Ilayaraaja's music.

One of the most unforgettable figures during the entire shooting schedule was Mathampatti Sivakumar, who became my friend. He left a jeep at the disposal of the crew. One day, he arrived with mutton biryani, chicken kurma, and boiled eggs for 100 people by noon. We could not believe our eyes. He must have prepared everything the previous evening, because he could have reached the shooting spot from Mathampatti only if he had started by 8 a.m. We devoured the feast, as we had gone nearly 15 days without proper food. A youth accompanied Mathampatti Sivakumar and it was actor Sathyaraj.

One of the memorable scenes in the film is when the hero and heroine embrace each other. Annam realises her position and gently wriggles herself out of the situation.

"Men can express emotion. The world cannot bear it if a woman becomes emotional."

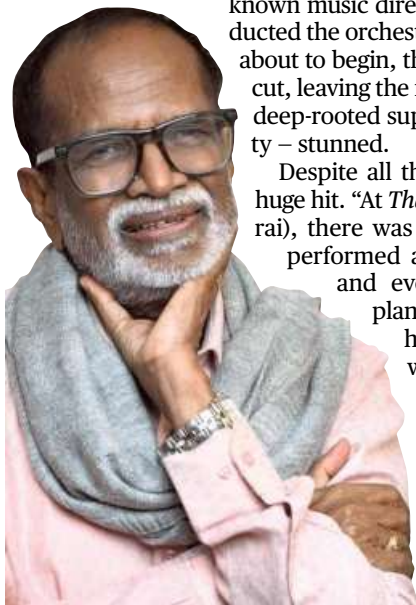
Annakili was released on May 14, 1976. We celebrated the 58th day of its run at Idhaya Theatre. A cake-cutting ceremony marked the 100th-day celebration at Prasad Studios on August 21, 1976. A.L.S. Kannadasan, K. Balachander, Arangannal, AVM Murugan, AVM Saravanan, and S.P. Muthuraman participated in the silver jubilee celebrations on November 27, 1976. We celebrated the film's 200th day in Madurai in 1977.

There had been no film like it in those days. A black-and-white film running successfully for 200 days was remarkable, and much of that achievement was due to the songs composed by Ilayaraaja.

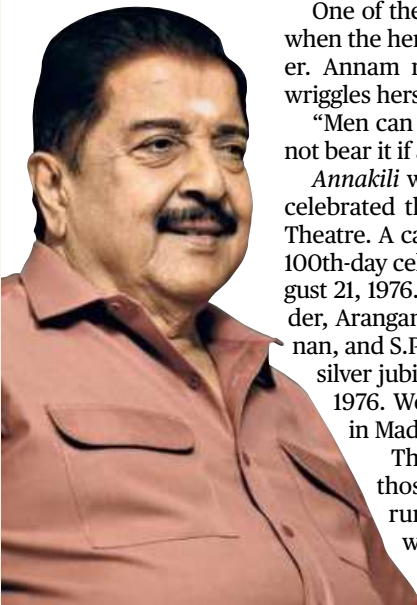


If there had been no Panchu Arunachalam, there would have been no Ilayaraaja or Gangai Amaran. He was our first god. He lit the light in our lives

GANGAI AMARAN
Composer and lyricist



A black-and-white film running successfully for 200 days was remarkable, and much of that achievement was due to the songs composed by Ilayaraaja
SIVAKUMAR
Actor



INBRIEF



Students of Sri Ramachandra Institute develop health app

Students of the Faculty of Pharmacy at Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education and Research have developed 'Meduora', a digital health application that connects patients with doctors, pharmacies, and diagnostic laboratories through a single platform, with a focus on tier-2 and tier-3 hospitals. The app, developed under the Sri Ramachandra Innovation Incubation Foundation, was inaugurated by Samyuktha Venkataachalam.Vice-Chancellor Uma Sekar, Dean K. Balaji Singh, and Registrar S. Senthil Kumar were present.

IJCCI calls for applications for CEO Business Matching Event

The Indo-Japan Chamber of Commerce and Industry (IJCCI), in collaboration with the SME Support Japan Organization, Ministry of Investment, Trade and Industry (MITI), Government of Japan, has invited IJCCI member companies to participate in the CEO Business Matching Event in the Medical Equipment Sector, encompassing Medical Equipment, Healthcare, Nursing (medical care) and Nursing Care. Interested member companies can contact 9884394717 or indo-japan@ijcci.com for more details. There is no registration fee and the deadline for submitting the application is June 2, 2026.

Nominations invited for Cavinkare-MMA awards

CavinKare, in association with the Madras Management Association, has invited nominations for the 15th CavinKare-MMA Chinnikrishnan Innovation & Great Ideas Awards, 2026, a national platform that nurtures impactful entrepreneurial ventures across India. Interested institutions and individuals can apply for the awards by submitting their entries on or before June 22, 2026 at www.ckinnovationawards.in or call +91 9444700068 to register, the release said.

State sees pass percentage of 95.25 in CBSE Class 12 exams, a dip from last year's 98.48

Chennai region stands second in the country, after the Thiruvananthapuram region, with 93.84%; girls outperform boys and Kendriya Vidyalayas perform the best among institutions in the State

Meghna M.
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu registered a pass percentage of 95.25 in the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) Class 12 exams. This marks a dip from the previous year's pass percentage of 98.48.

The CBSE Class 12 results were announced on Wednesday, with the national pass percentage recorded at 85.2.

As many as 46,901 boys and 41,245 girls from Tamil Nadu wrote the exam, wherein girls outperformed boys (94%), with a pass percentage of 96.68.

The Chennai region stood second in the country - after the Thiruvananthapuram region - with 93.84%, which is a decrease from the previous year's 97.39%. Besides Tamil Nadu, the Chennai region includes Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Puducherry, and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

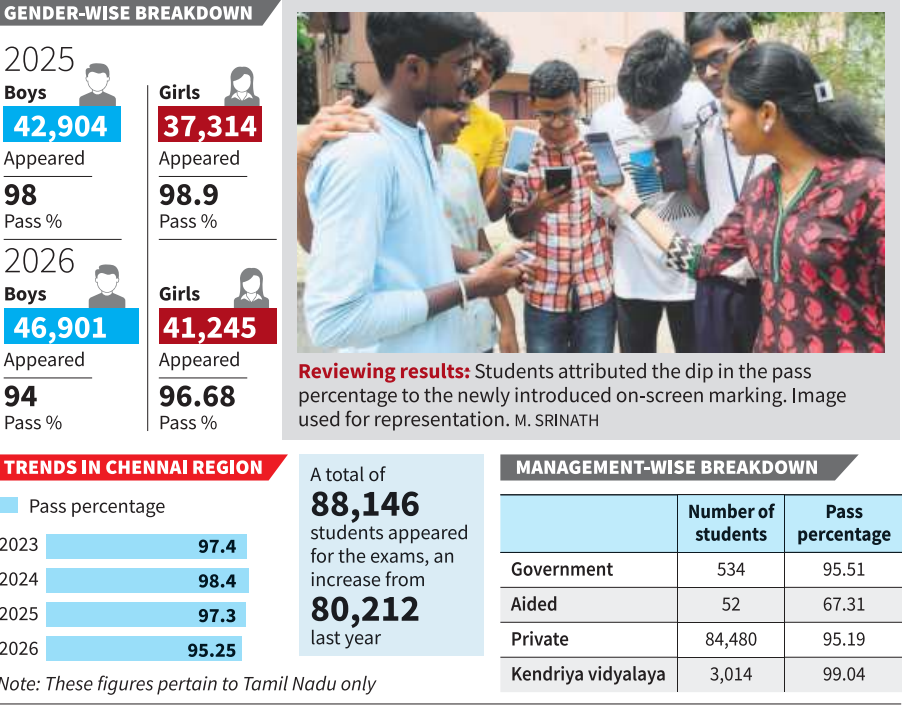
The exams were held between February 17 and April 4. Students from as many as 1,123 schools in the State wrote the exams held across 357 centres in Tamil Nadu.

In Tamil Nadu, Kendriya Vidyalayas performed the best among institutions, registering a pass rate of 99.04, while government-aided schools achieved a pass rate of 67.31. Government schools registered 95.51% and private schools, 95.19%.

Further, 14,229 General

Performance chart

Students from as many as 1,123 schools wrote the exams held across 357 centres in Tamil Nadu



Category students secured a pass rate of 97.15 and 7,267 Scheduled Caste (SC) students cleared the exam with 92.15%.

While 512 students under the Scheduled Tribe (ST) category achieved a pass rate of 91.92, 61,954 Other Backward Classes (OBC) students passed with 95.23%.

Students, parents and teachers expressed disappointment at the drop in the pass percentage registered.

They attributed this to the on-screen marking (OSM) system that was introduced this year.

N. Vijayan, senior prin-

cipal of Zion and Alwin Group of schools, said, "A student of a CBSE school, on understanding the concept, conveys the answer in their style without altering the principle of the concept. This is taken into consideration during evaluation in conventional mode. But in OSM, it is not possible. Hence, the student tend to lose marks even though the answer is correct."

Senior Principal of Prasan Vidya Mandir Lakshmi Prabha said that while some papers such as maths and physics were tough, the decrease in centums and marks was concern-

ing. "While the CBSE took so many steps with Class 10 exams, this (OSM system) should have been kept in mind for Class 12 students. This could have been rolled out in the sampling format," she said.

Many teachers pointed out that the CBSE should do review the papers, as students are affected by the dip in scores.

Students can access the results through any of the four CBSE websites: www.cbse.gov.in; www.results.nic.in; www.results.digilocker.gov.in; and www.umang.gov.in. The documents can be accessed via Digilocker app.



Key resource: Water from the Cooum eventually reaches the Chembarambakkam reservoir, one of the city's major sources.

Sewage discharge into Cooum, groundwater depletion raise alarm

WATER WATCH

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

The mismatch between rapid urbanisation and lack of sufficient sewer infrastructure has threatened the relatively cleaner stretch of the Cooum river. Residents have raised concerns over persistent sewage pollution near the Puttur check dam, located 40 km from Chennai.

Residents of Manavala Nagar, Tiruvallur, said groundwater levels in the neighbourhood had taken a hit after portions of the riverbed were dried up for the construction of a bridge as part of the Chennai Peripheral Ring Road project.

Sewage pollution in the upper reaches of the river can also affect Chennai's water source, as water diverted through the Pudu-chattram and Korattur check dams eventually reaches the Chembarambakkam drinking water reservoir.

D. Anandakrishnan, a resident of Manavala Nagar, said "The entry of untreated sewage directly into the river, particularly near the dry riverbed, will worsen groundwater pollution and undermine efforts to store freshwater near check dams. We have been demanding that the dysfunctional Periyakupam sewage treatment plant be upgraded to handle growing volume of sewage generated."

The local body, which has sunk borewells along the river, also faced scarcity after water was pumped out for the bridge construction, he said.

Suresh Ramanathan, president, Manavala Nagar Residents Welfare Association, said, "Groundwater already depleted by a depth of 20 feet in areas such as Vengathur, Puttur, and Manavala Nagar after the riverbed was dried up for the work. Temporary storage structures should be built in the upstream or downstream portion of the river to store water and avert water scarcity in the localities."

Residents said several representations had been submitted seeking steps to arrest untreated sewage flow into the river.

Officials of the Water Resources Department said a joint inspection was recently conducted with the Municipal Administration and Water Supply Department and the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board. The team has suggested that the sewage treatment plant's capacity be increased to cater to the sewage generation of the rapidly urbanising Tiruvallur municipality.

While advanced soil biotechnology is being deployed to improve quality of treated sewage discharged into the river, the plant capacity was not adequate. A report suggesting measures to mitigate sewage pollution in the river has been submitted to the Tiruvallur local body and district administration, officials said.

Noting that the work for the Chennai Peripheral Ring Road project across the river portion would not adversely impact groundwater, an official said the contracting firm had been advised to build a temporary bund downstream of the work site.

RPF gets high-tech trike scooters for patrolling, crowd control

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Aimed at enhancing passenger safety, strengthening security, and promoting eco-friendly mobility solutions, the Railway Protection Force (RPF), Chennai

Division, has introduced two electric three-wheeler mobility scooters, or trikes, at the Chennai Central railway station.

These are designed to enhance the mobility and rapid response capability

of RPF personnel engaged in station patrolling, surveillance, and crowd management duties.

Advanced features

Equipped with advanced features such as a siren, public address system, ra-

dio frequency identification (RFID)-based ignition system, and GPS tracking facility, these vehicles will support efficient, technology-driven security operations.

An RPF officer said that with a maximum speed li-

mit of 15 kmph, the scooters would enable swift and effective patrolling of platforms and passenger concourses, particularly during peak hours. These would help the RPF staff cover all platforms with minimal fatigue.

As part of a phased expansion plan, similar scooters will soon be introduced at other high footfall stations in the Chennai Division, including Chennai Egmore, Tambaram, Arakonam, Chengalpattu, and Katpadi, the RPF said.

Experts discuss role of nurses, allied healthcare professionals in technology-driven world

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

At a recent webinar titled 'Allied Health and Nursing: Backbone of Modern Healthcare', Helen Shaji J.C., Dean of SRM College of Nursing, highlighted the surging demand for nursing professionals in India and overseas.

Dr. Shaji attributed this growth to the rising burden of chronic diseases, an ageing population, and the continuous expansion of hospital infrastructure, besides an acute shortage of healthcare workers globally.

The event was held on Monday, as part of the Future Career Conversations Series jointly organised by The Hindu and SRM Institute of Science and Technology. Dr. Shaji stressed the need for policy support for nurses, as the nurse-to-patient ratio is low in many institutions.

Training challenges

Mary Marjeri, Chief Nursing Officer at Naruvi Hospitals, Vellore, said that even as demand for nurses rises, there are training challenges that



must be addressed, especially in light of the integration of AI into healthcare. Nursing students struggle with skill gaps when entering the world, as do experienced nurses when they move into a high-technology environment.

She suggested that organisations must have a robust transition-to-practice programme that provides adequate mentorship to young nurses.

Allied health professionals, who provide diagnostic, technical, therapeutic, and rehabilitative care, play a vital role in maintaining a collaborative and multidisciplinary healthcare system, said D. Jagadeswaran, Dean, Allied Health Sciences, SRM Medical College Hospital & Research Centre, Chennai.

Dr. Jagadeswaran expanded on the various specialisations

in allied healthcare - such as medical laboratory and life sciences, trauma care, physiotherapy, occupational therapy, and community care.

He emphasised that allied healthcare professionals no longer don a supporting role in the medical ecosystem, but function as key players, thanks to various government initiatives.

Role of AI

Rashmi Shukla, Senior Scientist in the Division of Genetics, Department of Pediatrics at AIIMS, New Delhi, elaborated on the role of AI in allied healthcare. She said it empowers professionals by enhancing diagnosis, optimising personalised care, and predicting outcomes to improve overall access to healthcare.

She stressed the need for tech-driven education, iterating that it is not an attempt to replace professionals, but to ease fatigue by handing over repetitive workload to AI.

The session was moderated by Meenakshy S., Principal Correspondent, The Hindu.

Watch the webinar on <https://newsth.live/THSRMNY>

'Savukku' Shankar gets bail in attempt to murder case

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court has granted bail to YouTuber 'Savukku' Shankar, alias A. Shankar, 50, in an attempt-to-murder case registered against him after he allegedly pelted stones at the escort police personnel who accompanied him to Chennai pursuant to his arrest in Ongole, Andhra Pradesh, on April 8.

Justice L. Victoria Gowri granted the relief on the condition that the petitioner, after his release from prison, must appear before the Inspector of Puzhal police station every day until further orders.

He was further directed to cooperate with the investigation and appear for police inquiry as and when required.

THE HINDU
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OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

A. MALLICK BADSHA (88), Retired Press Aid, The Hindu, Chennai passed away on 13th May 2026. Address: 33/45, New Farrance Road, Dashedmakkan, Perambur Barracks, Chennai-600012. Contact: 9840442591

PROF. G RAJU MA, MSc, MEd, PhD
June 15 1932 to May 13 2026
With profound sorrow we announce the passing of a devoted husband, caring father and cherished patriarch of our family.
In Loving Memory
Kasthuri, Prabhakar, Mercy, Sudhakar, Maisy, Renuka, Murugesan, Manoj, Rohith, Namitha, Mehul and Joshika
Ph: 9847338825

DEATH

A.S. RAMACHANDRAN (108), Ex-General Manager, Simpson, passed away peacefully on 13.05.2026 at 7AM at his Residence 5/14, Arunachalam Road, Kotturpuram, Chennai - 85. Ph: 24472486. Surrounded by his family

Dr. J.M. Boopalaraj, MBBS, MD,
17 September 1939 - 13 May 2026
Retd. Professr and Head of Department Dermatology, Madras Medical College Chennai.
Funeral Mass at 3:00 pm
Santhome Cathedral Basilica, Chennai.

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FIRST ANNIVERSARY

SMT. N. VATSALA
M.Com Retd. DFC TNEB
(Wife of Late Shri L. Ethirajan)
14.05.2025 - Aged 85 Years
Fondly remembered by
Sons, Daughters - in law
and Grand children
98841 84667

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FIFTH ANNIVERSARY
R. VAITHIYANATHAN B.A. B.L.
Retd. Dy. Commissioner (C.T)
DOB: 14.12.1943 - DOD: 14.05.2021
--- Always in our Hearts ---
V. Shanthi, Dr. V. Malathi,
G. Lakshmiipathy IAS,
L. Sai Prashanth

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

39TH YEAR OF REMEMBRANCE
Shri ISARI VELAN
(Our Source of Inspiration)
DR. ISHARI K. GANESH
Founder & Chancellor, Vels University
Relatives, Friends & Staff
VELS
UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY & ADVANCED STUDIES (VSTU)
PILLAGARKOIL, THIRUVANANTHAPURAM, KERALA
A+ NAAC
1

HOMAGE

S RAMAN (1935-2015)
11th Anniversary
Shanta Raman (1938-2019)
7th Anniversary
Your presence filled our lives with warmth, wisdom & kindness. Deeply missed, forever cherished, and always remembered with love and gratitude.
Pushya, Suresh & Grandchildren

Rangasamy takes charge as Puducherry Chief Minister for a record fifth tenure

BJP Legislature Party leader Namassivayam, AINRC MLA Malladi Krishna Rao become Ministers in the second NDA govt.; CM signs files on 17 subjects on day one; extends health insurance coverage to APL families, approves setting up of 'Namo Cancer Hospital', allots land for IIT-Madras and JIPMER

The Hindu Bureau
PUDUCHERRY

N. Rangasamy, founder of the All India N.R. Congress (AINRC) and head of the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) in the Union Territory of Puducherry, was on Wednesday sworn in as the Puducherry Chief Minister for a record fifth time.

Lieutenant-Governor K. Kailashnathan administered the oaths of office and secrecy to Mr. Rangasamy at a ceremony held at the Lok Niwas. Along with Mr. Rangasamy, BJP Legislature Party leader A. Na-

massivayam and AINRC MLA Malladi Krishna Rao were sworn in as Ministers in the second NDA government in the Union Territory. After the ceremony, the Chief Minister visited the Assembly. He was given a guard of honour by the territorial police.

Thereafter, he took charge and signed files related to 17 subjects, including the approval for extension of the CM's health insurance scheme (coverage of ₹3 lakh) to above poverty line (APL) families, establishment of 'Namo Cancer Hospital' at the Indira Gandhi Government Medical College and Hospi-

tal, and land allotment to IIT-Madras and JIPMER.

BJP national president Nitin Nabin, national general secretary (organisation) B.L. Santhosh, party in-charge for the Union Territory Nirmal Kumar Surana, the MLAs-elect of the AINRC, the BJP, the DMK, the AIADMK, the Latchiya Jananayaga Katchi, the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, the Neyam Makkal Katchi, and Independents attended the swearing-in.

Chief Secretary Sharat Chauhan, Director-General of Police Shalini Singh, and senior officials were also present.



Historic return: Lieutenant Governor K. Kailashnathan administering the oath of office to N. Rangasamy as Chief Minister at the Lok Niwas in Puducherry on Wednesday. S.S.KUMAR

Vijay Narayan earns the rare distinction of being A-G under two different governments

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government on Wednesday appointed senior counsel Vijay Narayan as its Advocate General. With this, he earns the rare professional distinction of having served as the A-G of the State for the second time under two different governments.

Mr. Narayan had served as the top most law officer of the State for the first time during the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam regime between August 2017 and May 2021. After a gap of five years of Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam rule, he has returned to the office once again.

The new A-G is the nephew of former Attorney



Vijay Narayan

General K.K. Venugopal and grandson of M.K. Nambyar, a legendary lawyer acclaimed for his contribution towards development of constitutional law in the country. Mr. Narayan completed his graduation from Loyola College in 1977 and obtained a law degree from the Madras Law College in 1982.

Mr. Narayan had argued a wide variety of cases in-

cluding those on service law, labour law, constitutional law, administrative law, and commercial law. In consideration of his long standing practice in the Bar, the Madras High Court had designated him as a Senior Advocate in 2004.

He had conducted cases in the Supreme Court as well as several other High Courts. After Mr. Narayan had resigned his post in May 2021, he was succeeded by senior counsel R. Shunmugasundaram and P.S. Raman.

Mr. Raman had put in his papers on Tuesday immediately after returning from a family holiday in Colombo, and Mr. Narayan too cut short his visit to Portugal and returned to the country on Wednesday to accept the post.

Scrap NEET-based admissions, allow States to fill up medical seats, Vijay appeals to Centre

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday urged the Union government to cancel the NEET-based admissions in medical courses and to permit the respective States to fill up seats based on marks secured in Class 12.

“The Government of Tamil Nadu reiterates the State's long-pending demand to abolish NEET and permit the States to fill all seats under the State quota in MBBS, BDS, and AYUSH courses on the basis of Class 12 marks,” Mr. Vijay said.

Referring to the cancellations of the NEET, following investigations by law enforcement agencies into

the alleged leakage of the question paper, Mr. Vijay said: “This cancellation has shattered the hopes of lakhs of medical aspirants across the country.”

“This is not the first time the NEET has been compromised. In 2024, the question paper was leaked and FIRs were registered in six States and was transferred to the CBI. Pursuant to the directions of the Supreme Court, the Union government constituted a High-Level Committee of Experts under K. Radhakrishnan, former Chairman of ISRO, which submitted 95 comprehensive recommendations for reforms. Despite all this, within two years, another paper leak has occurred, and the examination has been cancelled. This is conclusive

proof of flaws and structural flaws in a national level exam.”

Pointing out that the Tamil Nadu government has been consistently and unanimously opposing the NEET since its very inception, Mr. Vijay said: “The introduction of NEET has severely disadvantaged the students from rural areas, government schools, Tamil medium backgrounds, and socio-economically disadvantaged families.”

The NEET-UG 2026 was conducted by the National Testing Agency on May 3, 2026, across 5,432 centres. In Tamil Nadu, the examination was held in 31 cities. A total of 22,05,035 candidates appeared for the examination, including 1.4 lakh candidates from Tamil Nadu.

INBRIEF



Senior IPS officer Asra Garg posted IGP Intelligence

Senior IPS officer and Inspector General of Police (IGP), North Zone, Asra Garg has been transferred and posted as IGP, Intelligence, Chennai. He replaces Avinash Kumar who has not been given a posting yet. Mr. Garg is a 2004-batch officer of the Indian Police Service. As IGP, South Zone, Mr. Garg supervised the security arrangements for major events, including the sensitive *Thevar Jayanthi* and Immanuel Sekaran anniversaries. In the North Zone, Mr. Garg took stringent action against drug peddlers and also conducted financial investigations to seize and attach their assets procured with the proceeds of crime. Mr. Garg also served in the Central Bureau of Investigation, Delhi, and as Additional Commissioner of Police, Greater Chennai Police.

Udhayachandran to assume office as CMD of TNIICL

Senior IAS officer T. Udhayachandran is set to assume office as the Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Tamil Nadu Industrial Investment Corporation Limited (TNIICL). Mr. Udhayachandran was until Tuesday the Finance Secretary. A G.O. issued by Chief Secretary M. Sai Kumar also posted Darez Ahamed as the Secretary of the Health and Family Welfare Department and Mariam Pallavi Baldev as the Secretary of the Social Welfare and Women Empowerment Department. Kumar Jayant would assume office as the Chairman and Managing Director of the Tamil Nadu Newsprint and Papers Limited. Anu George was posted as the Secretary of the Animal Husbandry, Dairying and Fisheries and Fishermen Welfare Department.

S.N. Narain assumes charge as CPRO for Southern Railway

S.N. Narain assumed charge as the Chief Public Relations Officer (CPRO) of Southern Railway on Wednesday. He succeeds K. Senthamil Selvan, who has now been posted as the Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer of the Royapuram Electric Loco Shed. He has served in various capacities in operations and commercial wings across different Divisions of Southern Railway.

Palaniswami sacks 26 district secretaries

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Wednesday dismissed 26 rebel district secretaries.

Of the ousted functionaries, 12 are currently legislators of the party. They are Natham R. Viswanathan, S.P. Velumani, C.Ve. Shanmugam, R. Kamaraj, C. Vijayabaskar, K.P. Anbalagan, K.C. Veeramani, Esakki Subaya, M.R. Vijayabhaskar, P. Balakrishna Reddy, A. Arunmozhithe-

van and S.M. Sukumar.

Mr. Palaniswami appointed 14 new district secretaries and restructured some district units with nine new office-bearers. Among those appointed are former Minister Dindigul C. Sreenivasan (Dindigul-east), R. Rajendran (Cuddalore-south), former MP C. Sivasami (Tiruppur-suburban) and former MLA V.P.B. Paramasivam (Dindigul-west).

Later, Mr. Shanmugam questioned Mr. Palaniswami's authority to remove the district secretaries.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

ई-निविदा आमन्त्रण सूचना

मंडल रेल प्रबन्धक, इंजीनियरिंग, उत्तर पश्चिम रेलवे, जोधपुर द्वारा भारत के राष्ट्रपति के लिये एवं उनकी ओर से ई-निविदा के माध्यम से प्रचलित नियमों के अन्तर्गत विधित्त प्रपत्रों में निविदा निम्न कार्यों के लिए क्रमानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है- ई-निविदा सूचना सं. : 35of2026-27 कार्य का नाम व स्थान : Zone Contract (Masonry, Painting & Road Work) Zone-1:- Residential Buildings in the section of SSE/PW/PLCJ & SSE/PW/JSM under ADEN/JSM/JU .for the year 2026-27 & Year 2027-28. अनुमानित लागत रुपये : 7,31,99,681.20 बयाने की राशि रुपये : 14,64,000.00 ई-निविदा सूचना सं. : 36of2026-27 कार्य का नाम व स्थान : Zone Contract (Masonry, Painting & Road Work) Zone-2:- Service Buildings in the section of SSE/PW/PLCJ & SSE/PW/JSM under ADEN/JSM/JU .for the year 2026-27 & Year 2027-28. अनुमानित लागत रुपये : 99,99,911.90 बयाने की राशि रुपये : 2,00,000.00 ई-निविदा सूचना सं. : 37of2026-27 कार्य का नाम व स्थान : Zone Contract (Water supply) Zone-3:- Supply of potable sweet drinking water to P.Way Gangs staff quarters stations and L-Xing's in the section of SSE/PW/PLCJ & SSE/PW/JSM under ADEN/JSM/JU .for the year 2026-27 & Year 2027-28. अनुमानित लागत रुपये : 1,61,99,999.92 बयाने की राशि रुपये : 3,24,000.00 ई-निविदा सूचना सं. : 39of2026-27 कार्य का नाम व स्थान : Secondary TSR of loop lines & Deep screening of loop line in BGKT and JU yard in the section of SSE/PW/JU under ADEN/Line of Jodhpur division. अनुमानित लागत रुपये : 7,89,11,007.82 बयाने की राशि रुपये : 15,78,200.00 निविदा सूचना संख्या 35 to 37 of 2026-27 & 39 of 2026-27 निविदा प्रस्तुत करने की तिथि 01.06.2026 को 15:00 बजे तक है। वेबसाइट का विवरण जहाँ पर ई-निविदा देखी व मरी जा सकती है www.jreps.gov.in 698-DI/26 Follow us on [f](#) [t](#) [in](#) [whatsapp](#) [youtube](#)

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CHANGE OF NAME

PERSONAL
OLD AGE HOME

I, **VASANTHI S.** D/o Sivasankaran G, W/o Namassivayam K, Date of Birth: 21.11.1971, Place of Birth: Tuticorin, residing at House No.9B4, Jains insell Park, Rajiv Gandhi Road, Padur Village, Thiruppur Taluk, Chengalpattu District - 603103, Shall henceforth be known as **VASANTHI N**

I, **RAJAN.** S/o. A.John Wesley, residing at No.54, Nehruji Jothi Nagar, Ayanavaram, Chennai-600 023, have changed my name to Raja Freeman. J forever vide affidavit dated 12.05.26 sworn before Notary Public, Chennai and I will be known as Raja Freeman.J for all purposes.

I, **G.JAYASHRI.** W/o.Vinoth, aged about 28 years, residing at No.2/ 418, AF 3 A-Block, Dhakshina Devesh Apartments, Samayapuram Main Road, Samayapuram Nagar, Porur, Chennai - 600 116, Henceforth be known as **JAYASHRI.G** vide affidavit dated 11/05/2026

I, **SAROJ JAIN** W/o. Ashok Kumar Jain R/o. 4K, 1st floor Prof Subramaniam Street, Kilpauk Chennai-600010 do hereby state that my old name as mentioned in my Aadhar is Saroj Jain, but my correct name is Saroj A Jain as per affidavit dated 13.05.2026

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Inauguration by
Lion Mr. D. Duraimurugan
Chairman and Managing Director RR Group of Companies, Kolathur.

Lighting of the Lamp by
Mr. K.M. Murali & Mrs. K. Sunitha
Balaji Decors, Kolathur.

First Purchase by
Mr. T. Ravi
State President, Federation of All Traders Associations of Tamil Nadu, Kolathur.

First Purchase Received by
Mr. S.V. Ramanan
President, Kolathur Sand Lorry Owners Association, Lakshimpuram, Kolathur.

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INBRIEF



Sustained effort needed to end alcoholism: Sowmiya

PMK legislator Sowmiya Anbumani said a sustained effort was needed to end alcoholism in the State. Welcoming the closure of 717 Tasmac shops, she said that whenever one shop closed, a few others opened. Women were afraid to cross Tasmac shops as they feared for their safety, she said. She also sought a separate DGP for women’s safety. When she spoke, Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay jotted down her remarks. She also urged the Chief Minister to ensure a drug- and alcohol-free State for generations to come.

Rebel leaders engaged in deep discussion during EPS’ speech

When AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami was speaking in the Assembly, rebel leader C.Ve. Shanmugam called C. Vijayabaskar, who went to his place and spoke to him for some time. Later, when Mr. Palaniswami was about to end his speech and Mr. Velumani was getting ready to speak, Mr. Shanmugam went to Mr. Vijayabaskar’s place and spoke to him in confidence.

Assembly adjourned *sine die* after vote of confidence

After the C. Joseph Vijay-led Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam government won the vote of confidence and Mr. Vijay delivered his reply in the Assembly, Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar adjourned the House *sine die*. The motion, moved by the Leader of the House, K.A. Sengottaiyan, was passed.

DMK boycotts confidence motion; asks CM to continue Dravidian model schemes

Opposition leader Udhayanidhi Stalin accuses TVK govt. of conspiring with corrupt elements; says people are losing faith in it; he asks Vijay to ‘rule the State for real, not through reels on Instagram’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin led his party MLAs on a boycott of the confidence motion moved by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, and staged a walkout from the Assembly on Wednesday.

In his speech, Mr. Udhayanidhi said that out of 4,93,25,000 votes, the TVK had polled only 1.72 crore, and the remaining voters, constituting 65% of the electorate, had rejected the party.

Though the Communist parties, the VCK and the IUML had extended their support to prevent President’s rule, they had clearly stated that they remained in the Secular Progressive Alliance led by the DMK, he said.

As the leader of an Opposition party, he had the responsibility to lay out what transpired in the last 10 days, he said. “You got the mandate claiming to be secular, but already you have co-opted an MLA who fought on the ideologically opposite NDA ticket without the knowledge of his party chief,” he said.

“Then, the AIADMK, the big party in the NDA, split. One faction has offered support to this govern-



Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin addressing the media at the Secretariat on Wednesday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

ment,” he said. “An incident that happened next is the latest twist. One new sofa goes to one of the factional leaders’ house. The new Chief Minister follows the sofa. There is nothing new to this government. On the contrary, your rule is like what we see in the movie *Pushpa*. During elections, you called them corrupt forces, and now, you are being questioned on social media as to what kind of government would join forces with corrupt elements. Is this your clean government?” Mr. Udhayanidhi said.

The present drama had surpassed what transpired in Koovathur, and the new government’s actions raised suspicion among the people, he said. After borrowing MLAs, the Chief

Minister, realising that he was not in a position to fulfil all his fake promises, was diverting public attention by blaming the previous DMK government, he added.

As the public had already begun regretting electing the TVK to power, the DMK MLAs would boycott the trust vote to reflect the public sentiment, he said.

Asking the Chief Minister to continue the welfare schemes introduced by the previous DMK government for all sections of society, he said: “Rule the State for real and not through reels on Instagram.”

‘Dangerous precedent’ Earlier, DMDK general secretary Premallatha Vijayakant warned the government against setting a

dangerous precedent of horse-trading in the State. Later, she walked out with DMK MLAs.

MMK leader M.H. Jawahirullah urged the new government to continue the nine schemes introduced by the previous DMK government in the education sector. Along with him, MJK leader M. Thamimur Ansari and KDMK leader K. Nithyanandam staged a walkout.

The Congress and DMK allies reaffirmed their support for the government.

Congress Legislature Party leader S. Rajesh Kumar said the confidence motion presented the parties with a historic responsibility to restore public faith in the Constitution, secularism, and social justice.

CPI(M) floor leader R. Chellaswamy said the election outcome indicated that the people had rejected divisive forces.

VCK floor leader Vanni Arasu hoped that the new government would complete its full term with the support of secular parties.

IUML floor leader A.M. Shahjahan said his party backed the TVK to prevent indirect rule by the BJP.

CPI floor leader T. Ramachandran said the Chief Minister should vehemently oppose divisive forces.

Rebel MLAs were promised Cabinet berths for backing TVK govt., says EPS

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Wednesday said he had information that some AIADMK MLAs were promised berths in the Cabinet and postings as the heads of various boards and corporations for backing the ruling TVK.

His speech in the Assembly during the discussion on the confidence motion moved by the TVK government led by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay assumes significance against the backdrop of a split in the AIADMK Legislature Party. As many as 25 rebel MLAs, headed by S.P. Velumani, supported the motion, while 22 others, led by Mr. Palaniswami, voted against it.

“The AIADMK MLAs were elected only after meeting the people and seeking their support in the name of MGR [M.G. Ramachandran] and *Amma* [Jayalalithaa]. A total of 47 MLAs have been elected on behalf of the party. I have been functioning as the general secretary. It is quite common in any party to have differences of opinion. In such a situation, how is it fair for the Chief Minister to get the support of one group? This should not become a wrong precedent. It will lead to horse-trading. When we met the

people during the election, we sought their mandate on the promise that the AIADMK-led alliance would win and the AIADMK would form the government,” Mr. Palaniswami said.

“All the 47 MLAs were elected on the ‘Two Leaves’ symbol. The people voted for them, believing that they would ensure the formation of an AIADMK government,” he added.

He said all the AIADMK members in the Assembly would vote against the motion. When Mr. Palaniswami completed his speech, Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar called Mr. Velumani to speak on the motion. However, the AIADMK MLAs backing Mr. Palaniswami strongly objected to it. They questioned the basis on which Mr. Velumani was being allowed to speak when Mr. Palaniswami had spoken on behalf of the party. But the Speaker said it was up to him to decide who should speak.

Mr. Velumani said the AIADMK rebel MLAs would vote in favour of the motion. He urged the Chief Minister to continue the welfare measures implemented when Jayalalithaa was the Chief Minister. “The people of Tamil Nadu have reposed faith in the Chief Minister. We [the rebel MLAs] are not vying for any post,” he said.

AIADMK legislature party splits vertically during trust vote in Tamil Nadu Assembly

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The AIADMK witnessed a vertical split during the trust vote on the floor of the Assembly. A total of 25 MLAs led by S.P. Velumani voted in favour of the confidence motion moved by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, while 22 MLAs led by AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami voted against it.

When Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar called for a division vote, the 47 AIADMK MLAs were clearly divided in their positions.

The MLAs who voted in favour of the motion are G. Hari (Tiruttani), Maragatham Kumaravel (Maduran-



Edappadi K. Palaniswami speaking during the floor test in the Assembly on Wednesday.

takam (SC)), S.M. Sukumar (Arcot), K.C. Veeramani (Jolarpet), P. Balakrishna-reddy (Hosur), K.P. Anbalagan (Palacodu), Maragatham Vetrivel (Pappireddippatti), C.Ve. Shanmugam (Mailam), R.

Rakesh (Sankarapuram), S. Sekar (Paramathi-Velur), P. Sathyabama (Dharapuram (SC)), N.S.N. Nataraj (Kangayam), S. Jayakumar (Perundurai), P. Haribaskar (Anthiyur), S.P. Velumani (Thondamuthur), K. Ravi-manoharan (Palani), Natham R. Viswanathan (Natham), M.R. Vijayabhaskar (Karur), Leemarose Martin (Lalgudi), K. Mohan (Panruti), A. Arunmozhihevan (Bhuvanagiri), R. Kamaraj (Nannilam), C. Vijayabaskar (Viralimalai), Dhilipan Jaishankar (Sankarankovil (SC)), and Esakki Subbaya (Ambasamudram).

The MLAs who voted against the motion are E. Rajasekar (Cheyyur (SC)), D. Velazhagan (Anaikattu),

E.C. Govindarasan (Bargur), V. Sampathkumar (Harur (SC)), S. Velu (Chengam (SC)), S. Ramachandran (Kilpennathur), Agri S.S. Krishnamurthy (Kala-sapakkam), L. Jayasudha (Arani), Mukkur N. Subramanian (Cheyyar), S. Palanisamy (Tirukkoyilur), A. Nallathambi (Gangavalli (SC)), A.P. Jayasankaran (Attur (SC)), P. Usharani (Yercaud (ST)), R. Mani (Omalar), G. Venkatachalam (Mettur), Edappadi K. Palaniswami (Edappadi), S. Vetrivel (Sankari), K.C. Karuppanan (Bhavani), S. Rajendran (Ariyalur), R. Rajendran (Neyveli), O.S. Manian (Vedaranyam), and N. Thalavai Sundaram (Kanniyakumari).

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Former Law Minister and rebel AIADMK leader C.Ve. Shanmugam on Wednesday defended his faction’s support for the TVK regime.

The AIADMK was established to oppose the DMK, and this was the main objective of the TVK too, he said. “This is why we are favouring this regime. There is no other motive behind our support to the government,” Mr. Shanmugam told reporters outside his office.

Reiterating his group’s opposition to any AIADMK-DMK tie-up, Mr. Shanmugam said the AIADMK had



C.Ve. Shanmugam and S.P. Velumani in the Assembly on Wednesday. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

been suffering electoral setbacks since 2019 and, so far, Mr. Palaniswami had refused to own up to the defeats. On the contrary, when Jayalalithaa lost the election in 1996, she went on the record, acknow-

ledging her responsibility for the setback, he said.

Apart from Mr. Palaniswami, others too were equally responsible for the spate of defeats, he said, adding, “Let us all collectively own up.”

Mr. Shanmugam also claimed that Mr. Palaniswami had turned down the idea of making VCK founder Thol. Thirumavalavan the Chief Minister (with support from the AIADMK and the DMK).

Emphasising that there was an “unimaginable opportunity” for Tamil Nadu to have a Chief Minister from the Scheduled Castes, Mr. Shanmugam said, “This was what was discussed in our last meeting

with him [Mr. Palaniswami]. However, the AIADMK chief had said, “Either I would become Chief Minister, or let us all sit in the Opposition benches,” Mr. Shanmugam said.

Former Minister S.P. Velumani called for the re-induction of former party leaders such as V.K. Sasikala and T.T.V. Dhinakaran into the AIADMK. Stressing the need for reforms in the party, he conceded that Mr. Palaniswami remained the general secretary. “Our plea to him is to have a discussion on the reasons for the defeats of the party at the hustings. Let him not throw out any more persons from the organisation,” he said.

Govt. revokes order posting astrologer as aide to Vijay

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government on Wednesday revoked the appointment of astrologer Rickey Radhan Pandit Vetrivel as the Officer on Special Duty (Political) to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay. The decision followed criticism from various quarters, including in the Assembly earlier in the day.

The government on Tuesday appointed Mr. Vetrivel to the post. The appointment drew severe criticism, even from allies of the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK). DMDK general secretary Premallatha Vijayakant, too, opposed the decision in the Assembly on Wednesday.

SC stays ‘atrocious’ HC order restraining TVK MLA from casting vote in floor test

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday termed a Madras High Court intervention barring TVK MLA R. Sreenivasa Sethupathi from casting his vote in the floor test on May 13 ‘atrocious’.

The top court stayed the operation of the High Court order, thereby allowing Mr. Sethupathi to participate in the confidence motion for the new TVK-led government on the floor of the House.

A Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta also stayed the proceedings before the High Court. “This is atrocious, to say the least. The High Court knows and says in the order that the remedy lies in an election petition, and yet entertains a writ



R. Sreenivasa Sethupathi

petition under Article 226?” Justice Mehta said, addressing senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi, appearing for Mr. Sethupathi’s rival and DMK candidate from the No. 185 Tiruppattur Assembly constituency, K.R. Periakaruppan.

Senior advocate A.M. Singhvi, appearing for Mr. Sethupathi, the petitioner, said the top court should pass strictures against the order passed by the High Court on May 12.

Justice Nath said this issue would be considered in the final hearing.

The Bench issued notice to Mr. Periakaruppan and other respondents, including the Tamil Nadu Chief Electoral Officer.

‘Does not matter’ Mr. Rohatgi sought, and was allowed, two weeks to file his counter to the petition. He said the case did not matter any longer, as the DMK had already decided to walk out of the trust vote.

Mr. Singhvi questioned the haste shown by the High Court Bench headed by Justice L. Victoria Gowri to hear the writ petition filed by Mr. Periakaruppan, a former Minister, on a Sunday, “that too for two whole hours”.

Mr. Rohatgi argued there was nothing wrong

in holding a special hearing, considering the urgency of the issue.

“This court has held a midnight hearing for Yakub Memon... I have appeared in special sittings on weekends so many times,” he said.

Justice Nath said the court did not care for or differentiate between one political party and the other, be it “DMK, AIADMK, TVK or BJP”.

“We are only bothered about the legality of this High Court order,” Justice Nath said.

Mr. Periakaruppan lost the constituency to Mr. Sethupathi by a margin of a single vote in the April 23 elections. While Mr. Periakaruppan, a former State Minister, secured 83,364 votes, Mr. Sethupathi got one more vote to finish with a tally of 83,365.

Stalin condemns ‘purchase’ of legislators from AIADMK

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin has accused those who came to power promising “clean politics” of practising “dirty politics”, with reference to the split in the AIADMK.

In a statement, Mr. Stalin noted that DMK members boycotted the vote of confidence, in line with the party’s stance that it would not be an obstacle to the formation of the TVK government.

Furthermore, he said, “Members of our alliance parties – Premallatha Vijayakant, Jawahirullah, Thamimur Ansari, and Nithyanandam – also staged a walkout. Alliance parties such as the Communist Party of India



M.K. Stalin

(Marxist), Indian Union Muslim League, and Viduthalaai Chiruthaigal Katchi voted in favour of the government to ensure that President’s rule is not imposed in Tamil Nadu. We respect their decision as well.”

“However, the TVK engaged in activities that shattered the trust of everyone who paved the way for this government to be

formed. Even though the numbers required for the government to remain stable were available due to the stance of the DMK’s alliance partners, they have ‘purchased’ members from the AIADMK, thereby splitting it,” he said.

“If your beginning is like this, how will the end be? The people are also going to see what ‘return gift’ you are going to give to those members of the split AIADMK. As far as the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam is concerned, it will continue to remain firm on its principles, and function as a constructive Opposition party,” Mr. Stalin said.

His statement came after the government’s motion of confidence was passed in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly on May 13.

Protection to religion not just for ‘essential practices’, says Centre

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Constitution presumes that every religious practice is protected unless it violates public order, morality, and health, the Centre told the Supreme Court on Wednesday.

Appearing before a nine-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant in the Sabarimala review hearing, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said the protection afforded to religion was not restricted to “essential religious practices” alone, but had a wider ambit.

Mr. Mehta, who opened the rejoinder in the constitutional reference hearing, said the burden was on the challenger to show that a religious practice breached public order, morality, and health.

He further submitted that fundamental rights in the Constitution have been interpreted expansively by the court in the past. Only Article 25 (right to religion and freedom of conscience) and Article 26 (freedom of denominations or any section thereof to manage their own religious affairs) were given restrictive meanings by the court. “Articles 25 and 26 were the only fundamental rights the court gave restricted meanings, saying the rights would be protected to the extent of ‘essential religious practices’ only,” Mr. Mehta submitted.

He pointed out that the phrase ‘essential religious practices’ is absent in the



text of the Constitution, arguing that it was sheer judicial creativity at work.

Interconnected rights

Mr. Mehta added that Articles 25 and 26 are interconnected, not isolated silos, submitting that an individual’s freedom of conscience and the right of a denomination to manage its own affairs are interconnected. Article 26 is only a manifestation of the individual right in a collective form, he said.

“Fundamental rights are not islands,” he said.

The full day hearing also saw the Supreme Court observe that people need not go to a temple to be religious. A small lamp lit in a hut was an equally poignant expression of faith, Chief Justice Kant said.

Justice B.V. Nagarathna added Hinduism was a way of life, and did not depend on ritualistic practices or frequent visits to temples.

Legal scholar and former director of the National Judicial Academy, Mohan Gopal, submitted that what Justice Nagarathna referred to was called ‘auto-theism’ or the individual freedom of conscience to explore one’s own inner conscience.

Congress defers Kerala CM announcement once again

Meeting between Rahul and Kharge ends without declaration; supporters gather before houses of the three CM contenders in anticipation of decision; MLAs-elect summoned to Indira Bhavan today

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Congress high command has deferred announcing the party’s Chief Minister designate for Kerala, ostensibly until Thursday.

The test of nerves centred on the Congress’s so far unsettled leadership question in Kerala, despite a historic win in the Assembly polls, appeared set to go down to the wire with a high-level meeting between Leader of the Opposition in Parliament Rahul Gandhi and Congress national president Mallikarjun Kharge in the latter’s residence in New Delhi on Wednesday ending without an announcement.

The anticipation for the



On tenterhooks: Workers wait outside KPCC headquarters Indira Bhavan in Thiruvananthapuram on Wednesday. NIRMAL HARINDRAN

momentous proclamation from New Delhi appeared to reach a feverish pitch in Kerala, with sizeable crowds of Congress workers congregating outside the residences of the three top contenders for the post – All India Congress Committee general secretary K.C. Venugopal, senior

leader Ramesh Chennithala in Alappuzha, and former Leader of the Opposition V.D. Satheesan at Paravur in Ernakulam.

A KPCC insider, citing media reports that Mr. Venugopal was party to the summit meeting, said the high command seemed to be attempting to take the

Congress Legislature Party into confidence in a bid to strike a middle ground between the respective factions. Notably, the high command has summoned the Congress MLAs-elect to Indira Bhavan in Thiruvananthapuram today.

Raging group war

Meanwhile, anonymous posters condemning Mr. Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, MP, for allegedly supporting Mr. Venugopal appeared in the latter’s constituency in Wayanad.

At Kottoor in Kozhikode, the Congress ward committee threatened to quit en masse if the high command pushed ahead with Mr. Venugopal’s candidature.

POCSO case: Minister’s son skips summons

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Even as Bandi Sai Bhagirth, son of Union Minister of State for Home Affairs Bandi Sanjay Kumar, failed to appear for questioning in connection with a case registered against him under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, several women protested outside the Petbasheerabad police station in Hyderabad on Wednesday.

Women from various or-

Several women protest outside police station demanding justice in the case

ganisations gathered near the station with flags, banners and placards demanding justice in the case. Police were seen controlling the crowd amid heavy security arrangements.

A similar protest had been staged by women’s groups on Sunday.

The Cyberabad Police had, on Tuesday, served him a notice directing to appear before investigators at the Petbasheerabad police station by 2 p.m. on Wednesday. The accused, however, had not arrived at the police station as of 2.05 p.m., effectively missing the first summons issued by the police.

Lookout posters

He has approached the Telangana High Court seeking anticipatory bail in the case registered on May 8

following allegations of sexual assault on a 17-year-old girl.

With the probe intensifying, the Cyberabad Police have dispatched multiple teams to New Delhi and Karimnagar in search of the accused, who has remained absconding for the past five days.

Meanwhile, posters urging the public to alert the nearest police station if they had information about his whereabouts surfaced in the Serilingampally and Gachibowli areas.

Karnataka students can wear ‘limited’ faith markers

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Karnataka government on Wednesday withdrew the 2022 order on dress code in educational institutions and replaced it with a fresh order allowing students to wear “limited” traditional and faith-based symbols along with prescribed uniforms, announced Minister for School Education and Literacy Madhu Bangarappa.

Wednesday’s order revokes the previous BJP government’s directive, which had required students to wear prescribed uniforms and had become the basis for restrictions that later triggered the hijab row.

Water woes, overcrowding in hostels trigger NLSIU protest

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

After months of complaints against water shortage, power cuts and overcrowding in hostels, students of the National Law School of India University (NLSIU) began protests on the campus.

The students first staged a protest around 10 p.m. on Tuesday at the basketball court. They protested again on Wednesday from 1 p.m. at the professors’ mess, and later at 3 p.m. at the amphitheatre, alleging that their repeated complaints were not addressed by administration. Students told *The Hindu* that the protest was not triggered by a sudden disruption, but by “frustration over long-pending issues”.



Students of NLSIU Bengaluru stage a protest on the campus on Tuesday night.

A common concern was the irregular water supply in hostels. They said taps in bathrooms would go dry abruptly. Even coolers did not have drinking water at times.

Students also alleged overcrowding, particularly in women’s hostels. A final-year student said that while men’s hostels had 18

bunk beds, women’s hostels had 93. In some hostel blocks, they said, 36 women share three toilets.

A final year student said that despite the university being one of the premier institutions, students are forced to live in inhuman conditions. Students questioned the state of hostel infrastructure despite the “high fees” charged by the government-run university. Annual fees range between ₹4.5 lakh and ₹5 lakh, with over ₹1.2 lakh going towards hostel accommodation, they said.

The protesting students said the Registrar and the Vice Chancellor visited them around 4 p.m., heard their concerns and left shortly. However, they did not speak to the students, they said.

24 children allege torture at Karnataka madrasa; FIR filed

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The rescue of 24 runaway minors from a madrasa in Tumakuru in Karnataka has led to the registration of an FIR against the institution’s management over allegations of torture, forced labour, and harassment of students.

According to a complaint filed by Nagabhushan C., an official attached to the District Child Protection Unit and Child Helpline, Kengeri, on April 19, as many as 24 children escaped from a madrasa, identified as Jamia Arabia Hasaniya Trust.

They were later rescued at the KSR Bengaluru Rail-

The minors say they were beaten, served worm-infested rice and forced to work at construction site

way Station by Railway Protection Force personnel and volunteers. Subsequently, the children were produced before officials of the District Child Protection Unit and the Child Welfare Committee for counselling and care.

The students, aged between nine and 17 and hailing from Bihar, told the welfare committee that they were served worm-infested rice, forced to work as construction labourers

within the madrasa premises, and beaten if they asked to see their parents.

They said they fled owing to the physical assault, harassment, and ill-treatment by staff members of the madrasa.

The complaint states that, the children were unwilling to return to the institution, and wanted to go back to their parents and native places.

Following directions from officials and members of the Child Welfare Committee, a formal complaint was lodged seeking legal action against the madrasa management for allegedly subjecting children to cruelty and engaging them in labour work.

Dead person ‘signs’ two land deals in Karnataka

The Hindu Bureau
BELAGAVI

Deputy Commissioner Mohammad Roshan has issued an order staying the registration of a land deal in Belagavi, Karnataka, following allegations of irregularities. He also recommended the suspension of two sub-registrars responsible for registering it.

The action comes after a family complained that fraudsters had fudged records to claim that a long-dead relative had registered the deal. The Belagavi District Brahmin Samaj Trust also raised complaints over the issue.

CENTRAL RAILWAY VARIOUS WORKS

For & on behalf of President of India, Dy. Chief Engineer (Bridge Line) HQ @ Central Railway, G. M. Building, 2nd Floor, CSMT Mumbai-400 001 invites e-bids at e-Procurement website, “<http://www.ireps.gov.in>” for the following work. **Sr.No. 1. Tender Notice No. & date:** CR-BR 022026-27, dated 11.05.2026 **Name of work:** Epoxy based painting and repairs of PSC Bridges, Br. No. 42/1 UP & DN on MNKD-PNVL and Raoli Junction flyover (Bridge No 10/2) in VDRL-MM chord section of Mumbai division. **Approx cost of work in Rs.:** Rs. 1,40,59,363.63/- **EMD Rs.:** Rs. 2,81,200/- **Completion period:** 09 months (excluding monsoon) **Sr.No. 2. Tender Notice No. & date:** CR-BR 032026-27, dated 11.05.2026 **Name of work:** Improvement of structural life of Track Girder Bridge by Sandblasting & Metallizing of Wadibunder Viaduct Bridge on CSMT-CLA(HB) Line. **Approx cost of work in Rs.:** Rs. 1,84,40,918.24/- **EMD Rs.:** Rs. 3,68,800/- **Completion period:** 09 months (excluding monsoon) **Sr.No. 3. Tender Notice No. & date:** CR-BR 042026-27, dated 11.05.2026 **Name of work:** Improvement in structural life bridge by sandblasting and metallizing of Wardha Bridge Up & Dn line Br. No 727/1 & Bhore Br. UP Rd., Br.No.774/2 in BD-NGP section of Nagpur Division. **Approx cost of work in Rs.:** Rs. 84,16,745.70/- **EMD Rs.:** Rs. 1,68,300/- **Completion period:** 06 months (excluding monsoon) **Sr.No. 4. Tender Notice No. & date:** CR-BR 052026-27, dated 11.05.2026 **Name of work:** Conventional painting of TGB’s & ROB’s in PA-MRJ-KOP, DD-MMR, ANG-BEED & LNL-PA section of Pune Division,(28 bridges) **Approx cost of work in Rs.:** Rs. 73,74,748.52/- **EMD Rs.:** Rs. 1,47,500/- **Completion period:** 06 months (excluding monsoon) **Date & Time of closing:** 03.06.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. **1. Complete information of above e-tender notice is available on website “<http://www.ireps.gov.in>”.** 2. Bids other than in the form of e-bids shall not be accepted against the above Tender. **3. Tender documents and corrigendum issued from time to time are available on the website at least 14 days in advance of opening tender and may be seen on this website.** [148] **Travel safely, Avoid footboard travelling**

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No. 1384 Date. 13/05/26

FACULTY RECRUITMENT NOTICE

Applications are invited, in online mode, from eligible candidates to fill up regular posts of Assistant Professor, Associate Professor and Professor in the Departments of Anthropology, Biotechnology, Botany, Chemistry, Commerce, Computer Science & MCA, Economics, Education & B.Ed, English, Geology, History, Mathematics & Statistics, Odia, Physics, Political Science, Zoology at Khallikote Unitary University, Berhampur.

Detailed advertisements will be available on the University website <https://kuu.ac.in> as well as on the HIMS Portal <https://himsrecruitment.odisha.gov.in/home> from 22.05.2026. The application process shall be conducted entirely in online mode through the HIMS Portal <https://himsrecruitment.odisha.gov.in/home> from **22.05.2026 to 22.06.2026 (11.59 PM)**. After submitting the application online, a printout of the same, along with all supporting documents duly self-attested by the applicant, must be sent to the “Registrar, Khallikote Unitary University, Berhampur, Ganjam, Odisha, Pin-760001” **by Speed Post only** so as to reach the office **on or before 30.06.2026 by 05.30 PM**.

For details of vacant Posts, essential qualifications, other terms and conditions, please visit the University website <https://kuu.ac.in> and for application visit HIMS Portal <https://himsrecruitment.odisha.gov.in/home>.

REGISTRAR
11001/50/2627 OIPR-11001/11125/1/26-27/0003

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar
Bengaluru - 560 009. Phone No. 080-22265383, website: www.kiadb.in

IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-14/1171/2026-27 Date: 13.05.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Item rate Tenders under two cover system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors (Civil) who have got adequate financial resources & sufficient past experience for the following works as per the schedule given below:

Name of the Work : 1) Providing and laying of Effluent Network at Adinarayanahosahalli Industrial Area Phase-2, Doddaballapura & Devanahalli Taluk, Bengaluru Rural District. 2) Providing and laying of Domestic Sewage Network at Adinarayanahosahalli Industrial Area Phase-2, Doddaballapura & Devanahalli Taluk, Bengaluru Rural District. 3) Providing and laying of Effluent Network at Devanahalli General Industrial Area, Doddaballapura & Devanahalli Taluk, Bengaluru Rural District. 4) Providing and laying of Domestic Sewage Network at Devanahalli General Industrial Area, Doddaballapura & Devanahalli Taluk, Bengaluru Rural District.

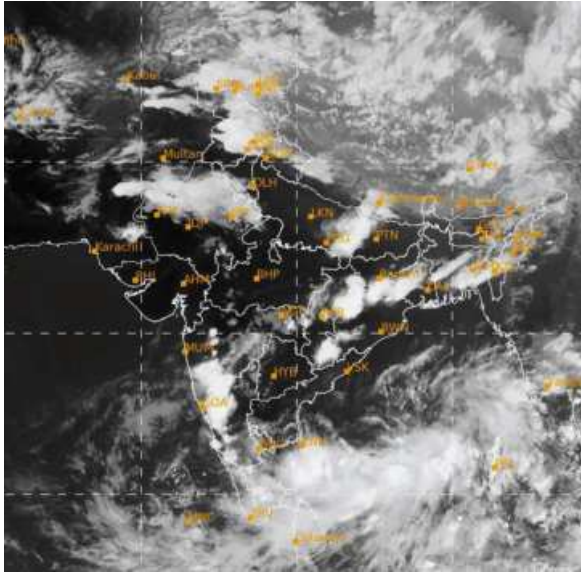
The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **05.06.2026 upto 4.00 pm.**
Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer-1, KIADB Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/645/Zen/2026-27

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Kerala and Andaman & Nicobar Islands. Heat wave/severe heat wave conditions likely at isolated places over Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala.....		34.3.....	24.9	Kozhikode.....		6.....	34.6.....
Ahmedabad.....		44.1.....	29.5	Kurnool.....		42.0.....	28.1
Aizawl.....		31.6.....	19.9	Lucknow.....		38.1.....	27.4
Allahabad.....		43.5.....	29.0	Madurai.....	0.5.....	35.0.....	26.6
Bengaluru.....		34.2.....	24.0	Mangaluru.....	23.....	33.2.....	22.5
Bhopal.....		43.2.....	29.2	Mumbai.....		34.2.....	28.6
Bhubaneswar.....		37.3.....	25.6	Mysuru.....		34.0.....	22.0
Chandigarh.....		38.6.....	23.0	New Delhi.....		39.2.....	26.4
Chennai.....		36.7.....	27.6	Patna.....		35.3.....	25.0
Coimbatore.....		34.2.....	23.6	Port Blair.....	22.....	30.0.....	25.1
Dehradun.....	0.8.....	35.1.....	20.8	Puducherry.....		35.6.....	26.4
Gangtok.....	82.....	20.4.....	14.0	Pune.....		41.4.....	29.2
Goa.....		36.2.....	28.8	Raipur.....		41.0.....	29.2
Guwahati.....		26.9.....	23.3	Ranchi.....	46.....	34.1.....	19.0
Hubballi.....		36.0.....	24.0	Shillong.....	3.....	17.6.....	14.1
Hyderabad.....		39.6.....	27.0	Shimla.....		27.5.....	18.2
Imphal.....		30.5.....	18.8	Srinagar.....	1.....	23.3.....	10.2
Jaipur.....		43.9.....	28.6	Thiruvananthapuram.....	0.7.....	34.0.....	25.2
Kochi.....		32.2.....	23.8	Tiruchi.....		36.3.....	27.0
Kohima.....		23.0.....	15.0	Vijayawada.....		37.9.....	27.4
Kolkata.....	0.8.....	35.5.....	26.9	Visakhapatnam.....		34.2.....	28.0

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing							Yesterday
CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE	
Ahmedabad	59	105	27	103	151	■	In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Mandipear,
Bengaluru	7	18	44	81	112	■	Madhya Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 210
Chennai	14	51	51	27	60	■	indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast,
Delhi	51	84	254	168	168	■	Ramanathapuram, Tamil Nadu recorded a healthy AQI score of 13
Hyderabad	14	14	35	62	92	■	
Kolkata	16	25	22	39	49	■	
Lucknow	10	23	43	136	124	■	
Mumbai	29	66	14	66	81	■	
Pune	32	32	42	45	66	■	
Visakhapatnam	7	17	11	16	48	■	

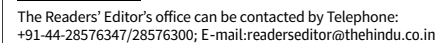
Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease



The ‘cinematisation’ of politics

Throughout the recent election season in Tamil Nadu, there was an unmissable air of restlessness and frenzy among youth voters. Most youth – the largest share of the vote bank that led to actor-turned-politician Joseph Vijay’s Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) winning over 100 seats – seem to have looked at the elections as one that would lead to “a change.”

Tamil Nadu, of course, has seen its share of youth revolution in politics. The very Dravidian government that Mr. Vijay defeated was built by a student political movement more than six decades ago. But unlike the 1960s, this new “change” wasn’t built up through protests against an oppressive force; it largely transpired on social media, in the minds of youth, amid a pandemic of political indifference.

A narrative of change

During the election campaign, two statements largely captured the opposing viewpoints netizens had about Mr. Vijay’s TVK; one was that “Vijay doesn’t understand that politics isn’t cinema” and two, “we need Vijay because we need a change.” There’s more to these statements than what meets the eye. The question is not whether politics is cinema but about how politics needs to become cinema, which Mr. Vijay understands. And change? The youth don’t necessarily crave for a change – what they crave for is a narrative; some purpose that empowers them with direction.

Sociologically speaking, life in 2026 cannot get any more routine for a youth of the State. They work a nine-to-five job, and endlessly scroll through various social media platforms. Beyond personal goals, life hardly allows one a purpose, let alone a larger-than-life vision for a revolution. But cinema does. Cinema offers an augmented reality where purpose is celebrated. This is why we live in a time when escapist cinema is so



Bhuvanesh Chandar

frenzied, and political news consumption has declined.

Throughout the election season, a large chunk of TVK followers were repeatedly criticised as “*tharkuri*,” meaning ‘imbecile’, for their alleged lack of political insight or their inability to articulate why they wanted to vote for Mr. Vijay. “*Anna* [older brother] will do us good,” they said. How or from what? They never bothered, as was evident from the many videos that went viral. However, it would be unfair to blame these youths, as what we are seeing is political indifference and political illiteracy that came from the State’s inability to educate the youth in their language. Depoliticised campuses have long been the cause of this aversion to politics.

This lack of purpose is why propaganda on social media and movies work – audiences need to feel a win, and cinema offers a narrative. And a narrative is what the politician in Mr. Vijay – a face they have seen so often serving them with a purpose – offered them when he took to the stage and tagged the government of the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) as “*theeya sakthi*” (evil force). The narrative was clear. Mr. Vijay had to win, and it didn’t matter why the DMK had to lose.

Need for dramatic change

This need for a purpose through a narrative has now reshaped politics as we know it. Mr. Vijay, to his credit, seems to have learnt this from his decades in the film industry – for an actor to win, politics must become his playground; politics must become cinema. Which is why Mr. Vijay’s election campaign, which ranged from urging children to ask their parents to vote for the TVK to repeatedly symbolising the DMK as a villain, seemed straight out of the climax of a summer blockbuster. If anything, the DMK did not lose to an actor who sold dreams, but to a strategist who offered the satisfaction of a social media campaign win. This is also

why Mr. Vijay’s victory feels so personal to most of his voters. What they have done is essentially beat the force that was unofficially declared unbeatable.

For the interest of these youth ‘audiences’ in politics to sustain, politics needs to become more. They need to see variety in politics, and stability can seem boring. Development shouldn’t just improve upon something; it should demolish something pre-existing, for the lack of dramatic flair would simply be akin to death.

There must be development, but through a steady supply of ‘something different’. Because “we need a change.” In fact, if anything, this statement from supporters of the TVK says enough about the crisis of ‘purposelessness’. For example, many TVK supporters wished for a government change due to the many crimes against women in the last five years. This is one definition of ‘change’ they have attested to. Now, all one must do to check if this was a genuine concern is to see if similar social media campaigns hold the TVK accountable should there be crimes against women during their reign. If not, perhaps, like most election manifestos these days, ‘change’ is just a pre-election commodity. Crimes against women do not need a mere change in government – it needs a government that acknowledges the deep-seated patriarchy in society and takes steps towards abolishing the socio-political factors that lead to sexual assaults. Until then, a change in this regard wouldn’t be concrete.

How Mr. Vijay and the TVK define this victory and govern in the years to come remains to be seen. For the social media warriors who voted for them, this victory is a respite under the punishing sun. Who cares if there’s a happily ever after? We don’t bother about what happens to the hero after the climax.

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The law does not favour AIADMK rebels

The divide needs to be evaluated under the anti-defection law

STATE OF PLAY

K.Venkataramanan

As many as 25 of the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK)’s 47 legislators voted in favour of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) government in the confidence vote moved by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay. This has further deepened the crisis within the party that finished third in the recent Assembly election. The party’s general secretary, Edappadi K. Palaniswami, and 21 of his supporters voted against the TVK government.

A key question is whether the dissidents have incurred disqualification under the anti-defection law. Mr. Palaniswami is in an unenviable position. If he seeks the rebels’ disqualification, the move may lead to a formal split in the party, and may result in byelections that would lead to further marginalisation. On the other hand, even if he doesn’t, the other faction, led by former ministers S.P. Velumani and C. V. Shanmugam, may gain the upper hand within the party structure. However, what stands in his favour is that the dissidents are in no position to save themselves from disqualification, as they do not have the requisite two-thirds’ strength to claim that they have merged with another party. The 2023 judgment of a Constitution Bench on related questions arising from the anti-defection law is also not in their favour.

The verdict in *Subash Desai vs. Principal Secretary to the Governor*, delivered in May 2023, deals squarely with the fate of dissident legislators who are numerically larger than the MLAs loyal to the original party leadership. A key



ruling in the judgment is that it is the political party and not the legislature party that appoints its whip and gives the direction to vote in a particular manner or abstain. Therefore, any claim by another faction that it has its own whip and its own direction to vote cannot be countenanced by the Speaker. The second principle in the judgment is that the numerical strength of respective factions is irrelevant. “The percentage of members in each faction is irrelevant to the determination of whether a defence to disqualification is made out,” the five-judge Bench said. However, the Court also recognised that the Speaker may have to determine which of the two factions constitutes the original party and he may examine the party’s own constitution and other regulations that spell out its structure. “The Speaker must not base their decision as to which group constitutes the political party on a blind appreciation of which group possesses a majority in the Legislative Assembly,” it said. The structure of leadership outside the House is also a relevant consideration.

The Speaker’s determination as to which group constitutes the party is only a *prima facie* finding, and would not have any impact on the Election Commission’s power to adjudicate the question under Paragraph 15 of the Election

Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968, which deals with recognition to parties and allotment of symbols.

Mr. Palaniswami will have to decide whether to seek the disqualification of those who voted against him. The 10th Schedule gives a political party the option of condoning such a vote within 15 days. In 2017, he did not seek action against 11 AIADMK legislators of the O. Panneerselvam faction when they voted against him. A related question is whether a whip was issued and received by all members of the AIADMK. In the 2017 example, Mr. Panneerselvam and his supporters claimed that they had not received it as they were not part of the group of MLAs housed in a resort by the party leadership. Under the rules governing the question of disqualification in the Assembly, each party has to submit a list of its members and designations within 30 days of the first sitting of the House. It is not known whether this was done. The appointment of a member as the Whip, as well as the existence of a ‘direction’ to the members on manner of voting (the word ‘whip’ is not used in the Tenth Schedule) and its communication to all members will all be questions of facts that may require adjudication.

The AIADMK members who voted for the TVK have rendered themselves vulnerable to disqualification by violating a party direction. However, they may depend on the Speaker’s indulgence in not acting on disqualification petitions, if any, and may raise disputes on facts such as which of them is the authority and whether one was issued at all. The Speaker will have to bear in mind the law laid down by the Court while deciding these questions.

China’s economic strengths now rival that of the U.S.

Beijing continues its economic rise and has now become a diplomatic powerhouse

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy

U.S. President Donald Trump commenced his highly anticipated three-day visit to China on May 13, amid the ongoing Israel-U.S. war with Iran, and a year after Mr. Trump imposed steep import tariffs on several countries. China was one of the countries on which the U.S. imposed the highest tariffs.

Mr. Trump’s previous visit to Beijing was in November 2017 during his first term as U.S. President. Interestingly, it was a few months after his 2017 visit that he started a trade war with China by levying high import tariffs on various products to fight the latter’s “unfair trade practices” and address the huge trade imbalance between the two countries. China retaliated with its own tariffs.

Though Mr. Trump escalated this trade war between the two countries in his second term with a further increase in tariffs, he will be visiting China after having backed down following Beijing’s retaliatory tariffs and steps taken by it to restrict vital rare earth exports to the U.S.

A look at multiple economic indicators over the years shows that China is catching up at a steady pace with the U.S., considered the world’s lone superpower both economically and militarily since the collapse of the Soviet Union. Today, China’s economic strength has grown dramatically to rival that of the U.S.

The Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of the U.S. in 1990 was about 15 times the size of China’s economy. By 2025, according to the International Monetary Fund’s data, the U.S. GDP was only 1.5 times larger than that of China (Chart 1).

Despite growing into an economy comparable in size to the U.S., China has managed to maintain a strong GDP growth rate of at least 5% even after it became a \$10 tril-

lion economy in 2014, barring the exceptions of 2020 and 2022. Since becoming a \$10 trillion economy in 2000, the U.S. economy’s growth rate last crossed the 3% mark in 2005. The only exception was 2021 because of the negative growth caused by the COVID-19 pandemic the year before.

The gap is even starker when it comes to labour productivity growth – that is, output per worker. Besides being far higher than the U.S.’s, China’s growth rate of labour productivity is at a level that the U.S. has not come close to in the past 25 years (Chart 2).

In many key export sectors, China now occupies the place once held by the U.S. While China’s share in global exports across sectors such as electronics and minerals has grown, the U.S.’s share has seen a gradual decline (Chart 3). China’s share in global vehicle exports has grown from less than 1% in 1995 to over 13% in 2024.

China has also massively increased its spending on R&D, which assumes significance in the backdrop of the race between the two countries in AI. According to the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), China overtook the U.S. in R&D expenditure for the first time in 2024. The U.S. spent \$781.8 billion while China spent \$785.9 billion, which is a 20-fold jump from the \$41 billion spent in 2000. Between 2000 and 2024, Beijing’s share in global R&D expenditure increased by 23 percentage points while that of the U.S. declined by 9.71 percentage points (Chart 4).

The Asian giant is using its economic growth to increase its diplomatic influence. According to Aid-Data, China was the world’s largest official creditor in 2023, having lent about \$140 billion to public and private sector borrowers. The U.S. is the largest recipient of China’s official sector credit. Lowy Institute’s Asia Power Index ranked Beijing’s ‘diplomatic influence’ and ‘economic relations’ higher than those of the U.S. for 2025.

Tipping the scales

The data for the charts were sourced from the International Monetary Fund (IMF), International Labour Organisation, Harvard Growth Lab’s Atlas of Economic Complexity and World Intellectual Property Organisation



CHART 1: The Gross Domestic Product in current prices

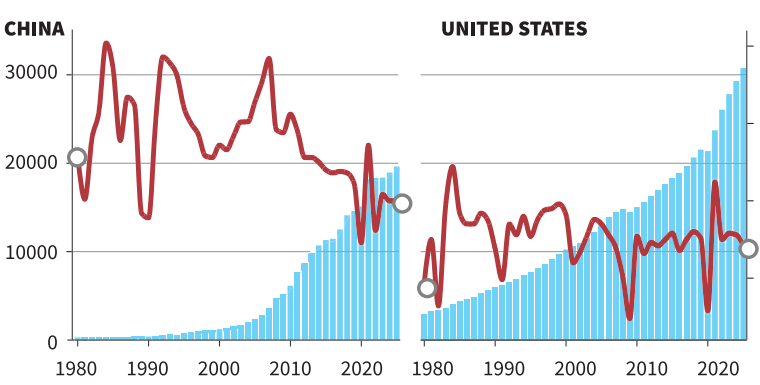


CHART 2: Annual growth rate of output per worker. Figures in %

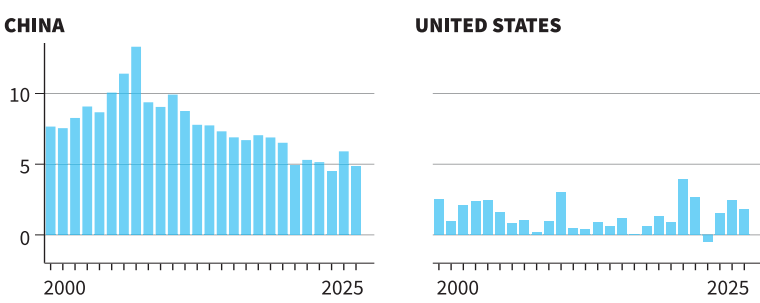
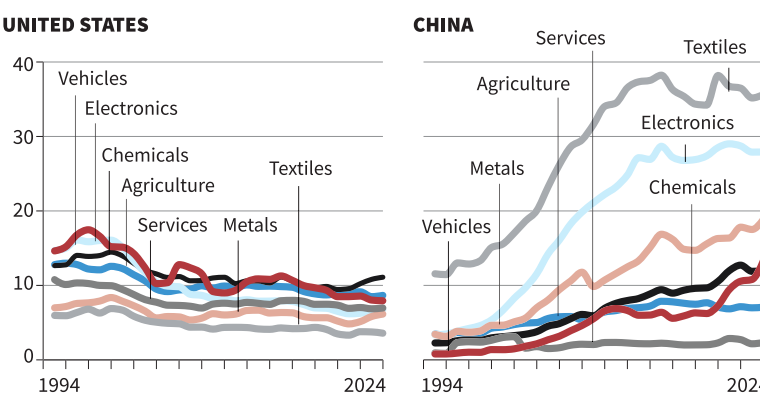


CHART 3: The share in global exports for select items. Figures in %



A comparison of China and U.S.'s GDP since 1980 (Figures in \$ billion)

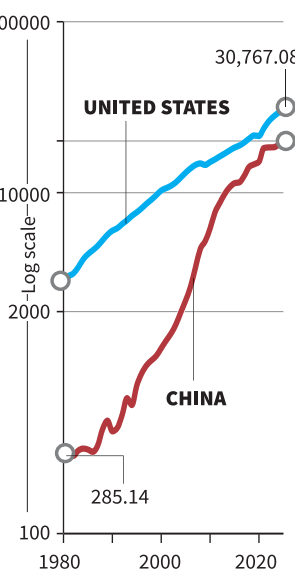
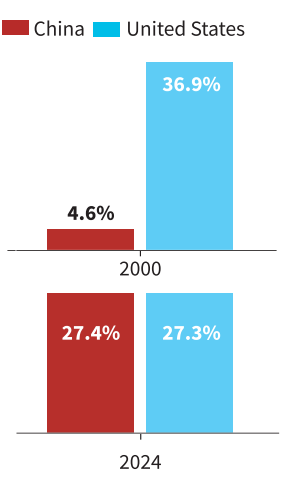


CHART 4: The share in global Research and Development spending



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO MAY 14, 1976

Archipelago status for Andaman to be sought

New Delhi, May 13: India will continue to try in world forums for the archipelago status for Andaman which will entitle it to exercise control over the 12-mile territorial sea and enjoy rights in regard to living and non-living objects in the 200-mile economic zone around the island.

Mr. H.R. Gokhale, Union Law Minister, who has just returned after attending the New York conference on the law of the sea, said to-day that the Indian stand on the rights of the coastal States on archipelago has not been accepted. India, he said, would continue to work through bilateral talks, to secure acceptance for its viewpoint. The big powers, he noted, had combined to deprive the coastal countries of their rights in regard to their islands and were prepared to treat only the archipelago States as an independent entity. “It is a very vital issue for us and we are not happy about the position that has emerged so far. We will continue to fight,” he said.

About the outcome of the New York conference, Mr. Gokhale mentioned that on the positive side was the near-universal acceptance of the idea of the territorial water (with the limit extended to 12 miles) and that of the economic zone 1200 miles beyond the territorial waters. On the negative side, he listed, besides the differences over archipelagos, disagreement over the rights of the landlocked countries. India and some others wanted the landlocked countries to have access to the sea, though transit arrangements could be made only through negotiations with the coastal States on reciprocal basis. Some others were not prepared to recognise this right.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO MAY 14, 1926

Merchandise marks bill

London, May 12: The House of Commons, by 221 votes to 65 passed the second reading of the Merchandise Marks Act, which Sir P. Cunliffe-Lister defined as enabling the purchaser to know whether he was buying British products, British agricultural produce and Empire produce.

Mr. Sidney Webb moved the rejection on the ground that the Bill would create obstacles to the importation of certain classes of goods, increase prices, and encourage monopolies.

A CH-CHE

‘Unfair, stressful’: students in a rage over NEET saga

With no re-test date announced and over 20 lakh students in limbo, many grapple with uncertainty, pressure and possibility of delayed admissions; describing the cancellation a major failure of examination system, they seek free transport for the re-test; calling for strict action, educators, unions say aspirants should be counselled and given time to recover before reappearing for the re-test

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

With no re-test date announced for the cancelled National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-Undergraduate (NEET-UG), students, parents and educators have expressed anger, frustration, and anxiety over additional study load and pressure, and the possibility of delayed admissions resulting in less time for course work.

While they welcomed the exemption of fee for the retest, many called the cancellation a major failure of the examination system.

Over 20 lakh students have to take the re-test for more than 10 medical courses, competing for over 2.5 lakh seats.

Describing the entire episode as unfair and stressful, several people are demanding transport support for students when

they retake the exam.

The Tamil Nadu Consumers Federation said that free bus and train travel should be provided to NEET aspirants. Students travel beyond their own States, or districts within their respective States, to take the exam, bearing significant expenses to appear for the test, the federation's general secretary, K. Thirunavukkarasu, said. "This time, they will have to be compensated for their travel expenses."

P.D. Satya Sree, who completed her Class 12 this year and had been preparing for NEET, said the cancellation had left her shocked and emotionally drained.

"Not just me, many of my friends who appeared for NEET this time are struggling to process this. We don't know how to start preparing all over again," she said, adding that the uncertainty and



Uncertain future: Members of a student organisation protesting against the cancellation of NEET-UG in Hyderabad on Wednesday. NAGARA GOPAL

pressure has taken a heavy emotional toll on students for various reasons.

Every mark matters

Albin Benoy, a student from Odisha, said the cancellation has come as a blow. "With the examination now set to be conduct-

ed again, I do not know how I can return to Kerala and resume coaching at such short notice," he said.

Students were also anxious about the nature of the repeat examination. "There is concern about the difficulty level of the retest. In a highly competi-

tive exam like NEET, even a single mark can determine the college a student gets, and shape their entire future," Mr. Benoy said.

For Mounika U., a long-term aspirant, the cancellation has been emotionally devastating. "Months and years of my prepara-

tion have gone to waste because of a system failure. I did nothing wrong," she said. Although she is willing to take the examination again, she questioned who could guarantee a fair and transparent process.

Describing the cancellation of the test as an injustice, particularly to those who were expecting top ranks based on the provisional answer key released shortly after the test, George Thomas, director of Brilliant Study Centre at Pala in Kerala, said that the uncertainty has also created severe financial anxiety for families who had already stretched their resources for coaching, tuition, and hostel expenses.

A NEET(UG) trainer from Secunderabad, G. Vijay Kumar, said the alleged paper leak and subsequent cancellation would have serious consequences, particularly for long-term aspirants. "It is difficult to

counsel such young students when a prestigious national entrance examination itself becomes a failure. There is immense pressure and an emotional impact on students," he said. Aspirants should be counselled and given adequate time to recover before reappearing for the examination, Mr. Kumar added.

'Abolish the exam'

The All India Students' Federation Andhra Pradesh vice-president, M. Saikumar, has demanded permanent abolition of the nationwide NEET.

He also called for immediate closure of the "incompetent" National Testing Agency, holding it responsible for repeated failures.

Protests were held near the Telangana Secretariat by the Student Islamic Organisation of India along with several aspirants. "Repeated failures send a mes-

sage that the government is incapable of conducting the examination in a fair and transparent manner," they said.

The Students' Federation of India (Telangana), which led demonstrations in Hyderabad, termed the controversy an "administrative failure". Its leader, T. Nagaraju, said the present scandal was a repeat of past incidents because strict action had not been taken after the 2024 paper leak.

"While the officials, middlemen, and coaching mafia responsible for the leak must be arrested immediately, the demand by individual States to conduct their own entrance examinations is important. Policies that are helping education become a corporate business must also be withdrawn," the student leaders said.

(With inputs from State bureaux)

NTA, govt. did not want to cancel NEET in 2024, cited student welfare in the SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A decision taken by the National Testing Agency (NTA) with the approval of the Centre to scrap NEET-UG, upsetting the future of over 22 lakh students nationwide, is diametrically opposite to what it had said and promised in the Supreme Court amid the backlash over the NEET (UG) paper leak in 2024.

Two years ago, the Centre and the NTA had told the court cancelling the test would be a drastic and ill-advised move, jeopardising careers of lakhs of students. They had urged segregation rather than cancellation in 2024, reasoning that students "innocent of wrongdoing should not pay a price for those who are actually found to be involved in irregularities".

The government had argued in 2024 that cancelling the test would be like

In its 2024 order, the court enumerated four consequences of the cancellation of the entrance test

treating "unequals equally" and that innocents and wrongdoers would be made to suffer the same consequences. "Public bodies, after all, had to act fairly and reasonably," the Centre said.

The Centre had promised the court that the enactment of the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was solid evidence of its "seriousness about safeguarding the sanctity of exams".

Not more than two years have passed since these assurances and a statement issued by the NTA on Tuesday said that "inputs" and "investigative findings" necessitate the cancellation of the test.

The court did not cancel the 2024 test. It had held that cancellation would require the high-threshold proof of "systemic breach in the sanctity of the examination". It is not certain if the 2026 paper leak shows such a systemic breach.

Four consequences

In its 2024 order, the court enumerated four hard-hitting consequences of the cancellation of the NEET exam.

These were disruption of the admission schedule for the commencement of courses, setting back the entire process by several months; cascading effects on the course of medical education; impact on the availability of qualified medical professionals in the future; and a grave disadvantage to students from marginalised communities and weaker sections for whom reservation has been made in the allocation of seats.

'Transport, storage, human handling are weakest links in holding NEET'

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

The K. Radhakrishnan Committee, constituted following the controversies surrounding malpractice in the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) for undergraduate medical admissions in 2024, identified local transport and storage and human handling as some of the weakest links in the conduct of the test. The committee formed in June 2024 submitted its report in October the same year.

In its report, the committee said the test should be conducted in phases and a computer/hybrid mode should be brought in instead of relying entirely on a pen-and-paper mode. The committee sought an overhaul of the National Testing Agency (NTA) while reducing paper leak risks, minimising logistical vulnerabilities, improving encrypted delivery, and enabling better audit trails. It said the NTA should bring in permanent professional



The committee had sought feedback from stakeholders, especially students and parents. FILE PHOTO

staff, reduce dependence on outsourced manpower, and have stronger accountability mechanisms.

Now, two years later, the Centre is yet to fully implement the recommendations. NEET-UG is India's largest entrance examination conducted in a single day and in a single shift and attended by nearly 25 lakh candidates.

The report called for efforts to prevent impersonation by fake candidates to crack down on organised cheating networks and blacklist unreliable

centres. Digital surveillance, CCTV use, and command-and-control monitoring could strengthen these efforts, it said.

Sought feedback

As part of the report-making process, the committee had sought feedback from stakeholders, especially students and parents. More than 37,000 responses were collected, a bulk of them from Class 12 students.

The committee explained that while doing away with third-party in-

volvement in the exam process is recommended, a district-wise assessment of infrastructure – especially in rural areas – is equally important. It said that a computer-based test could reduce paper leak risk and enable better audit trails.

"The NTA may target developing at least 1,000 secure Standard Testing Centres in the country, in a phased manner, in reputed government institutions. This process may require a 'war-footing' approach," the committee said, adding that it envisaged a future where the NTA could offer a nimble, zero-error, adaptive, and integrative process.

The committee also said that India could emerge as a global leader in educational testing. "Any test-conducting agency that learns to operate nationwide testing in India successfully gets to train a robust model that can work at scale in varied conditions and contexts elsewhere in the world," the committee said.

Plea seeks SC direction to restructure or replace NTA

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A petition was filed in the Supreme Court on Wednesday seeking a direction to the Centre to "replace or fundamentally restructure" the National Testing Agency (NTA) following the cancellation of the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) for undergraduate medical admissions. The test, conducted on May 3, was cancelled due to a question paper leak.

The Federation of All India Medical Association (FAIMA) pressed for the need for a "more robust, technologically advanced and autonomous body for conducting NEET".

It said the court should intervene and appoint a high-powered monitoring committee chaired by a retired apex court judge and with members including a cybersecurity expert and a forensic scientist to supervise the re-conduct of the exam and ensure there were no further leaks.

Cong. takes a swipe at RSS leader over Pak. remarks

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Wednesday took a dig at senior RSS functionary Dattatreya Hosabale over his remarks advocating dialogue with Pakistan.

Reacting to Mr. Hosabale's remarks in an interview to PTI Videos, Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said the RSS leader's recent interactions in the U.S. seemed to have had an impact on his outlook. He took a swipe at TV channels and supporters of the ruling dispensation, saying they would have "frothed, fumed, and fulminated" had similar remarks been made by leaders outside the ideological fold of the RSS.

Mr. Hosabale had said there should "always be a window" for dialogue with Pakistan and stressed the importance of people-to-people engagement in easing tensions between the two countries.

Modi cuts size of his convoy after making an appeal to save fuel

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has substantially downsized the strength of his convoy, days after making an appeal to the people for the rational use of fuel-powered vehicles amid the West Asia crisis, a move subsequently followed by Chief Ministers in several States ruled by the Bharatiya Janata Party.

Mr. Modi's fleet size has been reduced while ensuring that all essential components of his security arrangements remain in accordance with the Special Protection Group (SPG) protocols. After his appeal during a recent speech in Hyderabad, the decision was reportedly implemented during his visits to Gujarat and Assam. He has also asked for already available electric vehicles to be part of his convoy.

Following Mr. Modi's appeal, Uttar Pradesh Chief



Narendra Modi

Minister Yogi Adityanath directed a 50% reduction in the number of escort vehicles for himself and his Cabinet colleagues. He has requested people to reduce fuel consumption and avoid unnecessary purchase of gold, as suggested by Mr. Modi. The BJP-led governments in Delhi, Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Bihar have also taken similar decisions.

Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghvi has cancelled his planned visit to the U.S.

Kharge slams Modi over 'stagnant' pensions

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Wednesday accused the Narendra Modi government of preaching austerity to citizens while spending lavishly on publicity and political spectacle, even as pensions for the elderly, widows, and people with disabilities remain stagnant.

In a post on X, Mr. Kharge alleged that the Centre had failed to raise old-age pensions for the past 12 years despite soaring inflation, thereby eroding the economic dignity of vulnerable sections of society.

Citing expenditure figures, he said the Centre had spent ₹5,987.46 crore on advertisements and publicity campaigns.

"This cruel BJP model strips disadvantaged citizens of their economic dignity while spending extravagantly on political spectacle," he said.

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STATEMENT OF STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED 31ST MARCH 2026									
(Rs. in Crores)									
S. No	Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter ended		Year ended		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		31.03.2026	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025
		(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1	Total income from operations	12,807.63	9,550.44	47,270.32	36,251.32	15,052.73	11,542.00	56,069.52	44,089.01
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional Items)	1,358.40	1,009.56	4,944.89	3,521.54	1,298.13	992.88	4,871.82	3,505.35
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional Items)	1,358.40	1,009.56	4,903.52	3,521.54	1,298.13	992.88	4,821.74	3,505.35
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after exceptional items)	997.70	760.68	3,615.22	2,633.89	819.55	697.51	3,186.43	2,379.81
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income / (Loss) (after tax)]	1,026.04	800.98	3,780.58	2,666.08	1,019.00	733.01	3,693.34	2,427.03
6	Paid up Equity share capital (Face value of Re.1/- each)	47.51	47.51	47.51	47.51	47.51	47.51	47.51	47.51
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	-	-	11,186.79	9,849.71	-	-	9,516.74	8,455.87
8	Security Premium Account								
9	Networth	11,348.62	10,006.97	11,348.62	10,006.97	9,187.21	8,481.39	9,187.21	8,481.39
10	Outstanding Debt	2,733.36	1,441.38	2,733.36	1,441.38	27,697.48	23,500.76	27,697.48	23,500.76
11	Outstanding Non-Convertible Redeemable Preference Shares	1,900.35	-	1,900.35	-	1,900.35	-	1,900.35	-
12	Debt Equity Ratio (Times) (Debt includes NCRPS)	0.24	0.15	0.24	0.14	2.60	2.76	2.60	2.76
13	Earnings Per Share (Face value of Re. 1/- each) (not annualised)								
	(i) Basic & Diluted (in Rs.) from continuing operations	21.00	15.78	76.09	54.81	16.24	13.41	63.53	46.42
	(ii) Basic & Diluted (in Rs.) from discontinuing operations	-	0.23	-	0.63	-	0.23	-	0.63
	(iii) Basic & Diluted (in Rs.) from continuing and discontinuing operations	21.00	16.01	76.09	55.44	16.24	13.64	63.53	47.05
14	Capital Redemption Reserve								
15	Debiture Redemption Reserve								
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (Excluding NBFC Subsidiary) (Times)	3.82	7.13	4.77	5.18	2.12	2.34	3.03	2.88
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (Excluding NBFC Subsidiary) (Times)	29.37	37.16	29.64	29.61	18.50	18.06	17.75	14.36
18	Current Ratio (Times)	0.54	0.61	0.54	0.61	0.97	1.12	0.97	1.12
19	Long term debt to working capital (Times)	-	-	-	-	2.46	1.81	2.46	1.81
20	Bad debts to Accounts Receivable ratio (Times)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
21	Current liability ratio (Times)	0.88	0.84	0.88	0.84	0.70	0.60	0.70	0.60
22	Total debts to total assets ratio (Times)	0.12	0.09	0.12	0.09	0.56	0.56	0.56	0.56
23	Debtors Turnover ratio (Times)	28.08	28.08	28.08	28.08	25.66	24.80	25.66	24.80
24	Inventory Turnover ratio (Times)	20.37	16.64	20.37	16.64	14.31	11.46	14.31	11.46
25	Operating Margin (%)	13.1	14.0	12.9	12.3	11.3	12.1	11.5	10.8
26	Net Profit Margin (%)	7.8	8.0	7.6	7.3	5.4	6.0	5.7	5.4

Notes:

1

The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the financial results are available on the Stock Exchange websites (www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com) and on Company's website (www.tvsmotor.com).

2

Figures for the previous periods have been regrouped, wherever necessary, to conform to the current period's classification.

3

The Detailed Financial Results of the Company for the year ended 31st March 2026 can be accessed through the QR code.



For TVS Motor Company Limited

Sd/-

Sudarshan Venu

Chairman

Date : 13.05.2026

INBRIEF



Consider requests on CCTV funds for police stations: SC

The Supreme Court on Wednesday urged the Union government to consider requests from States for the disbursal of funds for installing CCTV cameras and creating a centralised monitoring dashboard across police stations. A three-judge Bench headed by Justice Vikram Nath asked the Centre to ensure the implementation of the Assistance to States and Union Territories for Modernisation of Police scheme, under which the Ministry of Home Affairs has undertaken to provide funds for installing CCTV infrastructure in police stations across States and Union Territories. The order was passed in a *suo motu* proceeding initiated last year.

SC praises decision by kin to donate Harish Rana’s organs

The Supreme Court on Wednesday expressed appreciation for the family of Harish Rana, the first person in India to be permitted withdrawal of clinically assisted nutrition and hydration, for their “selfless” decision to donate his corneas and heart valves. A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K.V. Viswanathan said such “generosity” would ensure that Rana’s legacy lives on through the lives he saves. “Harish left his mortal world on his own terms, surrounded by love and compassion. Even in the face of their own loss, his family chose generosity through the selfless decision to donate his corneas and heart valves...,” the Bench said.

Accused in terror-financing case arrested after extradition

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) on Wednesday arrested an alleged “narco-terrorist”, Iqbal Singh, after securing his extradition from Portugal following sustained diplomatic and legal efforts. The NIA alleged that Singh, alias Shera, was a mastermind in a major Hizb-ul-Mujahideen terror-financing case. He was brought to Delhi and taken into custody. The accused had fled to Portugal in 2020. A non-bailable arrest warrant was issued against him in October 2020, followed by an Interpol Red Notice in June 2021. According to the NIA, Shera was a key conspirator and handler of an India-based narco-terror module engaged in smuggling heroin from Pakistan.

Prateek Yadav, younger son of Mulayam Singh, passes away

Prateek Yadav, younger son of Samajwadi Party (SP) founder Mulayam Singh Yadav and husband of BJP leader Aparna Bisht Yadav, passed away at 38, in Lucknow on Wednesday morning after falling ill. He was rushed to the Civil Hospital in Lucknow, where doctors declared him brought dead. He was the stepbrother of Akhilesh Yadav, the president of the Samajwadi Party. The postmortem conducted at King George’s Medical University (KGMU) revealed that Mr. Yadav died due to a massive blockage in the blood vessels of the lungs. Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath visited Mr. Yadav’s residence, and, in a post on X, expressed his grief.

CBSE Class 12 results record slight dip in pass percentage

National pass percentage stands at 85.2%, 3.19 percentage points down from last year’s; girls record a 88.86% rate, outperforming boys; Thiruvananthapuram region records over 95%

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) on Wednesday released the Class 12 Board examination results, which recorded a slight dip in the overall pass percentage from last year’s results.

The national pass percentage stands at 85.2%, a drop of 3.19 percentage points from last year’s 88.39%. A total of 17,68,968 students appeared in the examination.

Girls have once again outshone boys. “The pass rate for girls reached 88.86%, surpassing boys



Jubilant faces: Students in Patna celebrate their success after the CBSE Class 12 results were announced on Wednesday. ANI

(82.13%) by a significant margin of 6.73%,” a CBSE release said.

The Board has maintained its tradition of not

releasing an official merit list to curb “unhealthy competition”, it said. Over 94,000 students scored above 90%, with more

than 17,000 candidates securing marks above 95%. Among the regions, Thiruvananthapuram leads the charts with a 95.62% pass rate, followed closely by Chennai and Bengaluru. Prayagraj in Uttar Pradesh has the lowest at 72.43%.

Up to 1.63 lakh students placed in the compartment category, or those wishing to improve their scores in a single subject, can appear for the supplementary exams scheduled for July 15, the CBSE said.

The Board will soon release the schedule for students who wish to apply for marks verification or a photocopy of their evaluated answer books.

MSP for kharif crops hiked; farm groups criticise rates

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) on Wednesday announced the minimum support price (MSP) for kharif crops for the 2026-27 season, with the MSP for paddy increased by ₹72 per quintal to ₹2,441 for the common variety.

Talking to reporters after the CCEA meeting, Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the revised MSPs would ensure returns of about 50% over the cost of production of each crop.

For A-grade paddy varieties, the revised MSP is ₹2,461 per quintal. The MSP for cotton (medium staple) was increased by ₹557 to ₹8,267 per quintal, while the long staple variety would fetch ₹8,667 per quintal. For edible oil crops, sunflower seed MSP was increased by ₹622 to ₹8,343 per quintal, Niger seed by ₹515 to ₹10,052 per quintal, and sesamum by ₹500 to ₹10,346 per quintal. The MSP of soyabean was raised by ₹380 to ₹5,708 per quintal, while groundnut MSP was up by ₹254 to ₹7,517 per quintal.

Farmer organisations criticised the new rates, saying they do not factor in the possible “disastrous impact” of the India-U.S. trade deal and other free trade agreements, on the agriculture sector.

PCOS gets a new name; change seeks to aid faster diagnosis and treatment

Ramya Kannan
CHENNAI

The Endocrine Society, a global organisation of scientists and physicians devoted to hormone-related conditions, has decided to rename Polycystic Ovary Syndrome (PCOS) as Polyendocrine Metabolic Ovarian Syndrome (PMOS).

What’s in a name, you might ask. But there is good reason why this name change is important. In an article published in *The Lancet*, the authors Helena J. Teede et al, argue that the term PCOS is inaccurate as it refers to cysts in the ovaries and, if diagnosis is based on this, contributes to delays in diagnosis, treatment, and stigma. Instead, they explain that “accuracy is improved by omitting cysts and by capturing endocrine, metabolic, and ovarian dysfunction”. A “global implementation strategy, including a transition period, education, and alignment with health systems and disease classification” is reportedly under way.

A. Jaishree Gajaraj, senior obstetrician-gynaecologist based in Chennai, says this is a welcome move that will definitely help improve the perception of this condition, and will help clinical practice



PCOS is estimated to affect 170 million women during their reproductive years alone.

as well. “Unfortunately even doctors seem to think cysts in the ovary alone is PCOS, and there is a lot of erroneous self-diagnosis as well these days,” she said.

PCOS is estimated to affect 170 million women during their reproductive years alone. It is diagnosed, based on women over 20 meeting at least two of the following International Guideline criteria: irregular or absent ovulation (oligo-anovulation), meaning periods that are infrequent, too long between cycles, or absent; high male hormone levels (hyperandrogenism), with either visible signs such as excess hair growth, acne, or hair loss; or blood tests; and polycystic ovaries detected as small follicles, on ultrasound scans or high Anti Müllerian Hormone levels in the blood.

However, as the paper

says: “The broad clinical features of the condition are not captured in its current name, as although arrested follicular development is common, ovarian cysts are not increased. These factors delay diagnosis – with up to 70% of the affected individuals remaining undiagnosed.

The authors write that PCOS has long been “primarily perceived as a gynaecological or ovarian disorder”. The reproductive focus of the name can reinforce stigma, particularly in sociocultural contexts where fertility carries high value.

However, mounting research, evidence synthesis, and International Guidelines have shown that PCOS is underpinned by “endocrine disturbances in insulin, androgens, and neuroendocrine and ovarian hormones.” Further, they emphasise that the multi-pronged features that underline the condition must be folded in for a diagnosis. They can be metabolic, including obesity, type 2 diabetes, hypertension, and abnormal levels of fats in the blood, they could also be reproductive – causing irregular menstrual cycles, infertility, pregnancy complications, and endometrial cancer. They can also manifest as psychological features.

Nicobarese oppose proposal for three wildlife sanctuaries

Abhinay Lakshman
NEW DELHI

Even as the Calcutta High Court is set to hear challenges to the Centre’s Great Nicobar Island (GNI) project over allegations that the Forest Rights Act was violated while obtaining locals’ consent for it, the tribal council in Nicobar has now flagged further violations of the law in the government’s notification of three wildlife sanctuaries in the Little Nicobar, Menchal, and Meroe islands.

While acknowledging that its ₹92,000-crore development project to build an international container transshipment port, an airport, and a greenfield tourist township on the Great Nicobar Island would impact coral colonies, and nesting habitats of the leatherback turtle and the megapode, the Union government, in October 2022, notified the three sanctuaries to conserve these species, in parts of the Little Nicobar Island, Meroe Island and Menchal Island - all north of GNI.

Community in the dark
However, since August 2022, the Tribal Council of Little and Great Nicobar has been writing to the Union government and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands (A&NI) administration, flagging that the process to notify these sanctuaries had been initiated without giving notice to members of their community who have lived on and maintained these islands for generations.

In a letter to the Assistant Conservator of Forests of the Nicobar Forest Division, the tribal council on April 23 this year, reiterated that the three sanctuaries on Little Nicobar Island and the Meroe and Menchal islands were announced without any consultation with the residents and traditional owners and caretakers of the islands. The council noted that of these three sites, Meroe and Menchal islands are of “high cultural and spiritual significance” to the Nicobarese; they believe the sites are home to the spirits of their ancestors.

The council was responding to a notice for a meeting of the committee constituted to determine the eco-sensitive zone around these three sanctuaries – the Leatherback Turtle Sanctuary in parts of LNI, the Megapode Sanctuary in all of Menchal



The sanctuaries will come up on Little Nicobar, Meroe, and Menchal islands. GETTY IMAGES

Island, and the Coral Sanctuary on the entire Meroe Island. In the letter, the council said its chairman was not consulted before the committee was formed – he was merely informed that he was part of the committee, that too a month later.

‘Scrap decision’

The council said the notification for these sanctuaries should be revoked and the committee on eco-sensitive zones be dissolved, as they were against the wishes of the community. The sanctuaries would encroach upon their pre-existing rights on these lands, which they have been exercising to hold ritual hunts, maintain plantations, worship their ancestors, and conserve wildlife species around them, it said.

In response to the concerns raised by the tribal council, the Nicobar administration, in May 2025, issued a “clarification” noting that the declaration of the three sanctuaries would not affect the “hunting rights conferred on the Scheduled Tribes of the Nicobar Islands”.

Appeal to Minister

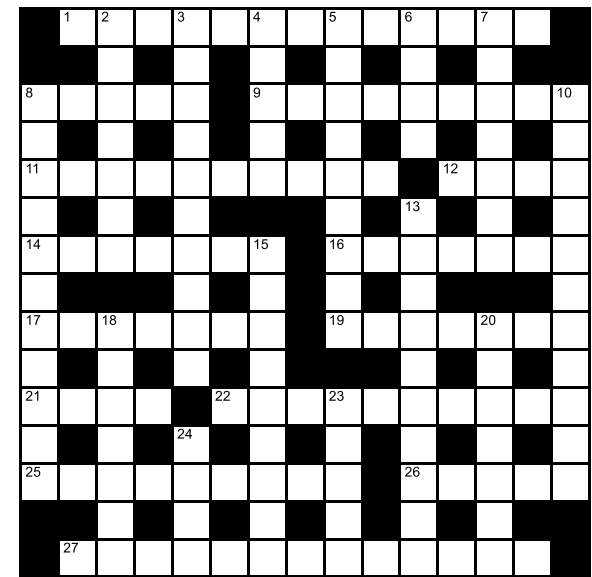
Meanwhile, on Wednesday, Congress leader and former Environment Minister Jairam Ramesh wrote to Tribal Affairs Minister Jual Oram, asserting that consent procedures under the Forest Rights Act were violated in the case of the GNI project.

He noted that the consent should have been obtained from the Tribal Council and not the Gram Sabhas, and also questioned how the government-controlled Andaman Adim Janjati Vikas Samiti could grant consent for the project on behalf of the Shompen, a particularly vulnerable tribal group. Mr. Ramesh asked Mr. Oram to direct the A&NI administration to withdraw the clearances issued under the law.

**THE HINDU****CROSSWORD****+****14793**
(Set by Dr. X)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

SCAN TO PLAY



- Across**
- 1 Bans pesticide, nasty stuff (4,3,6)
 - 8 Dim lights entirely at first in pub (5)
 - 9 Dribbling with energy in east European arena (9)
 - 11 Be very surprised by awful heat on set around afternoon (3,4,3)
 - 12 Beat culprit stealing bags in retreat (4)

- 14 Father is captivated by a master's art movement (7)
 - 16 Kitchen item with good sieve (7)
 - 17 American chap is badly affected by a language disorder (7)
 - 19 Overwhelmed by drink, member has terribly serious accident (5-2)
 - 21 Trouble after king's murder (4)
 - 22 Hero in rave turned intoxicated (10)
 - 25 Repaired terminal's railway tracks (9)
 - 26 Extremely unruly fool interrupting concert (5)
 - 27 Clear-cut kind of film (5-3-5)
- Down**
- 2 Thought creatively and edited a novel (7)
 - 3 Most resilient secret agents collaring gang leader in tunnel (10)
 - 4 Bags filled with special egg holders (5)
 - 5 Girl transported by plane has broken bones (9)
 - 6 Wife entertained by show about sheep (4)
 - 7 Victory secured by deceit, rogue's expelled (7)
 - 8 Stabbed with rake, ripping the stomach (11)
 - 10 Start to roll joint with member in merry social event held on lawn (6,5)
 - 13 One inspired by macho stud's unusual knack of making money (5,5)
 - 15 Revolutionary plan to catch brilliant Mafia boss in European region (9)
 - 18 Ancient chamber containing large bag (7)
 - 20 Musician in Paris, playing in hotel bar (7)
 - 23 Take a sedative to stay relaxed (5)
 - 24 Starts to beat leader of cocaine cartel (4)

SUDOKU

8						5	
		7			5	4	
5			3	4	9		1
6				1	3		
	7						8
			8	6			5
3	6		9	5	8		1
		4	6			5	
5							3

Solution to previous puzzle

C	A	P	T	A	N	U	R	E
L	I	N	G	O	A	L	E	R
S	P	A	R	S	G	O	L	L
T	B	T	R	L	R	T	I	E
R	E	A	N	T	M	A	T	E
O	M	E	T	A	V	E	M	E
B	E	A	R	C	H	B	R	E
E	A	D	T	H	B	R	E	A
L	A	C	T	I	E	S	T	E
G	A	M	E	R	O	C	A	T
H	E	R	E	S	N	O	H	
T	R	A	N	S	P	O	R	T
L	E	R	E	T	U	N		
G	I	R	O	D	F	R	A	S
A	G	E						

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

5	9	6	1	4	7	8	2	3
3	7	1	2	9	8	5	6	4
2	4	8	5	3	6	1	9	7
4	2	5	9	7	1	3	8	6
6	1	7	8	5	3	9	4	2
8	3	6	2	4	7	5	1	
8	3	9	4	1	2	6	7	5
7	6	4	3	8	5	2	1	9
1	5	2	7	6	9	4	3	8

FAITH

Tiruvaimozhi: revered work

In a pasuram about Lord Azhagar of Thirumalirunjalai, Nammazhvar says the Lord Himself sings the verses in praise of Him. This gives us an idea about the greatness of Tiruvaimozhi, said V.S. Karunakarachariar in a discourse. Tiruvaimozhi will always remain a revered work. There is a story about a king, who was against Vaishnavism. He went about pulling down all Vishnu temples. When this king died, his son became the king. The new king knew that his father had been foolish. He told his ministers that Vaishnavism could not be destroyed as long as the Ramayana and Tiruvaimozhi were around. We have bodies made of five elements. The rains nourish crops and grass. We eat that which grows on the earth. We drink the milk of cows, which feed on grass. To cook our food we need fire. But in the case of Nammazhvar, he never ate or drank anything that depended on the elements. He said the food he ate, the water he drank, the betel leaves he chewed were all nothing but Kannan (Lord Krishna).

There are many Upanishadic truths in Tiruvaimozhi. For instance, he says God exists if you say he does. He also exists if you say He doesn't! If you say God doesn't exist, then you will be asked, “How do you know?” If the answer to that question is “He is not here,” then it can be asked, “Does this mean He is elsewhere?” If you reply that He is not here at present, then the question asked will be, “How do you know He wasn't there in the past, and won't be there in future?” The very fact that you are talking about God shows He exists. You cannot talk about something that does not exist. This is what Nammazhvar means when he says God exists when you deny His existence.

‘India should have stepped into vacuum left by U.S.’



The session on ‘India’s Diplomatic Balancing in West Asia: Strategic Autonomy, Energy Security & Global Responsibility’, moderated by Suhasini Haidar, Diplomatic Editor, *The Hindu*. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

India should have stepped into the vacuum when the United States, which played a dominant role in the West Asia region as the guarantor of security, lost its credibility in the region, said Talmiz Ahmad, former Ambassador to Oman, UAE, and Saudi Arabia, and Professor of International studies, Symbiosis International University, Pune. He was speaking at Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences (SIMATS), which is hosting *The Hindu* Diplomacy and Sustainability Dialogues 2026.

The former Ambassador was speaking on the topic ‘India’s Diplomatic Balancing in West Asia: Strategic Autonomy, Energy Security and Global Responsibility’ on Wednesday.

Answering a question posed by by Suhasini Haidar, Diplomatic Editor, *The Hindu*, over whether he felt India has followed a “balanced” West Asia policy, Sunjay Sudhir, former Ambassador to UAE and Maldives and Distinguished Fellow, IIM Ahmedabad, said that the policy has been rather “pragmatic”.

Commenting on India’s role in the crisis in West Asia, Gulshan Sachdeva, Jean Monnet Chair, School of International Studies, JNU, said that India had taken a side in West Asia even before the war had begun.

“I would say that our assessment was not really correct. We thought that it was going to be a short and an easy war and they (U.S. and Israel) were going to win. We are trying to, perhaps, balance since then...,” he said, adding, “Our one relationship with Israel should not become a liability, not only in West Asia, but in the entire Global South. In the long run, things are going to settle.” T.C. Karthikeyan, Professor of Politics and International Relations, Director - Centre For Public policy and Administration, Saveetha School of Law, added, “Whenever nations face economic hardships, some people may emerge saying they can offer all the solutions. We have to be mindful of the emergence of dictatorships. India should play the role of a facilitator.”

‘Iran war shows military force alone is no solution to conflicts’

Iran’s insistence on a permanent solution of the issues involved has put the focus once again on political resolutions of wars and conflicts, in the region and beyond, says former diplomat T.S. Tirumurti at the Diplomacy and Sustainability Dialogues

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The United States-Israel-Iran war has clearly exhibited that military action alone was not enough to find resolution to conflicts and that a political follow-up was pertinent, T.S. Tirumurti, former Ambassador and Permanent Representative of India to the United Nations, New York, said in Chennai on Wednesday.

Speaking at the inauguration of Diplomacy and Sustainability Dialogues 2026, jointly organised by Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences (SIMATS) and *The Hindu*, the former Ambassador said, “...what has changed is that the Iran war has shown us once again that military force by itself cannot be a solution unless followed up with a political solution, whether in Ukraine or in Gaza or in Iran. With the U.S. and China having almost parallel visions of the world order, political resolution of conflict is one area which has been receiving less and less attention, especially from the P5 countries - the permanent five countries of the United Nations.”

On political resolutions

The Iranian insistence on a permanent solution of the issues involved, he said, has put the focus once again on political resolutions of wars and conflicts, both in the region and beyond.

Referring to the various conflicts and proxy wars in Africa fought by external players, historical conflicts in West Asia, including the Palestinian issue, and threats and conflicts in Latin America, Mr. Tirumurti said that terrorism has added one more layer of conflict by State or by non-State actors.

“We ignore all of them at our own peril. It is time



The inaugural session of Diplomacy and Sustainability Dialogues 2026 featured former diplomats and experts. L.V. Navaneeth, CEO, The Hindu Group, N.M. Veeraiyan, Chancellor, SIMATS Chennai, Suhasini Haidar, Diplomatic Editor, *The Hindu*, were present. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS



we took the right lessons from the Iran war,” he warned.

‘New world order’

Talmiz Ahmed, former Ambassador to Oman, the UAE, and Saudi Arabia, and Distinguished Professor of International Studies, Symbiosis International University, Pune, said the expression “we are in the cusp of a new world order” was something international relations experts were grappling with of late; and that it was a coming together of a “large number of significant changes”.

“It will take some effort on your part to realise that many of the things that are given in your life are changing and are likely to change very significantly,” Mr. Ahmed said pointing at what he called a “seismic change in political order”

in Tamil Nadu, and the government elected in Delhi 12 years ago that was re-vamping the basis of the idea of India enshrined in the Constitution. Quoting Lord Byron, he said, “...first freedom, then glory, then wealth, vice, corruption, barbarism at last...we are looking at the age of barbarism. This is what explains the extraordinary violence that has been wreaked all across West Asia with total impunity.”

Sunjay Sudhir, former Ambassador to the UAE and Maldives, and Distinguished Fellow, IIM Ahmedabad, said that the West Asia conflict has had a deep impact on India that was visible in its GDP, inflation, fall of the rupee, and the current account deficit, and was also having a deep cascading effect on its industries, especially petrochemicals and fertilisers. “When the war ends, when there is this so-called settlement that satisfies all sides, I think it will be a big challenge for us, because not only is there a new axis forming - Pakistan, Turkey, Saudi Arabia, and Egypt - but with the politics of the Gulf Cooperation



Through activities connected with the UN Sustainable Development Goals, we are committed to developing socially responsible students

N.M. VEERAIYAN
Chancellor, SIMATS Chennai

Council (GCC) itself changing, I think that will put our diplomacy to a big test,” he added.

N.M. Veeraiyan, Chancellor, SIMATS Chennai, said that the university believed in the principle of providing more than education, equipping students to contribute to society through innovation, research, policy, and sustainable development. “Through activities connected with the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDG), we are committed to developing socially responsible students, ethical leaders, and researchers who can solve real world problems by themselves,” Dr. Veeraiyan added.

In his welcome address,

L.V. Navaneeth, CEO, *The Hindu* Group of Publications, said dialogues such as these create informed public discourse, bringing together voices that helped society think deeper, engage better, and understand the larger forces shaping the future.

“At a time when the world is witnessing deep geopolitical shifts, economic uncertainty, energy insecurity, and increasing sustainability concerns, conventions such as these become not just relevant but a necessity,” Mr. Navaneeth added.

Earlier, setting the stage for the deliberations, Dhanraj Ganapathy, Dean of Sustainability, SIMATS, said that India’s position in the present geopolitical context was very “delicate” and it needed to tread cautiously while choosing between “the worse and the worst”. SIMATS, he said, would consolidate the day’s deliberations in the form of a document and present it to the Government of India.

S. Sundaresan, Vice-President, Advertisement Sales - South, *The Hindu*, proposed a vote of thanks at the end of the event.



The escalating Iran-Israel-USA conflict signals the dangerous breakdown of deterrence in West Asia. India was uniquely positioned to play a stabilising diplomatic role. India’s long-standing civilisational ties with the Gulf, coupled with its growing global stature and energy dependence on the region, made neutrality not merely desirable but strategically necessary

ASHWANI KUMAR
Vice-Chancellor, SIMATS



India’s approach to the West Asia crisis reflects a delicate diplomatic balancing act aimed at protecting its strategic, economic, and geopolitical interests. The greatest risks for India include pressure from competing global powers to take sides. India has managed to maintain balanced relations across West Asia while safeguarding its national interests and diplomatic flexibility

DHANRAJ GANAPATHY
Dean of Sustainability, SIMATS

India should formulate a regional policy for West Asia: T.S. Tirumurti

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

It is important to have a separate regional policy that accounts for the contradictions in a region, as a regional policy is not an aggregation of excellent bilateral policies, said T.S. Tirumurti, former Ambassador and Permanent Representative of India to the United Nations, New York, at Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technical Sciences (SIMATS), near Thandalam, which hosted *The Hindu* Diplomacy and Sustainability Dialogues 2026.

In conversation with Stanly Johny, International Affairs Editor, *The Hindu*, on the topic ‘India’s Global Future: Leadership, Diplomacy and Sustainability in Times of Conflict’, the former Ambassador said: “Right now, you have a huge problem between Saudi Arabia and the UAE. But India has excellent relations with both. So, how are you going to manage those contradictions? That comes only if you have a well-thought-out regional policy, which will also include Iran.”

Asked to elaborate on tackling multiple crises arising out of the West Asia region, especially energy crises and so on, Mr. Tiru-



Former diplomat T.S. Tirumurti in conversation with Stanly Johny, International Affairs Editor, *The Hindu*, during a session at the Diplomacy & Sustainability Dialogues 2026. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

murti said: “There are two important aspects to it: strategic autonomy and pro-activeness. Strategic autonomy is enlarging your space and taking independent decisions for your country based on your national interest. Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru exercised strategic autonomy by stating, ‘I don’t want to join either of the two’. And countries actually came and joined India in non-alignment (movement). We naturally became the leader of the Global South.”

He added: “In the present context, we have multi-alignment. We have two superpowers who actually engage very closely with each other but they are also adversaries. In multi-

alignment, the point is it helps us get strategic autonomy, but it doesn’t help us get leadership in geopolitics.” The former diplomat added that leadership is important because geopolitics affects economy, business, technology, and everything else.

Speaking about the perils of not playing a proactive role, Mr. Tirumurti said, “If you do not take a proactive role [in conflicts], other countries like Saudi Arabia, Türkiye, and Pakistan will fill this space. So, you are actually ceding space to other countries. We should continue to stick to our policy of strategic autonomy but be proactive.”

Explaining how Pakistan found itself at the

centre of the conflict between the United States, Israel, and Iran, the former Ambassador said, “A regional security architecture for that region (West Asia) should include Iran. Just as Russia should be included in Europe’s security architecture. The blocking of [Strait of] Hormuz is going to change their thinking about security. In future, they will look at land connectivity, pipelines, and how to avoid it (blockades). De-risking supply chains will be a major aspect going forward,” he said.

Explaining how the U.S. could not meet its objectives in the Iran conflict, he said, “By having a regime change, they wanted to stop this [radical] ideology and stop the proxies from getting any help from Iran. All of us know none of this has happened. Not only are Iran’s Revolutionary Guards there, they also have become stronger... The most important thing that has happened due to the Iran war is that it has exposed the security umbrella of the United States and has shown the Gulf States are extremely vulnerable. When it comes to nuclear [weapons], all the stockpiles remain with Iran.”

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

As the West Asia crisis impacts fertilizer supply globally, India should shift its long-term focus to gradually move away from the older model of fertilizer-dependent agricultural practices while not forgetting lessons learnt from the Sri Lankan experience, according to Sudha Meiyappan, Member, Economic Affairs Committee, Southern India Chamber Of Commerce And Industry (SICCI).

Participating in a panel discussion on the topic ‘Impact of West Asia Crisis on Economic Disruptions and Sustainability: Implications for India’ here on Wednesday, she said that in the long run, India should seek to make agriculture sustainable by adopting natural farming, agro-forestry, and various other forms of sustainable movements that are taking place in the sector. She, however, put forth a caveat that India should take care to pick up lessons from the Sri Lankan experience.

The island country had made a sudden shift to organic farming with a ban on fertilizer imports leading to a drop in production of food grains causing eco-



The session on ‘Impact of West Asia crisis on Economic Disruptions & Sustainability: Implications for India’ moderated by Kunal Shankar, Deputy Business Editor, *The Hindu*. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

nomical disruption and social unrest.

The panel discussion was part of the Diplomacy and Sustainability Dialogues 2026 jointly organised by the Saveetha Institute of Medical and Technological Sciences (SIMATS) and *The Hindu*.

Ms. Meiyappan said that in the short term, India should continue to follow the current policies while focussing on a transition to sustainable practices in the long term. “In the short term, you continue doing what you are doing today. You don’t change to organic today, but over the long term, you slowly, gradually veer away...not organic per se, but something that’s more climate resilient, more sustainable in nature. You can’t get rid of

fertilizers but [determine] how much you are using and for what crop you are using and where the crop is being grown,” she said, responding to a question from the moderator Kunal Shankar, Deputy Business Editor, *The Hindu*.

She also warned that India was looking at curtailment of personal consumption by virtue of general price rise due to the increase in fuel prices, even without the announcement from the Prime Minister. Gold prices, for example, went beyond the threshold of being a safe haven even before the war. After the announcement, the artisans and the local shops selling gold will be impacted heavily, Ms. Meiyappan added.

Col. Rajeev Agarwal

(ret'd), Senior Research Consultant, Chintan Research Foundation, said that the Iran war has given clear dimensions to projects like India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) while it has exposed the vulnerability of the existing trade routes and connectivity. Choke points and conflict zones, he said, would always make trade connectivity and supply lines vulnerable. An alternative is required that bypasses both these chokepoints and conflict zones. Projects like IMEC, with certain modifications given the geopolitical changes, could provide such a framework.

S. Pandiaraj, professor of International Law and Trade, Saveetha School of Law, said that India’s stand in foreign affairs should be pragmatic but also operate in a way that would not forsake the values and principles that it always stood for, whether it was the 1955 Bandung Conference or the Non-Aligned Movement (NAM).

“The transactional approach, the give and take approach would only take us up to a point and not beyond. So, India should be careful in terms of treading various passages,” Dr. Pandiaraj observed.

INBRIEF



HPCL Q4 net zooms 46% on improved refining margins

State-owned refiner Hindustan Petroleum's net profit in the March-end quarter zoomed more than 46% from the comparable period last year, aided by a 69% improvement in gross-refining margins (GRM) during the reported period that did not entirely see the impact of escalating tensions in West Asia, and their impact on fuel supplies. The refiner's net profit accelerated to ₹4,902 crore during the reported quarter from ₹3,355 crore in the comparable period last year.

Oil India net rises 12.5% on better crude price realisation

State-owned explorer Oil India reported net profit in the March-ended quarter rose 12.5% on a year-on-year basis, fuelled by a 5% improvement in average crude price realisation and 6% increase in crude oil production. Standalone profit after tax stood at ₹1,790 crore, against ₹1,591 crore in the year earlier period. Oil India produced 0.891 MMT of crude oil from matured and old oil fields. Its board recommended a dividend of ₹1 for each equity share.

Bharti Airtel posts ₹7,325 cr. Q4 net profit; ARPU flat

Bharti Airtel reported a 39% year-on-year increase in consolidated net profit (before exceptional items) at ₹7,245 crore for the quarter ended March 31, 2026, compared with ₹5,222 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous fiscal. The profits are 34% lower year-on-year if the one-time Indus Towers consolidation last year is taken into account. India business posted quarterly revenues of ₹39,566 crore, an increase of 7.7%.

India-Sri Lanka forum identifies logistics, pharma among six areas for cooperation

Chinmay Rajendrakumar Gaikwad
MUMBAI



Krishan Balendra

The India-Sri Lanka Business Forum, organised by the CII in partnership with the Ceylon Chamber of Commerce in Mumbai, has identified six areas for collaboration: ports, transport and logistics, pharmaceuticals, online payments, travel, and the existing free trade agreement (FTA). Officials from both sides said these sectors offered immediate investment and trade opportunities. The forum offered Indian businesses direct engagement with a Sri Lankan delegation representing diverse industries. This would help the two countries strengthen economic engagement and explore new avenues of cooperation across priority sectors.

Ports and logistics

Krishan Balendra, chairperson of The Ceylon Chamber of Commerce and John Keells Holdings plc, said logistics firms from both countries could form joint ventures for warehousing and cold storage. Transport links, including shipping routes and rail connectivity to Indian ports, were also discussed. Sri Lankan buyers expressed interest in sourcing generic drugs from India's pharma clusters in Mumbai and Pune. Anurag Agarwal, co-chairman of CII WR sub-committee on International Trade & Investment, and CEO of Polycab India, noted that the existing FTA al-

lows zero or low duties on many drug formulations. Both chambers agreed to share lists of registered pharma companies. India's FDA-approved drugs are already trusted in Sri Lanka, and a faster clearance mechanism was proposed. Sri Lanka is also said to explore cross-border digital payment links with India. The Ceylon Chamber stated that UPI-like systems could reduce transaction costs for tourists and traders. Indian fintech firms were invited to pilot such services in Colombo and Kandy. Travel circuits now include electronic visa on arrival for Sri Lankans landing in Mumbai.

FTA review

The existing FTA, covering over 4,000 products, will be reviewed to add pharmaceutical raw materials and logistics equipment. Shiran Fernando, Secretary General and CEO of The Ceylon Chamber, said a joint working group on trade facilitation would meet in August 2026. The forum was addressed by H.E. Maheshini Colonne, High Commissioner of Sri Lanka to India and Duminda Hulangamuwa, Senior Economic Advisor to the President of Sri Lanka among others.

Indian-manned ship owner, operator to pay \$2.25 billion

Highest-ever shipping damages payout against Grace Ocean and Synergy Marine, the owner and operator, respectively, of container ship Dali that rammed into a bridge in Baltimore in 2024

M. Kalyanaraman
CHENNAI

The State of Maryland has reached a \$2.25 billion settlement with Grace Ocean Private Limited and Synergy Marine Pte Ltd., the owner and the operator, respectively, of the Indian-manned container ship Dali that rammed into a bridge in Baltimore in March, 2024.

Maryland Attorney General Anthony Brown said: "This \$2.25 billion settlement reflects the full measure of accountability we were able to secure from the vessel interests - and our pursuit of justice is not finished." This may imply any claims Maryland may pursue against others, such as the manufacturer of the ship.

Synergy sources confirmed the settlement but did not want to discuss insurance contribution. In October, 2024, the federal Department of Justice had settled with the two companies for \$102 million, covering claims from federal agencies.



Cargo ship Dali stuck under a part of the Francis Scott Key Bridge after the ship hit the bridge in March 2024. FILE PHOTO

The total loss, as estimated by the U.S. government, runs to some \$5 billion. Insurance experts had earlier predicted that the Dali accident will equal or surpass the then highest-ever marine insurance payout in the case of the Costa Concordia cruise vessel capsizing in 2012.

Ahead of the settlement announcement, the U.S. Department of Justice (DoJ) said it was pressing criminal charges against Synergy Marine of Singapore, Synergy Maritime of Chennai and their employee Radhakrishnan Kar-

thick Nair, technical superintendent of Dali.

Synergy has, however, disputed the version of the DoJ on the cause of the accident.

According to the department, the accident was largely due to two onboard blackouts before the ship rammed into the bridge. First blackout was allegedly caused by a loose electrical wire and the second allegedly by generators getting starved of fuel and stopping because of the use of a wrong fuel pump.

Synergy has, however, said the root cause of the

accident was the loose electrical wire, attributed to the manufacturer's latent defect. The settlement with the two companies leaves open claims Maryland may have against the manufacturer of the ship, Hyundai Heavy Industries.

Synergy, in a statement, said: "DOJ is criminalising a tragic accident. The DOJ's reference to the vessel's use of the flushing pump is wholly irrelevant to the cause of the allision and runs contrary to the conclusions reached by the U.S. National Transportation Safety Board following a comprehensive 20-month maritime accident investigation. When the allision occurred, the vessel was approximately three ship lengths away from the Francis Scott Key Bridge, transiting at approximately 8.5 knots."

"Both the NTSB and well-respected maritime experts have conclusively determined that the accident was inevitable due to the loose wire, which was in no way attributable to Synergy's operation of the vessel," the statement says.

Air India slashes North America flights by 40%, global network by 27%

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

Air India on Wednesday announced sweeping international schedule cuts between June and August, in-

cluding a nearly 40% reduction in North America operations and significant cuts across SAARC and Southeast Asia, resulting in an overall reduction of about 27% in the air-

line's international network capacity. The airline announced a net reduction of 145 weekly flights across North America, Europe, South East Asia, SAARC and Far East between June

and August 2026. Air India sources said this amounted to an overall 27% reduction in flights. North America, Air India's most critical international market, will see weekly flights reduced

Cabinet approves ₹37,500 cr. package to boost coal gasification

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw briefing the media on the coal gasification scheme.

Providing a fillip to India's pursuit of coal gasification, the Union Cabinet Wednesday approved a ₹37,500-crore package to boost the sustainable alternate mining method.

The package seeking to promote surface coal gasification entails conversion of coal into syngas or synthetic gas, which could also be further used to produce downstream products like urea - about one-fifth of whose requirement is met through imports.

"India's import bill for key substitutable products LNG, urea, ammonium nitrate, ammonia, coking coal, methanol, DME and others stood at approximately ₹2.77 lakh crore in FY2025, a vulnerability further exposed by the ongoing geopolitical situation in West Asia," according to a Cabinet announcement.

With the scheme, India is targeting gasification of approximately 75 million tonnes of coal and lignite. This would contribute to the 100 MT target set for 2030. Further seeking to provide long-term certain-

ty for investment in this sector, the government also extended the coal linkage tenure up to 30 years within an accompanying component of the scheme entailing production of syngas leading to coal gasification.

More importantly though, the scheme would accord a financial incentive of up to one-fifth of the cost of plant and machinery.

In terms of project size, the scheme caps a financial incentive of ₹5,000 crore for a single project, and for any single product-centred project, except that for SNG and urea, it extends up to ₹9,000 crore.

A single entity would be able to avail a maximum of ₹12,000 crore across all project categorisations.

from 51 to 33, a 39% cut. Services on routes such as Delhi-Chicago, Delhi-Newark and Mumbai-New York are being temporarily suspended, although the airline has added four ex-

Mumbai-Newark flights, taking that route to seven weekly services. In Europe, cuts have been made on routes to Paris, Copenhagen, Milan, Vienna, Zurich and Rome.

West Asia conflict hits lubricant industry, 30% cost hike passed on to consumers

Lalatu Mishra
MUMBAI

The lubricant industry has seen the cost of production rising by 50% since the outbreak of the West Asia conflict, making it imperative to pass on part of the extra burden on to consumers, according to an industry leader.

The industry has done it in two phases and already 30% of the higher cost has been passed on to consumers from this month and more hikes are coming.

"The entire petroleum industry was the first to get impacted. The consumers in India have still not got impacted on the fuel prices because of the government control. Since March, for all the companies, the costs have increased by 50%. So, anything that took about ₹100 to make is now costing ₹150," said Nagendra Pai, CEO, Mitul India & South Asia.

"Most of the companies like us purchased more

Anything that took about ₹100 to make is now costing ₹150, says Nagendra Pai, CEO, Mitul India & South Asia

raw material in March and because of that, up till the end of April, the consumers were kind of insulated from a price increase on products," he pointed out.

"From May 1, it is natural that one has to pass on some of the increases. So, there have been price increases. We have passed on about 30% in two tranches to the consumers. But the real impact is yet to come," he said. "Only the first impact has come and [it was] minimal because of the stock in the pipeline," he added. The company on Wednesday unveiled IPONE, a premium French lubricant brand with Japanese DNA. The product is targeted at young bikers riding premium bikes.

TVS Motor Q4 PAT rises 19% to ₹772 crore

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

TVS Motor Company, reported a 19% YoY growth in Q4 consolidated profit after tax (PAT) at ₹772 crore. Revenue grew 30% YoY to ₹15,053 crore. For FY26, the company reported 35% YoY growth in PAT at ₹3,018 crore. Revenue for the year grew 27% to

₹56,070 crore. The board has declared an interim dividend of ₹12 per equity share. The company also allotted four fully paid bonus non-convertible preference shares (NCRPS) having a face value of ₹10 each for every equity share held, amounting to ₹1,900 crore with September 1, 2026 as maturity date.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
INSTITUTE FOR DESIGN OF ELECTRICAL MEASURING INSTRUMENTS, MUMBAI
संशोधन केंद्र सूक्ष्म, मध्यम और बड़े उपकरणों के डिजाइन के लिए
Government Certificate course on
Artificial Intelligence for Film Making and Content Creation
Course Timing: 07.00 PM to 8.00 PM (ऑनलाइन) Date: 18 to 22 May 2026
07.00 PM to 8.00 PM (ऑनलाइन) Course Duration: 5 Days
Email ID: training@idemi.org Website: www.idemi.org Ph: (022) 2405 0301/2/3/4
With hands on practical
Course Fees- 3000+18 % GST (Fees are not refundable)
For Whom: Filmmaker, Director, Content Creator, Cinematographer, Editor, Scriptwriter, Actor, Influencer, Vlogger, Social Media Manager, Students and interested candidates.
After Successful Completion Certificate Will be Issued
Scan QR Code for Registration & Fees Payment
Contact-9403566219, 8007765693, 9869087617

राष्ट्रीय समुद्र प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान
NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF OCEAN TECHNOLOGY
(पृथ्वी विज्ञान मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)
(Ministry of Earth Sciences, Government of India)
रासग्रीव परिसर, वेलच्येरी-तांबारम मेन रोड, पल्लिकरगे, चेन्नई - 600 100
NIOT Campus, Velachery-Tambaram Main Road, Pallikarai, Chennai - 600 100
Ph.:91-44-6678 3300 E-mail: recruitment@niot.res.in
ADVERTISEMENT No. NIOT/E&P/03/2026 (Apprenticeship)
WALK-IN INTERVIEW on 10.06.2026 (10.00 AM to 01.00 PM)
AN OPPORTUNITY TO UNDERGO
APPRENTICESHIP TRAINING IN NIOT, CHENNAI
National Institute of Ocean Technology (NIOT), an institution under Earth System Sciences Council (ESSC), an autonomous body under the Ministry of Earth Sciences, Govt. of India, invites applications for engagement as Apprentice under Apprentices Act 1961.
For detailed advertisement, viz. the disciplines in which the apprentices are to be engaged and educational qualification, etc., please visit NIOT website link: https://www.niot.res.in/recruitment_details.php
Interested and eligible applicants may participate in the Walk-in-Interview on the above mentioned date and time.

BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer,
Yelahanka Division, Bengaluru - 560064.
No: BNCC/EE/YNK.D/KPPP/04/2026-27 Date: 13-05-2026
INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT) - (SHORT TERM)
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only)
The Executive Engineer, Yelahanka Division, BNCC, Bengaluru invites Tenders from eligible Tenderers for the Works detailed below. (Standard Tender Document - KW-04)
Sl. No. Name of the Work / Category
1 Providing Thermoplastic Painting for Rumber Strips, Lane Markings, Junction Markings, Different Type of Sign Boards, Pelican Signals and Kerb Stone, HRPD and Other Safety Furniture's as per Traffic Police Requests in Yelahanka Division. (2nd Call) - Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 140.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 2,10,000.00
2 Establishment of Temporary Control Room for Monsoon Period in 2026 in Yelahanka Old Town Sub Division. (2nd Call) - (CAT-II (A)) - Estimated Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 7.50, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 9,375.00
Calendar of Events: 1) The Tender Document can be Downloaded from the GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Website: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in 2) Date of Pre Bid Meeting on 18-05-2026 at 15.00 Hours. 3) Last Date and Time for Receipt of Tenders: 22-05-2026 upto 16.00 Hours. 4) Date of Opening of Technical Bid: 25-05-2026 after 16.00 Hours. Further details can be had from the above office.
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Yelahanka Division, BNCC.

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
Tender Notice No.: DRMEGGRNC-37-2026, Dated: 11.05.2026, Divisional Railway Manager (Engg), South Eastern Railway, Ranchi for & on behalf of President of India, invites e-Tender for the following works:
Notice No.: DRMEGGRNC-37-2026, Name of work: Chandil-Muri-Barkakana Jn (SL) section : Conversion of stone-set bridges (18 Nos.) into RCC Box bridges with flat top under the jurisdiction of DEN (East) Ranchi. Tender Value: ₹ 10,69,12,424.48, EMD Value: ₹ 21,38,300/-. Tender closing date & time: 29.05.2026 at 15.00 hrs. Tenderers can visit the website www.ireps.gov.in for online tendering. (PR-163)

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
प्र. सं. WB-74/WO/04/06/2026 दिनांक: 08.05.2026
मंडल रेल प्रबंधक, इलीनियरग, उत्तर पश्चिम रेलवे, जोधपुर द्वारा भारत के राष्ट्रपति के लिये पर जनकी और से ई-निविदा के माध्यम से प्रचलित नियमों के अनुसार निविदा प्रपत्रों में निविदा निम्न कार्य के लिए क्रमानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है। ई-निविदा सूचना सं. 2026-27 : 31/05/2026-27 कार्य का नाम व स्थान : Supplying 65 mm gauge hard stone machine crushed railway track ballast in stacks and loading in to railway ballast hoppers at PARIHARA ballast depot under ADEN/Degana of Jodhpur Division. अनुमानित लागत रुपये : 84731670.00 रुपये की राशि रुपये : 1694600.00 निविदा सूचना सं. 31/05/2026-27 निविदा प्रस्तुत करने की तिथि 01.06.2026 को 15.00 बजे तक) जेबार्डई का विवरण जहाँ पर ई-निविदा देखी व मरी जा सकती है - www.ireps.gov.in 692-CQ/26
Follow us on: f t i c NWRRailways NWRRailways

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Dy. CEE (W), NWR, Ajmer on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tender for the following work up to 15.00 Hrs. on the mention date. Tender No. : E/5023/2025-26PT Name of work : Ajmer-Augmentation of Ancillaries shop with Load Bearing Covered shed with Solar Panel including CMT lab Improvement and Digitization in HQ and Carriage Workshop Ajmer. Approximate cost : Rs. 18218436.98/- Earnest money : Rs. 364400/- Date & Time of closing of E-Tender : 22.05.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. and 22.05.2026 at 15.30 Hrs. The details of above E-Tender is available on website : www.ireps.gov.in 696-D/26
Follow us on: f t i c NWRRailways NWRRailways

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
Tender Notice No.: MECHCKP-26-27-10, Date: 12.05.2026. For and on behalf of President of India, Divisional Railway Manager (Mechanical), South Eastern Railway, Chakradharpur invites E-tender under Two Packet System for the under mentioned work. Manual offers are not allowed against the tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. Name of work: Housekeeping and depot premises cleaning at Tatanagar, Adityapur, Jharsuguda & Dangoasopi for a period of 02 years under open tender. Tender Value: ₹ 3,64,41,116.45. Bid Security: ₹ 3,32,200/-. Cost of tender form: ₹ 10,000/-. Place of opening of tender: Office of the Sr.DME/Chakradharpur, South Eastern Railway. Date and time of closing of tender: 15.00 hrs. of 03.06.2026. Tender can be viewed at website http://www.ireps.gov.in The tenderer/bidder must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered under IREPS portal. Only registered tenderer/bidder can participate on e-Tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. (PR-167)

CENTRAL RAILWAY
e-Tender (OPEN TENDER) Notice No. CAOC-02-2026 Dated 07.05.2026
Chief Administrative Officer (Const.), Central Railway, 6th floor, New Administrative Building, D. N. Road, CSMT, Mumbai -400 001, for and on behalf of President of India invites open tenders e-tendering on IREPS website (e-tender portal). www.ireps.gov.in (In Two Packet System), from reputed Contractors for the following work: Name of Work: Request for Proposal (RFP) for Engagement of Detailed Design Consultant (DDC) for "Providing services related to structural designs for New line, Doubling, 3rd & 4th line projects, Road Over Bridges and Road Under Bridges etc. including station buildings, FOBs, PF shelters and other ancillary structures" for projects of Construction Organization under CAO/Con/Central Railway, CSMT, Mumbai. Tender Value: Rs. 11,06,87,602.00 Bid Security: Rs. 22,13,800.00/- Cost of Tender Form: Not Applicable (As per Clause No.3 at Page 4 of GCC APRIL 2022) Validity of offer: 120 days from the date of opening of Tender. Completion period: 36 months of Construction Period and 06 months of Defects Liability Period. Availability of Tender documents: Available on the website www.ireps.gov.in. Date & Time of Submission & Opening of Tenders: The e-tenders duly completed in all respects, along with the requisite documents, should be uploaded electronically on the above mentioned website, up to 15.00 hrs. on 18.06.2026. The tender (Technical Bid only) will be opened online on the same day after 15.00 hrs. Joint Venture (JV) firms/Consortiums (maximum permissible is 3 members each) will be allowed to participate in this tender. Important Note to Tenderers: a) The tendering will be solely through e-tendering only. All intending tenderers need to First register with IREPS website www.ireps.gov.in. b) Prospective tenderer/s are advised that before submitting their offer electronically, they should refer to the Tender details regarding terms and conditions, eligibility criteria, etc. c) Tender documents & corrigendum issued from time to time are available on the website mentioned above. Changes, if any, would be posted on this website at least 15 days in advance of opening of tender and may be seen on this website. For any additional information/clarification contact on the above address Dy. Chief Engineer(C)/Design, Central Railway, Mob.No.8828110262 on any working day between 10.00 hours to 17.30 hrs. Note:- If there is any difference between the Hindi and English versions in any kind of words, terms and conditions etc. under the e-tender notice, then in case the English version of the e-tender notice will be considered final and will be applicable. [45]
Travel safely, Avoid footboard travelling

Russia renews hardline demands for ending war, rules out ceasefire



Israeli drones hit highway south of Beirut, killing 12, including children



Netanyahu's office says he visited UAE secretly during the Iran war



Gunshots at Philippine Senate as lawmaker wanted by ICC holds out



King's speech outlines U.K. govt. agenda as Starmer's future hangs in the balance

Trump to begin talks with Xi on Iran war, trade, U.S. arms sales

In Qom, Indian volunteers serving sharbat amid war fears and protests

MILESTONE MAN

Kohli becomes first Indian batter to score 14,000 runs in T20s



Virat Kohli on Wednesday became the first Indian to score 14,000 runs in T20 cricket, achieving the feat in the IPL 2026 clash between RCB and KKR in Raipur. He is the sixth batter — after Chris Gayle, Kieron Pollard, Alex Hales, David Warner and Jos Buttler — to cross the mark in the shortest format.

CHAMPION PLAYER

Bumrah is a fantastic person to be around: fellow MI pacer Bosch



Bumrah is probably one of the calmer people I've met. He knows that he hasn't been at his best, but he is a class above the rest. You can see the standards he sets for himself; he's still among the best in the competition in terms of economy. He's a fantastic cricketer, a fantastic person to be around — Corbin Bosch on Jasprit Bumrah.

OPPORTUNITY

Chennai Super Kings ropes in Noronha in place of Ramakrishna



CSK has signed Karnataka's Macneil Noronha as a replacement for the injured Ramakrishna Ghosh. Noronha will join CSK for ₹30 lakh. The all-rounder was recently awarded the M.A. Chidambaram Trophy at the Naman awards for being the highest run-getter in the 2024-25 Col. C.K. Nayudu Trophy.

MORE WOES

Injured Super Kings pacer Overton to return to the UK



Chennai Super Kings all-rounder Jamie Overton, who has a right thigh injury, will be returning to the UK for further assessment and management, the team said on Wednesday. It is another blow for the Super Kings who have grappled with injury issues in IPL 2026 as the Englishman was one of the star performers with 14 scalps.

Kohli's masterful knock powers Royal Challengers to the top

The Bengaluru opener, who was dismissed for a duck in the last two games, roars back with an unbeaten century to guide his side to a facile win over Knight Riders; his 92-run partnership with Padikkal puts the home team on the road to victory

IPL-19

Anish Pathiyil
RAIPUR

Awristy flick past mid-on off his second ball, and all the doubts about Virat Kohli's lack of runs vanished into thin air.

The Royal Challengers Bengaluru veteran, who was dismissed for nought in the last two encounters, stamped his class at the Shaheed Veer Narayan Singh Stadium here on Wednesday. His calculated unbeaten 105 helped the side overhaul Kolkata Knight Riders' 192 for four with five balls to spare.

The pursuit began with fluency despite the early dismissal of Jacob Bethell, who was caught and bowled after pulling a shot into his helmet.

Kohli's positive start at the other end rubbed off on Devdutt Padikkal as the southpaw struck two consecutive boundaries. The Knight Riders did not help their case with two dropped catches. Kohli's fierce slap through covers burst through the fingers of Rovman Powell, while Vaibhav Arora was guilty of dropping a dolly, offered by Padikkal, at deep square-leg.

The duo's 92-run association ended when the No. 3 batter carved one straight to skipper Ajinkya Rahane at cover. But the break in momentum made no difference to Kohli, who pressed on the accelerator to get to his ninth IPL century and seal RCB's eighth win.

Earlier, after KKR was asked to bat first on a pitch that was under covers for a considerable period, open-



Marauder: Kohli's ninth IPL hundred contained 11 fours and three sixes. EMMANUAL YOGINI

ers Rahane and Finn Allen fell after brisk starts. Bhuvneshwar Kumar removed Allen with a length ball that cramped him for room and forced an edge to the wicketkeeper. Rahane was undone by a Josh Hazlewood bouncer that

skidded through. Angkrish Raghuvanshi managed to keep the runs flowing with boundaries through the leg-side as Cameron Green settled in. The acceleration came after the introduction of the lone spinner, Krunal

Pandya, with the duo collecting two towering sixes over midwicket. But Green was castled by Rasikh Salam after a 68-run partnership. Raghuvanshi looked largely untroubled en route to a 32-ball half-century, his

SCOREBOARD

KOLKATA KNIGHT RIDERS
Ajinkya Rahane c & b Hazlewood 19 (13b, 3x4, 1x6), Finn Allen c Jitesh b Bhuvneshwar 18 (8b, 3x4, 1x6), Angkrish Raghuvanshi run out 71 (46b, 7x4, 3x6), Cameron Green b Rasikh 32 (24b, 3x4, 1x6), Rinku Singh (not out) 49 (29b, 3x4, 2x6); Extras (lb-1, w-2); 3; Total (for four wkts. in 20 overs): 192.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-23 (Allen, 2.3 overs), 2-48 (Rahane, 4.4), 3-116 (Green, 12.2), 4-192 (Raghuvanshi, 19.6).

RCB BOWLING
Bhuvneshwar 4-0-34-1, Duffy 4-0-48-0, Hazlewood 4-0-35-1, Rasikh 4-0-35-1, Krunal 4-0-39-0.

ROYAL CHALLENGERS
Jacob Bethell c & b Tyagi 15 (12b, 2x4, 1x6), Virat Kohli (not out) 105 (60b, 11x4, 3x6), Devdutt Padikkal (Impact Player for Duffy) c Rahane b Tyagi 39 (27b, 7x4), Rajat Patidar c Rahane b Narine 11 (8b, 1x6), Tim David c Pandey b Tyagi 2 (3b), Jitesh Sharma (not out) 8 (5b, 1x4); Extras (lb-4, w-10); 14; Total (for four wkts. in 19.1 overs): 194.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-37 (Bethell, 3.2), 2-129 (Padikkal, 13.1), 3-157 (Patidar, 15.6), 4-180 (David, 17.5).

KNIGHT RIDERS BOWLING
Saurabh Dubey (Impact Player for Allen) 2.1-0-21-0, Vaibhav 4-0-48-0, Tyagi 4-0-32-3, Narine 4-0-31-1, Green 2-0-22-0, Anukul 3-0-36-0.

Toss: RCB; PoM: Kohli.
RCB won by six wickets with five deliveries to spare.

Next assignment

KKR: May 16 vs. GT
Kolkata, 7.30 p.m.

RCB: May 17 vs. PBKS
Dharamshala, 3.30 p.m.

Misfiring PBKS faces MI, aims to snap four-game losing run

Abhishek Saini
DHARAMSHALA

Punjab Kings will be desperate for a turnaround when it takes on Mumbai Indians in an IPL 2026 fixture at the HPCA Stadium here on Thursday.

After leading the standings for nearly four weeks, PBKS slumped to fourth place on the back of four straight defeats. Another slip-up will leave it in a scrap for the final playoffs spot.

Fifties from skipper Shreyas Iyer and Priyansh Arya against Delhi Capitals were reminiscent of the batting flourish that was the backbone of Kings' early success.

But its bowling lapses continue to cost it.

PBKS leaked 73 runs off four overs at the death against the Capitals, and has the worst economy rate in this phase this season (11.66).

The silver lining, though, has been Arshdeep Singh delivering again up-front. He has three wickets at an economy of 8.15 in the last three games after a horrid run which got him just four wickets in eight games before that.

"Arshdeep is a terrific cricketer. And these big cricketers rise at the right moment. I think now is the right time and our coach Ricky Ponting always speaks of peaking at the right time, at the back-end



Fingers crossed: After rain curtailed training, Kings and Mumbai Indians will hope weather doesn't affect the match. R.V. MOORTHY

Today's match

Dharamshala, 7.30 p.m.

HEAD-TO-HEAD

Played: 35

PBKS 18 | MI 17

PREVIOUS MEETING

PBKS won by seven wickets, 2026

LIVE ON STAR SPORTS 1 & JIHOOTSTAR

jab to get its act together against a Mumbai Indians side that is already out of the reckoning for the playoffs.

Its listless run was already a mood dampener this season, and MI has been handed another cruel blow with stand-in captain Suryakumar Yadav unavailable for the game.

The best chance MI has of getting out of its rut is to take on the misfiring Punjab bowlers.

Ryan Rickelton and Rohit Sharma have nailed their role in setting the pace this year, adding 380 runs in six innings at a run rate of 11.76.

of the tournament," Punjab Kings' assistant bowling coach Trevor Gonzalves said.

Odds would favour Pun-

Profligate bowling and shoddy fielding hurting Punjab Kings

S. Shrivathsan

Punjab Kings, a team that looked like an unstoppable force about three weeks ago, is now struggling to get a 'W' next to its name.

In a matter of a few matches, PBKS, which made a rousing start to IPL 2026, has seen its cracks exposed. The Shreyas Iyer-led side masked its weaknesses by consistently out-batting opponents in the first half of the 19th edition, but since the time the rivals uncovered them, the Punjab outfit has been on a downward spiral.

The 2025 runner-up has plenty of holes to plug in the bowling and fielding departments. The bowlers have leaked runs at approximately 10.6 runs per over, the worst average economy rate in the league as of Tuesday. Kings have conceded 200 or more seven times already this season, besides the 195 they gave away against Mumbai Indians.

Wicket-taking is another area that requires immediate repair. Only left-arm pacer Arshdeep Singh (13) has scalped 10 or more so far. Compared to the rest of



Not sharp enough: Jansen's bowling has lacked bite this season. R.V. MOORTHY

the top-four teams — Gujarat Titans, Royal Challengers Bengaluru and Sunrisers Hyderabad — that have at least three bowlers with 10 or more scalps, PBKS has been well behind par.

Arshdeep, despite being the side's top wicket-taker, is battling for consistency, while his pace partner Marco Jansen has hardly posed a threat. Leggie Yuzvendra Chahal is not trusted enough in spite of being the lone specialist spinner for most part of the campaign.

Poor fielding, especially dropped catches which have proved harmful, has also massively contributed to PBKS' downfall. If Kings' butter-fingered fielders had come up with an improved show against Sunrisers Hyderabad and Delhi Capitals, the team may not find itself in the dire situation it is in now.

PBKS has to act quick and smart if it harbours hopes of advancing to the playoffs.

Rabada in rhythm and Titans on the rise

Pranay Rajiv
AHMEDABAD

Kagiso Rabada could hit the good length with his eyes closed. Probably.

His ability to consistently zone in on that part of the pitch, at high pace, has been the cornerstone of his reputation as one of the best pacers in the world.

In IPL 2026, Gujarat Titans has leaned heavily on Rabada's metronomic skillset to seize an early advantage with the ball.

The South African pacer has already claimed 16 wickets in the PowerPlay in IPL 2026. Only one bowler has ever taken more such wickets in an IPL season — Mohammed Shami (17) in 2023.

On Tuesday, Rabada

once again delivered the decisive opening knockout punch. He snared three vital wickets in the PowerPlay to derail Sunrisers Hyderabad's chase and set Titans on the way to a massive win.

Rabada and his new-ball partner, Mohammed Siraj, bowled unchanged through the PowerPlay, persisting with a nagging off-stump line.

The Titans duo maximised the dampness of the Ahmedabad surface by targeting the hard lengths, often slanting deliveries away from the all-leave SRH top order.

It was an exhibition of unerring pace bowling by two of its best exponents in modern-day cricket. This has been a recurring theme for Titans in IPL



Rabada. VIJAY SONEJI

2026, particularly at their home ground in Ahmedabad.

"Siraj and Rabada have been hitting their lengths very well. That is the advantage of having proper

Points table

	M	W	L	NR	PTS	NRR
Royal Challengers	12	8	4	0	16	1.053
Gujarat Titans	12	8	4	0	16	0.551
Sunrisers Hyderabad	12	7	5	0	14	0.331
Punjab Kings	11	6	4	1	13	0.428
Chennai Super Kings	11	6	5	0	12	0.185
Rajasthan Royals	11	6	5	0	12	0.082
Delhi Capitals	12	5	7	0	10	-0.993
Kolkata Knight Riders	11	4	6	1	9	-0.198
Mumbai Indians (E)	11	3	8	0	6	-0.585
Lucknow Super Giants (E)	11	3	8	0	6	-0.907

E: Eliminated

Test bowlers," pointed out GT spinner R. Sai Kishore.

In IPL, rarely do pacers get the right conditions to utilise this Test-match length. When they do, like on Tuesday, it allows them to strike up something important - rhythm.

"Rhythm is everything," explained Rabada after receiving the Player of the Match award on Tuesday. When a bowler like Rabada enters that flow state, it is inevitably perilous for opposition batters, as SRH found out.

Sreejesh no longer National junior coach

The former goalkeeper questions the preference for foreigners; asks why home-grown coaches aren't chosen to develop Indian hockey

HOCKEY

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

A Junior World Cup (JWC) medal after nine years apparently isn't good enough for Hockey India with the federation deciding not to renew P.R. Sreejesh's appointment as the chief coach.

Sreejesh, who was handed charge of the junior men's side soon after his retirement post the Paris Olympics, had been without contract since December 2025. India won bronze playing at home, its first medal since the 2016 title triumph.

"It seems like my coaching career comes to an end after 1.5 years, during which we played five tournaments and secured five podium finishes, including a Junior World Cup bronze medal. "I have heard about coaches getting fired after bad performances. But this is the first time I am experiencing being removed to make way for a foreign coach... can't Indian coaches develop Indian hockey?" Sreejesh questioned in a social media post on Wednesday.

"(Hockey India president) Dilip Tirkey told me that Craig Fulton prefers a foreign coach because it will help in coordination and developing a streamlined, uniform structure between junior and senior sides. I only want to know



Fruitful stint: India finished on the podium all five times when Sreejesh was at the helm. FILE PHOTO: G. MOORTHY

why he cannot coordinate with an Indian coach?" Sreejesh told *The Hindu*.

"I was told, 'we need someone experienced' but did they not think of it when they first gave me the responsibility? I had zero experience back then! Then they said, 'we will give you the development side' but doesn't lack of experience matter for the development side and do we even have a well-defined one?" Sreejesh further questioned.

While HI hasn't made any official announce-

ment, it has been learnt that the federation has expressed its preference for Frenchman Aymeric Bergamo, who led France to third place at the 2021 JWC.

Bergamo in contention Interestingly, that is the only achievement with a national team for Bergamo, who has since been associated with various European club sides. Hockey India officials refused to speak on the matter with secretary-general Bhola Nath Singh saying, "I do not wish to comment".

Hockey India refutes Sreejesh's charges

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

Hockey India (HI) on Wednesday refuted the charges made by former India goalkeeper P.R. Sreejesh over his removal as the head coach of the junior national team.

Stating that Sreejesh's coaching term officially concluded as per contract in December 2025, it said as per protocol, the position was advertised and applicants were shortlisted and finalised as per a proper merit-based selection process.

"A coach with distinguished qualification has been selected as a result of this process and will be announced shortly," the HI said in a statement.

"We had offered Sreejesh the position of coach of the development team... this would have furthered his experience and exposure as a coach.

"However, he did not accept this position despite being asked to reconsider the decision. In no terms has it ever been conveyed to him that there has been any preference for a foreign coach by the chief coach," the HI further said.

"We are collectively working towards the vision of our government to build a pathway towards 2036 and a big part of that process is to develop our Indian coaching talent.

"Development of the grassroots and home-grown coaches has always been central to the interests of Hockey India as a national sports federation."

In a first in Indian squash, National coach Harinderpal dons player's hat

K. Keerthivasan
CHENNAI

Since taking over as the coach of the Indian senior squash teams in September last year, Harinderpal Singh Sandhu has been busy designing training camps for the country's top players and mentoring them.

But the 37-year-old has put the player's hat on again, partnering youngster Om Semwal in the men's section of the National doubles championships here. It is the first time in Indian squash history that a National team head coach is competing in an open National event.

Cyrus Poncha, secretary of the Squash Rackets Federation of India, said there was nothing wrong with Harinder's involvement as a player in the tournament.

"Harinder sought per-



Bracing for action: Harinderpal and Om get ready for the challenge ahead. R. RAGU

mission to participate. We've got to remember that at the 2022 Asian Games, he won the mixed doubles gold medal with Dipika Pallikal. I would see it more as a positive experience that he can offer other players. Even if he wins the tournament, he will not be considered for selection," said Poncha.

Harinder entered the doubles championships with Om after his original partner, Ramit Tandon, withdrew because of injury. He, however, could not take the court on Wednesday as Jinash and Reyansh handed Harinder and Om a walkover.

Harinder, who has largely limited himself to spar-

ring sessions since becoming a coach, is excited to compete again. "I want to share my experience with everyone. Doubles tournaments don't really happen throughout the year," he said.

Meanwhile, all seeded pairs across categories were handed first-round byes.

The results: Men: Round of 16: Shubham & Vedant Patel bt Akashay Deepak & Parthiban 11-8, 10-12, 11-2; Matthew Godwin & Navaneeth Prabhu bt Vidik Karkashe & Yash Sonwani 11-4, 11-6; Ravi Dixit & Vikas Mehra bt Ajinkya Shinde & Omkar Avhad 11-3, 11-4; Guhan Senthilkumar & P.R. Sandhesh bt Naman Surana & Pranav Agarwal 11-1, 11-2; Harinderpal Singh & Om Semwal w/o Jinash & Reyansh.

Women: Group B (round robin): Janet Vidhi & Pooja Arthi bt Kriya Saravanan & Nandikasree (ret'd). **Mixed: Round of 16:** Ravi Dixit & Janet Vidhi bt R. Dinesh & Ananya Narayan 4-11, 11-5, 11-8.

Five Indians advance in singles at Thailand Open

Press Trust of India
BANGKOK

P.V. Sindhu, Lakshya Sen and K. Srikanth progressed to the singles second round on a mixed day for India at the \$500,000 Thailand Open Super 500 badminton on Wednesday.

The results: Men: K. Srikanth bt Loh Kean Yew (Sgp) 21-14, 21-15; Kodai Naraoka (Jpn) bt Ayush Shetty 21-13, 17-21, 21-4; Koki Watanabe (Jpn) bt Tharun Manneppalli 21-12, 21-16; Lakshya Sen bt Jason Teh (Sgp) 21-16, 21-17; **Women:** P.V. Sindhu bt Tung Ciou-Tong (Tpe) 21-9, 21-12;

Pornpawee Chochuwong (Tha) bt Unnati Hooda 11-21, 21-17, 21-16; Chen Yu Fei (Chn) bt Anmol Kharb 19-21, 21-13, 21-18; Hina Akechi (Jpn) bt Tanvi Sharma 21-17, 21-8; Devika Sihag bt Natsuki Nidaira (Jpn) 21-19, 13-21, 21-15; Malvika Bansod bt Wen Yu Zhang (Can) 13-21, 26-24, 21-13; Thalita Wiryawan (Ina) bt Isharani Baruah 15-21, 21-19, 21-15.

Mixed doubles: Tsai Fu Cheng & Sung Yu-Hsuan (Tpe) bt Ashith Surya & Amrutha Pramuthesh 24-22, 21-11; Mathias Christiansen & Alexandra Boje (Den) bt Tanisha Crasto & Dhruv Kapila 21-9, 21-15; Supak Jomkoh & Ornricha Jongsathapornparn (Tha) bt Rohan Kapoor & Ruthvika Gadde 21-15, 21-10.



Easily done: Sindhu took out Ciou-Tong in quick time. INSTAGRAM@BAL_MEDIA

Metro Railway, Kolkata

e-Tender is invited by Principal Chief Engineer, Metro Railway for the following work: **Name of work:** Renovation of 4th floor and outside of 58 C.R. Avenue in Central Metro Station (RITES Building) of Metro Railway, Kolkata. **Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 97,01,572.04. **Earnest Money :** Rs. 1,94,000. **Completion Period:** 12 (Twelve) Months, **Date and Time of Closing:** 09.06.2026 at 12:00 Hrs. The Tender Document and other details can be obtained from the website www.ireps.gov.in Amendments/Corrigendum, if any, would be uploaded only on the website.

Abridged e-Tender Notice No. : Civil-2561-2026-(Open)

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Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
71	SE/Mech.Maint II TTPS	Unit 1 210 MW LMW Turbine Supply of second hand HP LP by pass system complete assembly of 210MW
26	SE/GTS	Procurement of Transformer oil

For details of works/Procurement/Due date of submission/Opening/viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: www.tnpdcl.org, www.tenders.in.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in
DIPR/1885/TENDER/2026

Government of Karnataka

DEPARTMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION

6th Floor, 2nd Stage, M.S. Building,
Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Veedhi, Bangalore-560 001.

No. ED/56/UBV/2026(Part-1) Date: 13.05.2026

PUBLIC NOTIFICATION

Selection of Vice-Chancellor of Bangalore University, Bangalore

The Higher Education Department, Government of Karnataka invites application for the selection of Vice –Chancellor of Bangalore University, Bangalore as per section 14(2) of Karnataka State University Act 2000 from eligible and distinguished Academicians/Professors. Applications should be submitted within 30 days (including general holidays) from the date of this advertisement to the "Secretary to Government, Higher Education Department, 6th Floor, Gate No. 03, Room No. 601 (R & I Section), M S Building, Bengaluru 560001". Soft copy of the application in PDF format should be sent to email : busearchcommittee2026@gmail.com. The application form is available on Higher Education Department website <https://hed.karnataka.gov.in>.

Sd/-
Secretary to Government
Department of Higher Education

DIPR/CP/630/Zen/2026-27

SOUTHERN RAILWAY

Construction Organization, Ernakulam Jn.
Tender Notice No. 09-CE-CN-ERS-2026-OT Dated : 08.05.2026

Name of work : Conducting Final Location Survey (FLS)/Detailed field survey for the following :

i. Final location survey for 3rd line between TVC-NCJ & Other New Line / Doubling / future projects including soil investigations

ii. Detailed field survey & preparation of drawing & documents including soil investigation for AFK-Sabari New Line

iii. Detailed field survey & preparation of drawing & documents including soil investigation for AMPA-TUVR doubling section under the jurisdiction of CAO/CN/ERS.

Tender Value : Rs. 3088.36 Lakhs
Bid Security : Rs. 61,76,700/-
Completion Period : 24 Months

Date and time of tender closing : 09.06.2026, 15.00 hrs.

Complete details and tender document will be available at <https://www.ireps.gov.in>
Chief Engineer / Construction,
Ernakulam Jn.

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd. (UPRVUNL)

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

UPRVUNL invites Expression of Interest (EOI) for an integrated ERP solution with AI/ analytics to automate and manage its core business and operational processes.

- The project scope includes supply, implementation, migration, integration, testing, and commissioning of the AI enabled ERP system along with an enterprise-grade database platform.
- The solution will cover ERP-IMSS (Integrated Modular Software Solution) integration and all required functional modules for efficient management of UPRVUNL's business operations.

Submission Deadline: 30.05.2026 – 5:00 PM

For detailed information and submission of EoI, interested parties may contact:

Website: www.uprvunl.org |
Email: cpm.pragati@uprvunl.org |
Mob: 9415900616

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SOUTHERN RAILWAY

Chennai Division (Mechanical Branch)
GEM Bid No. GEM/2026/B/7484152 Date : 11.05.2026

Divisional Railway Manager / Mechanical Branch / Chennai Division, Chennai - 600 003 for and on behalf of the President of India Invites ONLINE tenders for the following work as per tender notice given in the GeM Portal <https://gem.gov.in>. The tenderer(s) / Contractor(s) intending to apply for GeM-tender for Mechanical works in Chennai Division, need to get enrolled in the e-tender portal <https://gem.gov.in> and only online tenders will be accepted.

Description : Comprehensive Cleaning work at Perambur, Avadi, Tiruvallur, Tiruttani and Ambur Stations for 730 days and Perambur, Avadi, Tiruvallur, Tiruttani, Ambur, Mathews colony, RPM Colony, Washermanpet, Salt Cotarus, Tondiarpet colonies for 626 days i.e., excluding Sunday on an outcome basis for a period of 2 years.

Location	Chennai
Advertised tender Value in	Rs. 11,71,46,539.82/-
Earnest Money Deposit in	Rs. 7,35,730/-
Similar Nature of work	Applicable
Period of completion in months	24 Months

Tender closing date and time 01.06.2026 @ 15.00 hrs. Details of value of tender, EMD are given in GeM portal <https://gem.gov.in>
For details bid submission please refer to web portal <https://gem.gov.in>

Divisional Railway Manager (Mechanical),
Chennai Division, Southern Railway, Chennai - 600 003.

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INBRIEF



Gyaneshwari bags two medals at Asian senior weightlifting

India's Gyaneshwari Yadav won two medals in the 53kg category at the 2026 Asian senior weightlifting championships in Gandhinagar on Wednesday. Gyaneshwari won a silver in the snatch section with a lift of 88kg and an overall bronze in the event with a combined lift of 194kg. The gold was claimed by Jinlan Zhao of China with total lift of 216kg, while silver went to Vietnam's Hoai Huong Nguyen (total 195kg).

East Bengal retains the IWL crown

East Bengal successfully defended its Indian Women's League (IWL) title after the match between Sethu FC and SESA FA ended in a 1-1 draw in Kolkata on Tuesday. Later in the day, East Bengal eased past Nita Football Academy 2-0 with Soumya Guguloth bagging a brace. Gokulam Kerala FC secured a 1-0 win over Sribhumi FC. Following the conclusion of Matchday 12, champion East Bengal sits at the top with 33 points. Sethu occupies the second spot with 23 while Kickstart follows in third with 19 points.

Real president Perez calls club elections, to stand again

Real Madrid president Florentino Perez on Tuesday called club elections and announced he would stand again. "I am not going to resign," the 79-year-old said. Perez justified his bid for a new term in response to what he dubbed an "absurd campaign" against Real Madrid.



History-maker Sawe to take part in Berlin Marathon

Kenya's Sabastian Sawe, who became the first person to run a marathon in under two hours, will compete in the Berlin Marathon on Sept. 27, organisers said on Wednesday. The 31-year-old Kenyan smashed the previous World record when he ran the London Marathon in 1h 59m 30s in April wearing a new model of super shoes. Sawe won the last Berlin Marathon in 2:02:16.



Eye on the prize: Scheffler is keen to get back to the top. AP

'Bittersweet' runner-up run inspires Scheffler

PGA CHAMPIONSHIP

Agence France-Presse
PHILADELPHIA

Top-ranked defending champion Scottie Scheffler has turned "bittersweet" feelings over three consecutive runner-up finishes into inspiration ahead of the PGA Championship beginning on Thursday.

The 29-year-old American captured his 20th career PGA Tour crown at the American Express in January. Since then, however, Scheffler has had to settle for second place at the Masters, Heritage and Doran tournaments.

The results left him somewhat pleased yet unsatisfied. "I would say that they were a little bittersweet," Scheffler said. "Finishing second hurts. But when you're looking at things to work on, there's a lot less to clean up when you're finishing second than when you're 30th."

With four titles and 16 top-10 finishes in his last 20 major starts, Scheffler has arrived at Aronimink well prepared to add to his trophy cabinet. Scheffler and second-ranked Rory McIlroy have together won four of the past five majors, but they never had a Sunday battle down the back nine for a title victory.

Itisha rallies to down Pooja in 76kg final

World under-23 bronze medallist Nishu posts a 9-3 win over Himanshi to take the 53kg crown; World championships participant Vaishnavi gets the better of Anjali to clinch the 62kg title

WRESTLING

Y.B. Sarangi
NANDINI NAGAR (U.P.)

Young Itisha Choudhary warded off a strong challenge from Pooja to take home the women's 76kg gold medal at the senior Open ranking wrestling tournament on the Nandini Nagar Mahavidyalaya campus.

In a keenly fought final bout, Itisha took a one-point lead before Pooja levelled the scores.

Itisha gathered two more points to reclaim her advantage and used her strong defence to emerge the winner.

World under-23 bronze medallist Nishu posted a 9-3 victory over Himanshi to take the 53kg crown.

In 57kg, where Vinesh Phogat had registered but



Complete dominance: Reena, right, recorded a 10-2 victory over Kajal in the 57kg title bout. SANDEEP SAXENA

could not participate after being rendered ineligible by Wrestling Federation of India (WFI), World under-20 silver medallist Reena emerged the champion.

In a one-sided final, Reena recorded a 10-2 victory over Kajal Choudhary.

World championships

participant Vaishnavi Patil (62kg) defeated Anjali 8-6 to claim the yellow metal in another Olympic weight class.

The results (finals):

Women: 50kg: Ankush (Har) bt Rachana (Har) 4-3; 53kg: Nishu (Har) bt Himanshi (Har) 9-3. 55kg: Nisha (Har) bt Naina (Har)

10-8; 57kg: Reena (Har) bt Kajal Choudhary (U.P.) 10-2; 59kg: Sito (Har) bt Simran (Har) 10-2; 62kg: Vaishnavi Patil (Mah) bt Anjali (Har) 8-6; 65kg: Anjali (Chd) bt Dishun (Har) 10-0.

68kg: Anshu (Har) bt Bhateri (SSCB) 16-6; 72kg: Bipasha (Del) bt Riya Kaushik (Har) by fall; 76kg: Itisha Choudhary (UP) bt Pooja (Har) 3-1.

Tyagi and Manish move into the last-eight stage of ATP Challenger

TENNIS

Ashwin Achal
BENGALURU

Kriish Tyagi and Manish Sureshkumar kept the Indian hopes high with victories in the round-of-16 of the Karnataka Open ATP Challenger at the S.M. Krishna Tennis Stadium here on Wednesday.

It was a milestone moment for the two as they entered a Challenger quarterfinal for the first time.

Wild card entrant Tyagi posted a fluent 6-4, 6-4 win over Japan's Yuta Kawahashi.

Composure

The 19-year-old, fairly new to the senior ranks, showed good composure in crunch points and excelled with a strong forehand, hitting down-the-line winners at will.



In control: Tyagi showed good composure in the crunch points against Kawahashi. K. MURALI KUMAR

Manish overcame qualifier Alastair Gray, who retired midway through the second set due to an illness.

Manish's dependable groundstrokes helped him win the first set 6-4, before his opponent began to wane.

Gray struggled to chase

the ball down, bringing a premature end to the match. Earlier, Mukund Sasikumar went down to second-seed Hamish Stewart 4-6, 4-6.

The results (round-of-16):

Hamish Stewart (GBR) bt Mukund Sasikumar 6-4, 6-4; Ognjen Milic (Srb) bt Joshua Charlton (Aus)

3-6, 6-4, 6-3; Keegan Smith (USA) bt Dominik Palan (Cze) 4-6, 6-3, 6-4; Ilya Ivashka bt Kokoro Isomura (Jpn) 6-1, 6-2. Maximus Jones (Tha) bt Amit Vales (Isr) 6-2, 6-7 (5), 6-4. Manish Sureshkumar bt Alastair Gray (GBR) 6-4, 3-2 ret'd. Kriish Tyagi bt Yuta Kawahashi (Jpn) 6-4, 6-4; Philip Sekulic (Aus) bt Christopher Papa (USA) 6-2, 6-3.

AROUND THE CITY

Mithun, Nisha win titles
N. Mithun (CCA) defeated S. Mathew (SACN) 16-13, 14-7 in the under-21 youth boys' final of the YMCA (Vepery) district-ranking carrom tournament. S. Barkath Nisha (CNCCC) downed M. Khazima (CNCCC) 21-12, 16-8 for the youth girls' title.

Other results (finals): Boys: Cadets (u-12): R. Lakshan (CNCCC) bt Thanish (GSCA) 21-0, 21-5; **Sub-junior (u-14):** Rohit Ramakrishnan (DBYC BB) bt Anish Atharva (CCA) 14-20, 8-3, 19-14; **Junior (u-18):** N. Naveeth Ahmed (CCA) bt A. Abdullah (CNCCC) 21-12, 4-21, 14-13. **Girls: Cadets:** R. Sadhana (BSCA) bt Keerthi (GSCA) 17-4, 16-15; **Sub-junior:** R. Ragavarshini bt S. Mothika 14-8, 18-5, 21-1; **Junior:** Tailam Varshini (CCA) bt K. Sanjana (CCN) 9-8, 19-0.

KDCA trials
The Kancheepuram



On the podium: The winners and runners-up of the district-ranking carrom tournament, organised by YMCA (Vepery).

LIVE TELECAST

IPL: Star Sports 1 & JioHotstar, 7.30 p.m.
LaLiga: FanCode, 10.30, 11.30 p.m. & 1 a.m. (Friday)

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STATEMENT OF STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED 31ST MARCH 2026

(Rs. In Crores)

S. No	Particulars	Standalone		Consolidated	
		Quarter ended	Year ended	Quarter ended	Year ended
		31.03.2026 (Unaudited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)	31.03.2026 (Unaudited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)
1	Total income from operations	348.41	294.72	516.34	637.30
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional items) (including discontinued operations)	312.24	264.04	373.42	410.09
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional items) (including discontinued operations)	312.24	264.04	373.10	410.09
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after exceptional items)	268.90	241.58	322.30	352.16
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income / (Loss) (after tax))	269.25	240.22	317.29	349.73
6	Paid up Equity share capital (Face value of Rs.5/- each)	10.12	10.12	10.12	10.12
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	-	-	1,744.31	1,601.02
8	Securities Premium Account	36.42	36.42	36.42	36.42
9	Networth	1,750.83	1,604.56	1,750.83	1,604.56
10	Outstanding Debt	1,593.08	943.81	1,593.08	943.81
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares of Holding Company	-	-	-	-
12	Debt Equity Ratio (including exceptional item)	0.90	0.45	0.90	0.45
13	Earnings Per Share (Face value of Rs. 5/- each) (not annualised) (in Rs.)	132.91	119.40	159.30	174.06
(i) Basic		132.91	119.40	159.30	174.06
(ii) Diluted		-	-	-	-
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA
15	Debenture Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (Excluding NBFC Subsidiaries) (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (Excluding NBFC Subsidiaries) (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA
18	Current Ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA
19	Long term debt to working capital (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA
20	Bad debts to Accounts Receivable ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA
21	Current liability ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA
22	Total debts to total assets ratio (Times)	0.44	0.34	0.44	0.34
23	Debtors Turnover ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA
24	Inventory Turnover ratio (Times)	NA	NA	NA	NA
25	Operating Margin (%)	NA	NA	NA	NA
26	Net Profit Margin (%)	77.62	80.42	62.45	54.68

Notes:

- The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulations 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the financial results are available on the Stock exchange websites (www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com) and on company's website (www.tvsholdings.com).
- Figures for the previous periods have been regrouped, wherever necessary, to conform to the current period's classification.
- The Detailed Financial Results of the Company for the year ended 31st March 2026 can be accessed through the QR code.



For TVS Holdings Limited
Sd/-
Venu Srinivasan
Chairman

Date : 13.05.2026



How things stand: Atletico is fourth on the table with 66 points. X@ATLETI

Atletico beats Osasuna; Betis qualifies for CL

LALIGA

Agence France-Presse
BARCELONA

Atletico Madrid consolidated its fourth place in LaLiga with a 2-1 victory over Osasuna on Tuesday while Real Betis beat Elche to guarantee itself a Champions League spot.

Atletico's English forward Ademola Lookman opened the scoring from the penalty spot in the 15th minute after Jani Galan was carded for handball.

Alexander Sorloth made it two with 20 minutes to play, the Norwegian heading in from close range past Aitor Fernandez.

Kike Barja made the game tighter than it should have been at the end with an injury-time strike to pull a goal back for Osasu-

na. But Atletico held on for a result that leaves the Madrid side fourth on 66 points behind newly crowned champion Barcelona (91 points), Real Madrid (77) and Villarreal (69), all three with a game in hand.

Elche lost 1-2 to Real Betis. Betis' victory means it qualified for next season's Champions League by finishing at least fifth.

It currently has 57 points, now seven ahead of sixth-placed Celta Vigo.

It will be Real Betis' first foray into the elite European competition since the 2005-06 season.

The results:

Celta Vigo 2 (Jutgla 4, 48) lost to Levante 3 (Arriaga 43, De la Fuente 57, Brugue 63). Real Betis 2 (Hernandez 9, Fornals 68) bt Elche 1 (Fort 41). Osasuna 1 (Kike Barja 90+1) lost to Atletico Madrid 2 (Lookman 15-pen, Sorloth 71).

$S-CH_2-CH_2-$

How new fossils, latest technology are tracing the origins of snakes

Scientists estimate that ancestors of the wildly diverse group of living snakes emerged around 160 million years ago, but they have not figured out what the first snakes were like; these mysterious, ancestral snakes should sit at the base of the snake family tree, but their fossils have not been found

Amber Dance

Back when dinosaurs stomped the earth, mammals scurried about in their shadows. Those furballs, hiding in underground burrows, provided a fresh niche for a novel reptile: the snake. Skinny snakes could squeeze into mammals’ holes and gobble them up. At least, that is how the dawn of snakes is imagined by Marc Tollis, an evolutionary biologist at Northern Arizona University in Flagstaff. No one knows for sure. Like the creatures, the snake fossil record is long and thin, leaving gaps in snaky history. Major questions, such as where they got their start and who their closest relatives are, remain unanswered.

Today, new fossils and modern techniques are updating the story of snakes. Starting about 125 million years ago, snakes used their flexible body plans to diversify like crazy, conquering regions that now make up six continents, plus the Indian and Pacific Oceans – and Mr. Tollis would not be surprised to find snake fossils in once-balmy Antarctica, either.

There are serpents slithering across the land, burrowing into the soil, swimming in the sea and gliding between trees, even catching rides on trains and, yes, planes. There are threadsnakes just a few inches long and thin as spaghetti, and pythons that exceed 20 feet. There are snakes that chase prey and snakes that lie in wait to ambush it, snakes that strangle their meals and others that immobilise their dinner with venom. Snakes that lay eggs, snakes that bear live young, snakes that reproduce without males.

It is an impressive smorgasbord of abilities for what is, essentially, a freaky offshoot on the lizard family tree. Serpents are basically predatory tubes, Mr. Tollis notes. They cannot walk or chew their food. These seem like seriously limiting factors.

“Despite that, snakes are some of the most successful animals,” marvels Mr. Tollis, who co-authored an overview of early snake and lizard evolution in the 2025 *Annual Review of Ecology, Evolution, and Systematics*. “They definitely have superpowers that we would normally associate with the fantastic.”

By sea, by land, or below?

There are more than 4,000 described living species of snakes, accounting for about one-third of the larger lizard group, and probably hundreds more awaiting official discovery, says Alex Pyron, an evolutionary biologist at George Washington University in Washington, DC. Scientists estimate that the ancestors of this wildly diverse group emerged around 160 million years ago, but they have not figured out what the first snakes were like – land snakes, sea snakes, underground snakes?

These mysterious, ancestral snakes should sit at the base of the snake family tree, but their fossils have not been found. The oldest snake fossils known come from a variety of environments, making it hard to determine which kind of habitat snakes wriggled out of, says Tiago Simões, a co-author on the *Annual Review* paper and an evolutionary biologist at Princeton University in New Jersey.

One longstanding hypothesis is that snakes got their start underground. The original idea was based, in part, on blind snakes that are the lowest branch on the family tree of living snakes. But blind snakes are quite specialised for the anthills and termite mounds they inhabit, says Catie Strong, a vertebrate palaeontologist and graduate student at the Harvard Museum of Comparative Zoology in Cambridge, Massachusetts.

They have weird, alien-looking skulls fit for their subterranean environment and insectivore diet. For example, Ms. Strong says, a “pronounced underbite” helps keep dirt out of their mouths. While training with vertebrate palaeontologist and evolutionary biologist Michael Caldwell at the University of Alberta in Edmonton, Canada, Ms. Strong concluded, as have others, that these hyperspecialised critters cannot correspond to the root of the snake family tree.

In the late 20th century, evidence suggesting a marine origin floated up. Scientists described snakes that lived nearly 100 million years ago in West Asia, when that land was underwater. Mr. Caldwell and colleagues also linked the snake clan to mosasaurs, extinct aquatic reptiles, raising the possibility that snakes emerged in the water. But favour for that hypothesis has sunk: There are other snakes that predate those aquatic snakes and were clearly terrestrial, says Mr. Simões.



Slithering around: Starting about 125 million years ago, snakes used their flexible body plans to diversify, conquering regions that now make up six continents, plus the Indian and Pacific Oceans. KNOWABLE MAGAZINE

Modern-day Patagonia has yielded a trove of additional snake fossils, such as *Najash rionegrina*, dated to about 95 million years ago, and *Dinilysia patagonica*, from about 80 million years ago, when that environment was desert-like. *Dinilysia* probably lived aboveground, but the situation with *Najash* is trickier, says Mr. Simões.

Najash has skull and spinal features that, to its discoverers, suggested it spent some time underground. But both of these Patagonia species were “big-bodied snakes,” adds Mr. Caldwell, similar to modern-day pythons. Like pythons, they might have hid out underground, but hunted on the surface, he speculates.

Additional evidence for a mixed dry land/underground origin comes from predictions about early snakes’ brains. Scientists used 3D X-ray imaging to analyse the braincase – the part of the skull protecting the brain – of nearly 60 snakes and lizards, plus a few snake fossils. From those inner contours, they could infer the brain’s shape. The researchers identified burrower brain anatomy: Diggers usually possess, for example, a small, flattened, triangular cerebellum, a brain section involved in movement. When the researchers used their data to predict the ancestral snake brain shape, they wound up with some burrower-like features, including that little cerebellum, but other features inconsistent with underground living.

Bringing the evidence together, Ms. Strong thinks that snakes evolved on land, maybe a sandy environment like the one *Dinilysia* and *Najash* inhabited. This, she suspects, also set them up to navigate underground on occasion.

A better way to slither

Another major event in snake evolution was, of course, the shedding of their legs. This is not as innovative as it might seem; among lizard-kind, several long, skinny

groups have kicked their legs to the curb. When crawling underground or moving through grass, limbs are literally “a drag,” says Daniela Garcia Cobos, an evolutionary biologist and graduate student at the American Museum of Natural History in New York City. Snakes do seem to have been among the first lizards to master this streamlined shape.

Mr. Pyron estimates this change happened between 150 million and 125 million years ago, but scientists have not pinned down exactly when or where.

Heady changes

In any case, what distinguished snakes from all other legless lizards were the other changes they made, says Mr. Pyron. To investigate further innovations, Mr. Pyron and collaborators embarked on a massive reptile census, published in *Science* in 2024. They measured the skulls of thousands of snakes and lizards. They examined stomach contents of museum specimens and pored over written dietary records. They amassed data from 5,400 genes from more than 1,000 snake and lizard species.

When they lined up those features, snakes stood out. About 125 million years ago, the group underwent sudden, significant changes to their skulls, diets and spines, positioning them to diversify and spread. Snakes’ biggest claim to evolutionary fame is their weirdly flexible craniums, made of bony pieces connected by soft tissue; Mr. Caldwell thinks this key alteration happened even before they gave up their legs. Snakes first changed up their braincase. In most lizards, this looks like a sandwich: bone on top, bone on the bottom, brain within and open on the sides. But in snakes, it is more like a wrap, a bony tube only open toward the face and spine. Protecting the brain that way meant snakes were free to let the rest of the skull’s bones move about. And boy, did they.

Those skull changes enabled new diets with the evolution of the serpentine jaw. While jaw anatomy varies within the group, in many snakes, the lower and upper parts are connected by stretchy ligaments, enabling a wide gape. The two sides of the lower jaw can splay apart, further expanding the snake’s maw. The palate at the top of the mouth has right and left parts that move independently to convey food throatwards. That is how a python can swallow a pig. Indeed, the *Science* team found that snakes, as a clan, can eat pretty much anything that moves. There are snakes that nosh on gooey slugs and armoured snails, slippery eels and even other serpents.

Around the same time, snakes grew longer, adding hundreds of vertebrae between their necks and nether regions. “Being elongate allows you to locomote more quickly and efficiently,” says Mr. Caldwell. Extra belly flesh supplies more surface area to push along the ground or climb tree trunks. For aquatic snakes, increased length enables more efficient weaving back and forth.

In sum, these changes to body, head and diet meant the evolving serpents were flexible not just in form, but also in lifestyle. Snakes adapt rapidly to new environments, says Frank Burbrink, curator of herpetology at the American Museum of Natural History and a co-author of the *Annual Review* article. In other words, these evolutionary superstars were primed to make the most of any habitat they slithered into.

Making up for absent fossils

The fragmented skulls and body length that were so beneficial for snakes’ spread create a headache for palaeontologists: Dead snakes go to pieces, making complete fossils scarce and leaving many questions unanswered. For example, researchers know serpents are related to groups containing iguanas and Komodo dragons, as well as possibly those mosasaurs, but it is not certain which are their closest cousins. Knowing that would help to predict what snake ancestors should look like, says Susan E. Evans, a paleontologist at University College London.

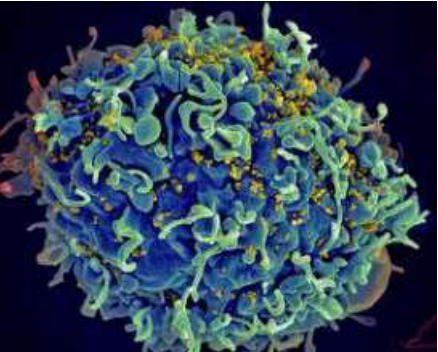
When fossils falter, genetics can come to the rescue. Already, genetic analyses have forced a reshuffling of the lizard family tree; trees based on body shape alone turned out to be “totally wrong,” says Mr. Pyron.

Genes have also illuminated how snake bodies build some of their special features. The lack of legs is linked to lost function in a limb-promoting sequence called ZRS.

Mr. Burbrink, Mr. Pyron and Mr. Simões are now sequencing whole genomes of more than 100 snakes and lizards, which will double the number of high-quality genomes available. With that plus additional data on living and fossil reptiles, they expect to build better family trees and further investigate the genes behind a snake’s sinuous shape.

Still, Ms. Evans says, scientists really need more fossils to fill in the twists and turns in the serpents’ tale.

As palaeontologists keep digging, Mr. Burbrink counsels us to take a moment to marvel the next time we come across a garter snake or other modern wriggler: “You are looking at the culmination of more than 100 million years of evolution.” (Amber Dance is special contributor, Knowable Magazine. This article is republished from Knowable Magazine with permission.)



This colourised electron microscope image provided by the U.S. NIH shows a human T cell (blue) under attack by HIV (yellow). AP

Revving up immune cells might help fight HIV: study

Associated Press

Scientists are tweaking a powerful cancer therapy in hopes it could fight HIV instead, by supercharging patients’ own immune cells.

On Tuesday, researchers said a single dose of those revved-up cells strongly suppressed HIV in two people – one for nearly a year and the other for nearly two years – without requiring their usual medicines.

Larger and longer studies are needed to prove if what’s called CAR-T cell therapy might really offer long-lasting help for HIV, cautioned Dr Steven Deeks of the University of California, San Francisco, who led the research.

“We find the fact that two people have had such a really sustained response provocative,” he said. “There is a real need for a one-and-done, safe and scalable cure ... and this is one of the

Researchers have long hunted an elusive cure, pursuing such clues as a rare gene mutation that makes some people naturally resistant to HIV

strategies that we’re pursuing.” The data is being presented at a meeting of the American Society of Gene and Cell Therapy in Boston.

There are nearly 40 million people living with HIV around the world. Today’s medicines have turned the virus that causes AIDS from a fast killer into a manageable chronic disease, often keeping the virus at undetectable levels, but only if people can afford the drugs and stick with them. The virus hides out in reservoirs in the body and rebounds fast if people stop treatment.

Researchers have long hunted an elusive cure, pursuing such clues as a rare gene mutation that makes some people naturally resistant to HIV or how a handful of HIV patients who also had certain cancers were declared cured or in long-term remission after receiving a stem cell transplant, something too risky for most people.

CAR-T therapy involves taking immune soldiers called T cells out of a person’s blood, genetically engineering them into “living drugs” and infusing them back into the patient. They’re widely used to cure certain types of cancer and are being studied for other diseases.

For HIV, scientists at the nonprofit drug developer Caring Cross created CAR-T cells with dual features. They’re programmed to better find and kill HIV-infected cells – and engineered with protection against infection by the very virus they’re supposed to fight.

With that added armor, they should be able to reproduce enough to keep HIV in check, said Caring Cross executive director Boro Dropulic.

Deeks’ early-stage experiment tested different dosing strategies in people who stopped their HIV medicine the day they received their CAR-T cells. There were no serious side effects. The first three recipients showed no response and resumed their usual medicines.

Six others received a small amount of chemotherapy to make space for the new T cells. Those two strong responders saw their HIV drop to undetectable levels, inching up only occasionally when the CAR-T cells presumably got to work again. A third patient had a temporary response and resumed regular HIV treatment.

Those three patients all had started their original HIV treatment soon after they’d been infected, Deeks said. That makes sense because people treated early tend to have less HIV hiding in the body and a healthier immune system.

For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount approved by Bangladesh for mega river project

2.8 in \$ billion. Bangladesh approved on Wednesday a mega river project worth \$2.8 billion that authorities hope would help the country address its persistent water crisis. The project highlights Dhaka's efforts to secure water supplies for its agriculture-dependent economy. AFP

People affected by disasters in Arunachal from January to May

32,800 A series of disasters, including storms, landslides, floods, forest fires and heavy rainfall incidents, have affected over 32,800 people across Arunachal Pradesh during the period between January and May 13 this year. PTI

Percentage increase in U.S. wholesale prices in April

6 in per cent. Wholesale prices in the U.S. rose sharply in April, pushed by a surge in energy costs related to the Iran war, registering their highest 12-month increase in more than three years. The Producer Price Index rose 6.0% for the 12 months ending in April, the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) said. AFP

Percentage increase in Pakistan's external debts in FY2025-26

3.60 in per cent. Pakistan's external debts have risen by 3.6% to reach Pakistani rupees (PKR) 22,959 billion in FY 2025-26, according to a report. The State Bank of Pakistan released the statistics, revealing that the total debt has surpassed PKR 80 trillion rupees. PTI

Financial assistance received by Delhi RWAs and NGOs

13.36 in ₹ crore. The Delhi government released over ₹13 crore in 2025-26 for maintenance of 1,643 parks through RWAs and NGOs, marking the highest financial assistance since 2008-09, according to official data. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Why did NTA's 'Zero Error' policy fail?

Why has NEET landed in controversy again? How has NEET faced repeated paper leak allegations? Why are paper leak concerns persisting despite NTA's safeguards? What reforms were proposed after the 2024 row? Can NEET shift to a computer-based format?

EXPLAINER

Maitri Porecha
Srinidhi Madurai K.

The story so far:

Nine days after nearly 22 lakh medical aspirants wrote the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET), which paves the way for admission to medical colleges, they were in for a rude shock. On May 12, the National Testing Agency (NTA) stated that the exam had been 'compromised,' and that there would be a re-test.

The decision has created a furore among students across the country, with the Federation of All India Medical Association (FAIMA) moving the Supreme Court with a plea to either replace NTA or conduct major restructuring reforms.

What controversies has NEET faced over the years?

The decision to conduct re-examination for nearly 22 lakh students is unprecedented in NEET's history, but concerns over paper leaks are not new. In 2024, the declaration of the NEET-UG results coincided with the announcement of national election results. For the first time, 67 out of the top 100 scorers received full marks. In comparison, only two students achieved full marks in 2023, while none did so in 2022. A high concentration of students achieving full marks led to massive rank inflation, with multiple aspirants who had scored high marks competing for a single seat in reputed medical colleges.

In 2024, 13 lakh students qualified and were competing for approximately 1.1 lakh MBBS seats across government and private medical colleges. Allegations of a paper leak later surfaced, with investigations revealing that 155 students had allegedly benefited from leaked question papers. Students had then demanded a re-examination, but their request fell on deaf ears.



Nearly 22 lakh medical aspirants wrote the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test. K.V.S. GIRI

Why has NTA's 'Zero Error' promise fallen short?

With repeated cases of paper leaks surfacing year after year, the NTA appears not to have learnt from its chequered past. The overhaul of NTA merely remained lip service. After the 2024 debacle, IAS officer Subodh Kumar Singh, then Director General of the NTA, was removed from the post and transferred to the Ministry of Steel as Additional Secretary. He is currently serving as Principal Secretary to the Chief Minister of Chhattisgarh.

Following his transfer, the NTA remained without a full-time chief for over a year, with retired 1985-batch IAS officer Pradeep Singh Kharola holding 'additional interim charge'. In March this year, former IndiaAI Mission CEO Abhishek Singh took charge of NTA and declared that there would be a 'Zero Error, Zero Tolerance' policy.

After the NEET-UG 2026 examination was conducted on May 3, the NTA underscored on social media the "smooth manner" in which the exam had been held across 5,432 centres, with 22.79 lakh candidates appearing. It stated that more

than two lakh personnel were involved in conducting the examination.

The agency also claimed that there was end-to-end secure handling of confidential materials under sealed protocols, GPS-enabled vehicles with police escorts for the movement of examination material, CCTV surveillance at all examination centres (up to 1,50,000), with feeds linked to centralised control rooms, mandatory frisking through high-sensitivity metal detectors before entry, with strengthened manpower and equipment at every centre, Aadhaar-based biometric authentication to prevent impersonation and real-time monitoring through centralised control systems.

Mr. Abhishek Singh told *The Hindu* that the NTA had blocked 120 Telegram channels for circulating fake question papers and rumours, aimed at defrauding candidates.

Despite these measures, investigations by the Rajasthan Police revealed that a "guess paper" containing 120 out of 410 questions from the final examination had allegedly been circulating for nearly a month before the exam, a massive

oversight by the NTA.

What did the Radhakrishnan panel recommend?

Following the NEET-UG 2024 controversy, the Ministry of Education formed a high-level committee headed by former ISRO chairman K. Radhakrishnan. However, the committee's recommendations were not followed in letter and spirit by either the NTA or the Ministry.

The report, submitted in October 2024, highlighted the pen-and-paper testing (PPT) model as 'a major security risk.' It recommended a transition to Computer-Based Testing (CBT) format, similar to the Joint Entrance Examination (JEE) Main, which is also conducted by NTA.

The committee also recommended Computer-assisted Secure PPT, where encrypted papers are delivered digitally to exam centres and printed locally just before the test. NTA has made no claim of implementing it. Instead, it relied on GPS vehicles and police escorts.

Mr. Abhishek Singh said that the NTA has the capacity to conduct CBT tests for only about 1.5 lakh students in a day. He added that shifting NEET to CBT mode is a 'high-level ministry call' involving both the Ministries of Health and Education.

In 2024, the NTA floated a tender to increase its capacity of computer labs, but the process could not be finalised. In 2026, the NTA has around 552 CBT centres, which are primarily used for JEE and CUET examinations. Since the Radhakrishnan Committee report came out in 2024, the NTA has not been able to augment its infrastructure to add more centres.

Multiple proposals to administer NEET-UG exams online were sent to the Ministry of Education, but in vain, officials at the NTA told *The Hindu*. "Talks for administering the NEET-UG in CBT mode have been ongoing for at least five years now. The recent paper leak fiasco should serve as an eye-opener to change the format of the exams," an official said.

THE GIST

▼ The NTA announced a re-test for nearly 22 lakh NEET aspirants after the exam was found to be "compromised", triggering outrage and fresh concerns over paper leaks.

▼ Despite "Zero Error, Zero Tolerance" claims and multiple security measures, a "guess paper" containing 120 of 410 questions allegedly circulated before the exam, renewing calls for reforms and a shift to computer-based testing.

What has the IMD announced ahead of this year's monsoon?

Why are the 15 States in the monsoon core zone the first to receive block-level forecasts?

Jacob Koshy

The story so far:

The India Meteorological Department on Tuesday unveiled a new forecast system that, for the first time, will generate block-level forecasts of the monsoon's arrival. The system covers 15 States and one Union Territory, taking in 3,196 blocks – roughly half of India's 7,200-odd blocks. Until now, monsoon onset estimates have been available at best at the State or district scale.

Why does this granularity matter?

The conventional district-scale forecast obscures a basic feature of the Indian monsoon: its patchiness. The arrival dates familiar to most people – around June 10 for Mumbai, June 29 for Delhi – describe the monsoon reaching a city or a district boundary. But within the same district, several blocks and villages can remain rainless even after the monsoon has

officially "arrived." For a farmer deciding when to sow, knowing that the monsoon has reached the district headquarters is of limited use if her own block is still dry. Hyper-local forecasts have been a long-standing aim of the IMD precisely to close this gap and help farmers time their sowing.

How does the new system work?

At its core are two forecasting models whose outputs are "blended" to sharpen accuracy. From the date of the monsoon's onset over Kerala, the system draws on AI-based analysis, the IMD's trove of nearly a century of meteorological data, and global weather models to project the monsoon's itinerary at a much finer scale than before.

The blending framework was developed by the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology, a Pune-based research institute under the Ministry of Earth Sciences. It issues probabilistic forecasts for the next four weeks.

Why these particular 15 States?

The States covered are part of what meteorologists call the monsoon core zone. As M. Ravichandran, Secretary in the Ministry of Earth Sciences, put it at a press briefing, these are "the regions that are largely rainfed and are most sensitive to southwest monsoon dynamics." They are also the regions where forecast errors translate most directly into crop losses. The ambition is eventually to extend block-level forecasts across all of India, but Mr. Ravichandran said this would require a denser network of observational data than is currently available in many States.

How well will it work in its first season?

The system has cleared two trial runs, but this year will be a stiff test. The IMD and global models are expecting "below normal" rainfall from July onwards, in the light of a developing El Niño – a pattern in the Pacific Ocean that has frequently

coincided with weak monsoon rains in India. Forecasting a weak, erratic monsoon at block resolution can be harder than forecasting a robust one.

What is the separate announcement about Uttar Pradesh?

The IMD also launched a 10-day monsoon forecast model specifically for Uttar Pradesh at a resolution of 1 km – meaning the model resolves weather features down to that scale. This was possible because of Uttar Pradesh's unusually extensive network of automatic weather stations, whose observations allowed a weather model called Mithuna, which natively runs at 12.5 km, to be "downscaled" to 1 km. Mr. Ravichandran said other States were being encouraged to share their station data with the IMD so that similarly high-resolution forecasts could be produced for them.

What is the broader picture?

Two trends are converging. One is a push, driven by the agriculture ministry, to make forecasts agriculturally actionable rather than merely meteorologically accurate. The other is the IMD's increasing willingness to combine traditional physics-based models with AI and to lean on State-level observational networks where they exist. Block-level forecasting is the first concrete product of that combination – and the 2026 monsoon, El Niño and all, will be its proving ground.

THE GIST

▼ The IMD has launched a new block-level monsoon forecast system using AI-based analysis, meteorological data and global weather models to provide hyper-local forecasts for farmers in the monsoon core zone.

▼ The 2026 monsoon will test the new blended forecasting framework as India faces the possibility of below-normal and erratic rainfall linked to a developing El Niño.

